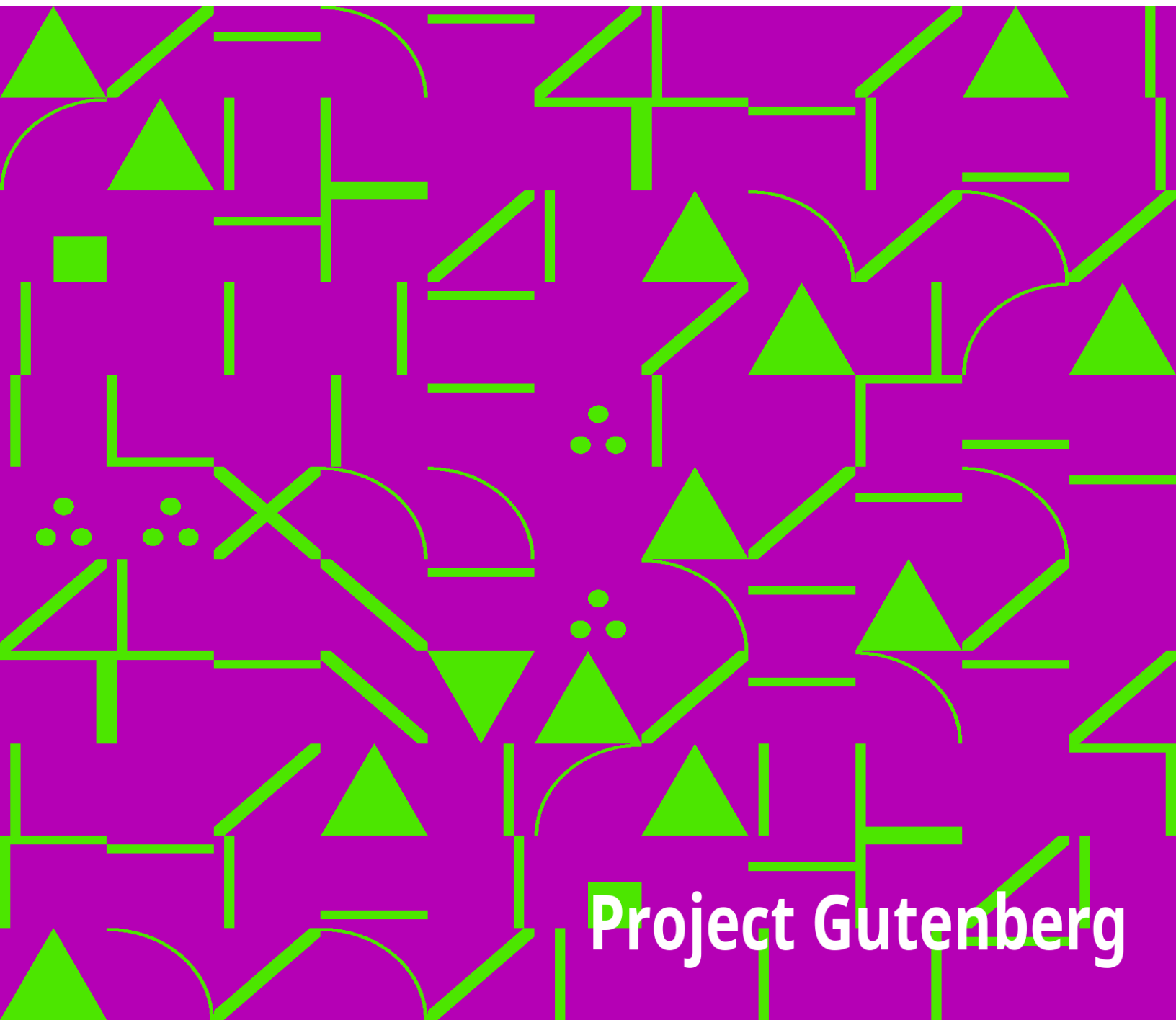


Ancient Nahuatl Poetry, Containing the Nahuatl Text of XXVII Ancient Mexican Poems

Daniel G. Brinton



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ANCIENT MEXICAN POEMS ***

ANCIENT NAHUATL POETRY,

**CONTAINING THE NAHUATL TEXT
OF XXVII ANCIENT MEXICAN POEMS.**

**BRITON'S LIBRARY OF ABORIGINAL AMERICAN
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**WITH A TRANSLATION, INTRODUCTION, NOTES AND
VOCABULARY.**

BY

DANIEL G. BRINTON

1890

PREFACE.

It is with some hesitation that I offer this volume to the scientific public. The text of the ancient songs which it contains offers extreme and peculiar difficulties to the translator, and I have been obliged to pursue the task without assistance of any kind. Not a line of them has ever before been rendered into an European tongue, and my endeavors to obtain aid from some of the Nahuatl scholars of Mexico have, for various reasons, proved ineffectual. I am therefore alone responsible for errors and misunderstandings.

Nevertheless, I have felt that these monuments of ancient native literature are so interesting in themselves, and so worthy of publication, that they should be placed at the disposition of scholars in their original form with the best rendering that I could give them at present, rather than to await the uncertain event of years for a better.

The text itself may be improved by comparison with the original MS. and with the copy previously made by the Licentiate Chimalpopoca, referred to on page 48. My own efforts in this direction have been confined to a faithful reproduction in print of the MS. copy of the Abbé Brasseur de Bourbourg.

The Notes, which might easily have been extended, I have confined within moderate compass, so as not to enlarge unduly the bulk of the volume.

To some, the Vocabulary may seem inadequate. I assume that those persons who wish to make a critical study of the original text will provide themselves with the Nahuatl Dictionaries of Molina or Siméon, both of which are now easily obtainable, thanks to Mr. Julius Platzmann for the reprint of Molina. I also assume that such students will acquaint themselves with the rules of grammar and laws of word-building of the tongue, and that they will use the vocabulary merely as a labor-saving means of reaching the themes of compounds and unusual forms of words. Employed in this manner, it will, I hope, be found adequate.

In conclusion, I would mention that there is a large body of Nahuatl literature yet unpublished, both prose and poetry, modern and ancient, and as the Nahuatl tongue is one of the most highly developed on the American continent, it is greatly to be desired that all this material should be at the command of students. The Nahuatl, moreover, is not a difficult tongue; for an Englishman or a Frenchman, I should say it is easier to acquire than German, its grammar being simple and regular, and its sounds soft and sonorous. It has special recommendations, therefore, to one who would acquaint himself with an American language.

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ANCIENT NAHUATL POETRY.

INTRODUCTION.

§ 1. *THE NATIONAL LOVE OF POETRY.*

The passionate love with which the Nahuas cultivated song, music and the dance is a subject of frequent comment by the historians of Mexico. These arts are invariably mentioned as prominent features of the aboriginal civilization; no public ceremony was complete without them; they were indispensable in the religious services held in the temples; through their assistance the sacred and historical traditions were preserved; and the entertainments of individuals received their chief lustre and charm from their association with these arts.

The profession of the poet stood in highest honor. It was the custom before the Conquest for every town, every ruler and every person of importance to maintain a company of singers and dancers, paying them fixed salaries, and the early writer, Duran, tells us that this custom continued in his own time, long after the Conquest. He sensibly adds, that he can see nothing improper in it, although it was condemned by some of the Spaniards.¹ In the training of these artists their patrons took a deep personal interest, and were not at all tolerant of neglected duties. We are told that the chief selected the song which was to be sung, and the tune by which it was to be accompanied; and did any one of the choir sing falsely, a drummer beat out of time, or a dancer strike an incorrect attitude, the unfortunate artist was instantly called forth, placed in bonds and summarily executed the next morning!²

With critics of such severity to please, no wonder that it was necessary to begin the training early, and to set apart for it definite places and regular teachers. Therefore it was one of the established duties of the teachers in the *calmecac* or public school, "to teach the pupils all the verses of the sacred songs which were written in characters in their books."³ There were also special schools, called *cuicoyan*, singing places, where both sexes were

taught to sing the popular songs and to dance to the sound of the drums.⁴ In the public ceremonies it was no uncommon occurrence for the audience to join in the song and dance until sometimes many thousands would thus be seized with the contagion of the rhythmical motion, and pass hours intoxicated (to use a favorite expression of the Nahuatl poets) with the cadence and the movement.

After the Conquest the Church set its face firmly against the continuance of these amusements. Few of the priests had the liberal views of Father Duran, already quoted; most of them were of the opinion of Torquemada, who urges the clergy "to forbid the singing of the ancient songs, because all of them are full of idolatrous memories, or of diabolical and suspicious allusions of the same character."⁵

To take the place of the older melodies, the natives were taught the use of the musical instruments introduced by the Spaniards, and very soon acquired no little proficiency, so that they could perform upon them, compose original pieces, and manufacture most of the instruments themselves.⁶

To this day the old love of the song and dance continues in the Indian villages; and though the themes are changed, the forms remain with little alteration. Travelers describe the movements as slow, and consisting more in bending and swaying the body than in motions of the feet; while the songs chanted either refer to some saint or biblical character, or are erotic and pave the way to orgies.⁷

§ 2. THE POET AND HIS WORK.

The Nahuatl word for a song or poem is *cuicatl*. It is derived from the verb *cuica*, to sing, a term probably imitative or onomatopoeitic in origin, as it is also a general expression for the twittering of birds. The singer was called *cuicani*, and is distinguished from the composer of the song, the poet, to whom was applied the term *cuicapicqui*, in which compound the last member, *picqui*, corresponds strictly to the Greek ποιητής, being a

derivative of *piqui*, to make, to create.⁸ Sometimes he was also called *cuicatlamantini*, "skilled in song."

It is evident from these words, all of which belong to the ancient language, that the distinction between the one who composed the poems and those who sang them was well established, and that the Nahuatl poetry was, therefore, something much above mere improvisation, as some have thought. This does not alter the fact that a professed bard usually sang songs of his own composition, as well as those obtained from other sources. This is obvious from the songs in this collection, many of which contain the expression *ni cuicani*, I, the singer, which also refers to the maker of the song.

In the classical work of Sahagun, the author describes the ancient poet: "The worthy singer has a clear mind and a strong memory. He composes songs himself and learns those of others, and is always ready to impart either to the fellows of his craft. He sings with a well-trained voice, and is careful to practice in private before he appears before the public. The unworthy singer, on the other hand, is ignorant and indolent. What he learns he will not communicate to others. His voice is hoarse and untrained, and he is at once envious and boastful."⁹

§ 3. THE THEMES AND CLASSES OF THE SONGS.

From what he could learn about them some two centuries or more after the Conquest, the antiquary Boturini classified all the ancient songs under two general heads, the one treating mainly of historical themes, while the other was devoted to purely fictitious, emotional or imaginative subjects.¹⁰ His terse classification is expanded by the Abbé Clavigero, who states that the themes of the ancient poets were various, some chanting the praises of the gods or petitioning them for favors, others recalled the history of former generations, others were didactic and inculcated correct habits of life, while others, finally, were in lighter vein, treating of hunting, games and love.¹¹

His remarks were probably a generalization from a chapter in Torquemada's *Monarquía Indiana*, in which that writer states that the songs at the sacred festivals differed in subject with the different months and seasons. Thus, in

the second month of their calendar, at its stated festival, the people sang the greatness of their rulers; in the seventh month all the songs were of love, of women, or of hunting; in the eighth the chants recalled the noble deeds of their ancestors and their divine origin; while in the ninth month nothing was heard but verses fraught with lamentation for the dead.¹² With less minuteness, Father Duran gives almost the same information. He himself had often heard the songs which Montezuma of Tenochtitlan, and Nezahualpizintli of Tezcucó, had ordered to be composed in their own honor, describing their noble lineage, their riches, their grandeur and their victories. These songs were in his day still sung at the public dances of the natives, and he adds, "although they were filled with laudation of their ancient rulers, it gave me much pleasure to hear the praises of such grandeur." There were other poets, he observes, who lived in the temples and composed songs exclusively in honor of the gods.¹³

These general expressions may be supplemented by a list of terms, specifying particular classes of songs, preserved by various writers. These are as follows:—

melahuacuicatl: this is translated by Tezozomoc, "a straight and true song."¹⁴ It is a compound of *melahuac*, straight, direct, true; and *cuicatl*, song. It was a beginning or opening song at the festivals, and apparently derived its name from its greater intelligibility and directness of expression. A synonym, derived from the same root, is *tlamelauhcaoyotl*, which appears in the title to some of the songs in the present collection.

xopancuicatl: this term is spelled by Ixtlilxochitl, *xompacuicatl*, and explained to mean "a song of the spring" (from *xopan*, springtime, *cuicatl*, song). The expression seems to be figurative, referring to the beginning or early life of things. Thus, the prophetic songs of Nezahualcoyotl, those which he sang when he laid the foundation of his great palace, bore this name.¹⁵

teuccuicatl: songs of the nobles (*teuctli*, *cuicatl*). These were also called *quauhcuicatl*, "eagle songs," the term *quauhtli*, eagle, being applied to distinguished persons.

xochicuicatl: flower-song, one singing the praises of flowers.

icnocuicatl: song of destitution or compassion.

noteuhcuicaliztli: "the song of my lords." This appears to be a synonymous expression for *teuccuicatl*; it is mentioned by Boturini, who adds that on the day sacred to the god Xiuhteuctli the king began the song so called.¹⁶

miccacuicatl: the song for the dead (*miqui*, to die, *cuicatl*). In this solemn chant the singers were seated on the ground, and their hair was twisted in plaits around their heads.¹⁷

In addition to the above terms drawn from the subject or character of the songs, there were others, of geographical origin, apparently indicating that the song, or its tune, or its treatment was borrowed from another locality or people. These are:—

Huexotzincayotl: a song of Huexotzinco, a Nahuatl town, situated east of the Lake of Tezcuco. This song was sung by the king and superior nobles at certain festivals, and, in the prescribed order of the chants, followed a *melahuaccuicatl*.¹⁸

Chalcayotl: a song of Chalco, on the lake of the same name. This followed the last mentioned in order of time at the festivals.

Otoncuicatl: a song of the Otomis. These were the immediate neighbors of the Nahuas, but spoke a language radically diverse. The songs so-called were sung fourth on the list.

Cuextecayotl: a song of the country of the Cuexteca, or Cuextlan, a northern province of Mexico.

Tlauancacuextecayotl: a song of the country of the Tlauancacuexteca.

Anahuacayotl: a song of Anahuac, that is, of a country near the water, either the valley of Mexico, or the shores of the ocean.

Some very ancient sacred songs were referred to by Tezozomoc as peculiar to the worship of Huitzilopochtli, and, indeed, introduced by this potent divinity. From their names, *cuitlaxoteyotl*, and *tecuilhuicuicatl*,¹⁹ I judge that they referred to some of those pederastic rites which still prevail extensively among the natives of the pueblos of New Mexico, and which

have been described by Dr. William A. Hammond and other observers.²⁰
One of these songs began,

Cuicoyan | nohuan | mitotia;
In-the- | with- | they-
place-of- me dance.
song

But the old chronicler, who doubtless knew it all by heart, gives us no more of it.²¹

§ 4. *PROSODY OF THE SONGS.*

The assertion is advanced by Boturini that the genuine ancient Nahuatl poetry which has been preserved is in iambic metre, and he refers to a song of Nezahualcoyotl in his collection to prove his opinion. What study I have given to the prosody of the Nahuatl tongue leads me to doubt the correctness of so sweeping a statement. The vocalic elements of the language have certain peculiarities which prevent its poetry from entering unencumbered into the domain of classical prosody.

The quantity of Nahuatl syllables is a very important element in the pronunciation of the tongue, but their quantity is not confined, as in Latin, to long, short, and common. The Nahuatl vowels are long, short, intermediate, and "with stress," or as the Spanish grammarians say, "with a jump," *con saltillo*. The last mentioned is peculiar to this tongue. The vowel so designated is pronounced with a momentary suspension or catching of the breath, rendering it emphatic.

These quantities are prominent features in the formal portions of the language, characterizing inflections and declinations. No common means of designating them have been adopted by the grammarians, and for my present purpose, I shall make use of the following signs:—

ă , short.
a , intermediate
ā , long.

â , with stress.

The general prosodic rules are:—

1. In polysyllabic words in which there are no long vowels, all the vowels are intermediate.
2. The vowels are long in the penultimate of the plurals of the imperatives when the preterit of the verb ends in a vowel; the *ā* of the *cān* of the imperatives; the *ī* of the *tī*; of the gerundives; the last vowel of the futures when the verb loses a vowel to form them; the penultimates of passives in *lo*, of impersonals, of verbals in *oni*, *illi*, *olli* and *oca*, of verbal nouns with the terminations *yan* and *can*; the *ō* of abstract nouns in *otl* in composition; and those derived from long syllables.
3. Vowels are "with stress" when they are the finals in the plurals of nouns and verbs, also in the perfect preterite, in possessives ending in *â*, *ê*, *ô*, and in the penultimate of nouns ending in *tli*, *tla* and *tle* when these syllables are immediately preceded by the vowel.²²

The practical importance of these distinctions may be illustrated by the following examples:—

tâtli , father.
tātli , thou
 drinkest.
tātlî , we
 drink.

It is, however, evident from this example that the quantity of Nahuatl syllables enters too much into the strictly formal part of the language for rules of position, such as some of those above given, to be binding; and doubtless for this reason the eminent grammarian Carlos de Tapia Zenteno, who was professor of the tongue in the University of Mexico, denies that it can be reduced to definite rules of prosody like those of the Latin.²³

Substituting accent for quantity, there would seem to be an iambic character to the songs. Thus the first words of Song I, were probably chanted:—

Nino' yolno' notza' campā' nicū iz' yec tli' ahui aca' xochitl': etc.

But the directions given for the drums at the beginning of Songs XVIII, XIX, etc., do not indicate a continuance of these feet, but of others, as in XIX:—

u—, u—, u—, uu—, u—, u—, u—, etc.

Indeed, we may suppose that the metre varied with the subject and the skill of the poet. This, in fact, is the precise statement of Father Duran,²⁴ who speaks of the native poets as "giving to each song a different tune (*sonada*), as we are accustomed in our poetry to have the sonnet, the octava rima and the terceto."

§ 5. *THE VOCAL DELIVERY OF THE SONG.*

Descriptions of the concerts so popular among the Nahuas have been preserved by the older writers, and it is of the highest importance to understand their methods in order to appreciate the songs presented in this volume.

These concerts were held on ceremonial occasions in the open air, in the village squares or in the courtyards of the houses. They began in the morning and usually continued until nightfall, occasionally far into the night. The musicians occupied the centre of the square and the trained singers stood or sat around them. When the sign was given to begin, the two most skillful singers, sometimes a man and a woman, pronounced the first syllables of the song slowly but with a sharp emphasis;²⁵ then the drums began in a low tone, and gradually increased in strength as the song proceeded; the other singers united their voices until the whole chorus was in action, and often the bystanders, to the numbers of thousands, would ultimately join in the words of some familiar song, keeping time by concerted movements of the hands and feet.

Each verse or couplet of the song was repeated three or four times before proceeding to the next, and those songs which were of the slowest measure and least emotional in character were selected for the earlier hours of the

festivals. None of the songs was lengthy, even the longest, in spite of the repetitions, rarely lasting over an hour.^{[26](#)}

The tone in which the words were chanted is described by Clavigero, Mühlenpfordt and other comparatively recent travelers as harsh, strident and disagreeable to the European ear. Mendieta calls it a "contra-bass," and states that persons gifted with such a voice cultivated it assiduously and were in great demand. The Nahuas call it *tozquitl*, the singing voice, and likened it to the notes of sweet singing birds.

§ 6. *THE INSTRUMENTAL ACCOMPANIMENT.*

The Nahuas were not acquainted with any stringed instrument. They manufactured, however, a variety of objects from which they could extract what seemed to them melodious sounds. The most important were two forms of drums, the *huehuetl* and the *teponaztli*.

The word *huehuetl* means something old, something ancient, and therefore important and great. The drum so-called was a hollow cylinder of wood, thicker than a man's body, and usually about five palms in height. The end was covered with tanned deerskin, firmly stretched. The sides were often elaborately carved and tastefully painted. This drum was placed upright on a stand in front of the player and the notes were produced by striking the parchment with the tips of the fingers.

A smaller variety of this instrument was called *tlapanhuehuetl*, or the half drum, which was of the same diameter but only half the height.^{[27](#)} Still another variety was the *yopihuehuetl*, "the drum which tears out the heart,"^{[28](#)} so called either by reason of its penetrating and powerful sound, or because it was employed at the *Yopico*, where that form of human sacrifice was conducted.

The *teponaztli* was a cylindrical block of wood hollowed out below, and on its upper surface with two longitudinal parallel grooves running nearly from end to end, and a third in the centre at right angles to these, something in the shape of the letter I. The two tongues left between the grooves were struck with balls of rubber, *ulli*, on the ends of handles or drum sticks. These

instruments varied greatly in size, some being five feet in length, and others so small that they could conveniently be carried suspended to the neck. The *teponaztli* was the house instrument of the Nahuas. It was played in the women's apartments to amuse the noble ladies, and the war captains carried one at the side to call the attention of their cohorts on the field of battle (Sahagun). The word is derived from the name of the tree whose wood was selected to make the drum, and this in turn from the verb *tepunazoa*, to swell, probably from some peculiarity of its growth.²⁹

A much superior instrument to the *teponaztli*, and doubtless a development from it, was the *tecomapiloa*, "the suspended vase" (*tecomatl*, gourd or vase, *piloa*, to hang or suspend). It was a solid block of wood, with a projecting ridge on its upper surface and another opposite, on its lower aspect; to the latter one or more gourds or vases were suspended, which increased and softened the sound when the upper ridge was struck with the *ulli*.³⁰ This was undoubtedly the origin of the *marimba*, which I have described elsewhere.³¹

The musical properties of these drums have been discussed by Theodor Baker. The *teponaztli*, he states, could yield but two notes, and could not have been played in accord with the *huehuetl*. It served as an imperfect contra-bass.³²

The *omichicahuaz*, "strong bone," was constructed somewhat on the principle of a *teponaztli*. A large and long bone was selected, as the femur of a man or deer, and it was channeled by deep longitudinal incisions. The projections left between the fissures were rasped with another bone or a shell, and thus a harsh but varied sound could be produced.³³

The *tetzilacatl*, the "vibrator" or "resounder," was a sheet of copper suspended by a cord, which was struck with sticks or with the hand. It appears to have been principally confined to the sacred music in the temples.

The *ayacachtli* was a rattle formed of a jar of earthenware or a dried gourd containing pebbles which was fastened to a handle, and served to mark time in the songs and dances. An extension of this simple instrument was the *ayacachicahualiztli*, "the arrangement of rattles," which was a thin board

about six feet long and a span wide, to which were attached bells, rattles and cylindrical pieces of hard wood. Shaking this produced a jingle-jangle, agreeable to the native ear. The Aztec bells of copper, *tzilinilli*, are really metallic rattles, like our sleigh bells. They are often seen in collections of Mexican antiquities. Other names for them were *coyolli* and *yoyotli*.

Various forms of flutes and fifes, made of reeds, of bone or of pottery, were called by names derived from the word *pitzaua*, to blow (e.g., *tlapitzalli*, *uilacapitzli*), and sometimes, as being punctured with holes, *zozolotli*, from *zotl*, the awl or instrument used in perforating skins, etc. Many of those made of earthenware have been preserved, and they appear to have been a highly-esteemed instrument, as Sahagun mentions that the leader of the choir of singers in the temple bore the title *tlapitzcatzin*, "the noble flute player."

Large conches were obtained on the seashore and framed into wind instruments called *quiquiztli* and *tecciztli*, whose hoarse notes could be heard for long distances, and whistles of wood, bone and earthenware added their shrill notes to the noise of the chanting of the singers. The shell of the tortoise, *ayotl*, dried and suspended, was beaten in unison with such instruments.

Recent researches by competent musical experts conducted upon authentic specimens of the ancient Mexican instruments have tended to elevate our opinion of their skill in this art. Mr. H.T. Cresson, of the Academy of Natural Sciences, Philadelphia, has critically examined the various Aztec clay flutes, whistles, etc., which are there preserved, and has reached the following conclusions:—

"I. That upon the four-holed clay flageolets the chromatic and diatonic scales can be produced with a full octave.

"II. That the clay whistles or pitch pipes, which may be manipulated in quartette, will produce an octave and a fourth.

"III. From the facts above shown, the Aztecs must have possessed a knowledge of the scales as known to us, which has been fully tested by comparison with the flute and organ."³⁴ [—](#)

This result indicates for the instrumental accompaniment a much higher position in musical notation than has hitherto been accepted.

§ 7. *THE POETIC DIALECT.*

All the old writers who were familiar with the native songs speak of their extreme obscurity, and the difficulty of translating them. No one will question the intimate acquaintance with the Nahuatl language possessed by Father Sahagun; yet no one has expressed more strongly than he the vagueness of the Nahuatl poetic dialect. "Our enemy on earth," he writes, "has prepared a thick woods and a dangerous ground full of pitfalls, wherein to devise his evil deeds and to hide himself from attack, as do wild beasts and venomous serpents. This woods and these pitfalls are the songs which he has inspired to be used in his service, as praises to his honor, in the temples and elsewhere; because they are composed with such a trick that they proclaim only what the devil commands, and are understood only by those to whom they are addressed. It is well known that the cavern, woods or depths in which the devil hides himself were these chants or psalms which he himself has composed, and which cannot be understood in their true significance except by those who are accustomed to the peculiar style of their language."³⁵ —

Not less positive are the expressions of Father Diego Duran, contemporary of Sahagun, and himself well versed in the native tongue. "All their songs," he observes, "were composed in such obscure metaphors that scarcely any one can understand them unless he give especial attention to their construction."³⁶ The worthy Boturini was puzzled by those which he had collected, and writes, "the songs are difficult to explain, because they mystify historical facts with constant allegorizing,"³⁷ and Boturini's literary executor, Don Mariano Echevarria y Veitia, who paid especial attention to the poetic fragments he had received, says frankly: "The fact is, that as to the songs I have not found a person who can fully translate them, because there are many words in them whose signification is absolutely unknown to-day, and moreover which do not appear in the vocabularies of Molina or others."³⁸ —

The Abbé Clavigero speaks in somewhat more definite terms of the poetic forms and licenses of the language. He notes that in the fragments of the ancient verses which had been preserved until his day there were inserted between the significant words certain interjections and meaningless syllables, apparently to fill out the metre. Nevertheless, he considered the language of the chants, "pure, pleasant, brilliant, figurative and replete with allusions to the more pleasing objects in nature, as flowers, trees, brooks, etc."³⁹ It is quite evident from the above extracts that in the translation of the ancient songs in the present volume we must be prepared for serious difficulties, the more so as the Nahuatl language, in the opinion of some who are the best acquainted with it, lends itself with peculiar facility to ambiguities of expression and obscure figures of speech.⁴⁰ Students of American ethnology are familiar with the fact that in nearly all tribes the language of the sacred songs differs materially from that in daily life.

Of the older grammarians, Father Carochi alone has left us actual specimens of the ancient poetic dialect, and his observations are regrettably brief. They occur in his chapter on the composition of nouns and read as follows:⁴¹—

"The ancient Indians were chary in forming compounds of more than two words, while those of to-day exceed this number, especially if they speak of sacred things; although in their poetic dialect the ancients were also extravagant in this respect, as the following examples show:—

1. Tlāuhquéchōllaztalēhualtō tōnatoc.

1. It is gleaming red like the tlauhquechol bird.

2. Ayauhcoçamālōtōnamēyōtimani.

2. And it glows like the rainbow.

3. Xiuhcōyólizítzîlica in teōcuitlahuēhuētl.

3. The silver drum sounds like bells of turquoise.

4. Xiuhtlapallācuilōlāmoxтли manca.

4. There was a book of annals written and painted in colors.

5. Nic chālchiuhcozcameca quenmach tōtōma in nocuic.

5. I see my song unfolding in a thousand directions, like a string of precious stones."

From the specimens presented in this volume and from the above extracts, I would assign the following peculiarities to the poetic dialect of the Nahuatl:

I. Extreme frequency and richness of metaphor. Birds, flowers, precious stones and brilliant objects are constantly introduced in a figurative sense, often to the point of obscuring the meaning of the sentence.

II. Words are compounded to a much greater extent than in ordinary prose writing.

III. Both words and grammatical forms unknown to the tongue of daily life occur. These may be archaic, or manufactured capriciously by the poet.

IV. Vowels are inordinately lengthened and syllables reduplicated, either for the purpose of emphasis or of meter.

V. Meaningless interjections are inserted for metrical effect, while others are thrown in and repeated in order to express emotion.

VI. The rhetorical figure known as aposiopesis, where a sentence is left unfinished and in an interjectional condition, in consequence of some emotion of the mind, is not rare and adds to the obscurity of the wording.

§ 8. *THE PRESERVATION OF THE ANCIENT SONGS.*

In a passage already quoted,⁴² Sahagun imparts the interesting information that the more important songs were written down by the Nahuas in their books, and from these taught to the youth in the schools. A certain branch of the Mexican hieroglyphic writing was largely phonetic, constructed on that method to which I have applied the adjective *ikonomatic*, and by which it was quite possible to preserve the sound as well as the sense of sentences and verses.⁴³ Such attention could have been bestowed only on the sacred, royal, or legendary chants, while the compositions of ordinary poets would only be disseminated by oral teaching.

By one or both of these methods there was a large body of poetic chants the property of the Nahuatl-speaking tribes, when they were subjugated by the Europeans. Among the intelligent missionaries who devoted their lives to mastering the language and translating into it the doctrines of Christianity, there were a few who felt sufficient interest in these chants to write some of them down in the original tongue. Conspicuous among these was the laborious Bernardino de Sahagun, whose works are our most valued sources of information on all that concerns the life of the ancient Nahuas. He collected a number of their sacred hymns, translated them into Spanish, and inserted them into the Appendix to the Second Book of his *History of New Spain*; but this portion of his work was destroyed by order of the Inquisition, as a note in the original MS. expressly states.⁴⁴

A certain number, however, were preserved in the original tongue, and, as already noted, we find the able grammarian Horatio Carochi, who published his Grammar of the Nahuatl in 1645, quoting lines from some as furnishing examples of the genuine ancient forms of word-building. He could not, therefore, have doubted their antiquity and authenticity.

A number of these must have come to the knowledge and were probably in the possession of the eminent mathematician and antiquary Don Carlos de Sigüenza y Góngora, who lived in the latter half of the same century (died 1700). It was avowedly upon the information which he thought he gleaned from these ancient chants that he constructed his historical theory of the missionary labors of St. Thomas in Mexico in the first century of our era. The title of the work he wrote upon this notion was as follows:—

Fenix del Occidente San Thomas Apóstol, hallado con el nombre de Quetzalcoatl entre las cenizas de antiguas tradiciones, conservadas en piedras, en Teoamoxtles Tultecas, y en cantares Teochichimecas y Mexicanos."

For many years this curious work, which was never printed, was supposed to be lost; but the original MS. is extant, in the possession of the distinguished antiquary Don Alfredo Chavero, of the City of Mexico.⁴⁵ Unfortunately, however, the author did not insert in his work any song in the native language nor a literal translation of any, as I am informed by Señor

Chavero, who has kindly examined the work carefully at my request, with this inquiry in view.

Half a century later, when Boturini was collecting his material, he found but very few of the old poems. In the catalogue of his MSS. he mentions (XIX, 1) some fragments of ancient songs, badly written, on European paper, but he does not say whether in the original or translated. The same doubt might rest on the two songs of Nezahualcoyotl named in his Catalogue (V, 2). He does not specifically state that they are in the original. The song of Moquihuix, King of Tlatilulco, in which he celebrated his victory over the Cuextla, which Boturini states in his text (p. 91) as in his possession, is not mentioned at all in his Catalogue, and it is uncertain whether his copy was in Nahuatl.

His literary friend, however, Don Mariano Echevarria y Veitia, removes the uncertainty about the two songs of Nezahualcoyotl, as he informs us that they were in the original tongue, and adds that he had inserted them in his History without translation.⁴⁶ I have examined the manuscript of his work, now in the Lenox Library, New York City, but it does not contain these texts, and evidently the copy used by Bustamente did not.⁴⁷

Boturini included the translations of the two odes of Nezahualcoyotl in a work on the Virgin of Guadalupe, only a fragment of which has been preserved. One of the chapters in this Latin Essay is entitled *De Indorum Poetarum Canticis sive Prosodiis*, in which he introduces Ixtlilxochitl's translation and also a song in the original Nahuatl, but the latter is doubtless of late date and unimportant as a really native production.⁴⁸

The fragments of Boturini's library collected by M. Aubin, of Paris, contain a number of the original ancient songs of the highest importance, which make us regret the more that this collection has been up to the present inaccessible to students. In his description of these relics published in 1851, M. Aubin refers to the *Historical Annals of the Mexican Nation* (§ VIII, 10, of Boturini's Catalogue) as containing "historical songs in a dialect so difficult that I have not been able to translate them entirely," and adds that similar songs are preserved in others of the ancient annals in his hands.⁴⁹

§ 9. THE LX SONGS OF THE KING NEZAHUALCOYOTL.

The most distinguished figure among the Nahuatl poets was Nezahualcoyotl, ruler of Tezcucó. His death took place in 1472, at the age of eighty years. His father, Ixtlilxochitl, had been deprived of his possessions and put to death by Tezozomoc, King of the Tepanecas, and until the death of the latter at an advanced age in 1427, Nezahualcoyotl could make but vain efforts to restore the power of his family. Much of the time he was in extreme want, and for this reason, and for his savage persistence in the struggle, he acquired the name "the fasting or hungry wolf"— *nezahualcoyotl*. Another of his names was *Acolmiztli*, usually translated "arm of the lion," from *aculli*, shoulder, and *miztli*, lion.

A third was *Yoyontzin*, which is equivalent to *ceveter nobilis*, from *yoyoma* (*cevere*, i.e., *femora movere in re venered*); it is to be understood figuratively as indicating the height of the masculine forces.

When his power became assured, he proved himself a liberal and enlightened patron of the arts and industries. The poetry and music of his native land attracted him the more as he felt within himself the moving god, firing his imagination with poetic vision, the *Deus in nobis, calescimus, agitant'illo*. Not only did he diligently seek out and royally entertain skilled bards, but he himself had the credit of composing sixty chants, and it appears that after the Conquest there were that many written down in Roman characters and attributed to him. We need not inquire too closely whether they were strictly his own composition. Perhaps they were framed on themes which he furnished, or were selected by him from those sung at his court by various bards. The history of the works by royal authors everywhere must not be too minutely scanned if we wish to leave them their reputation for originality.

He was of a philosophic as well as a poetic temperament, and reflected deeply on the problems of life and nature. Following the inherent tendency of the enlightened intellect to seek unity in diversity, the One in the Many, he reached the conclusion to which so many thinkers in all ages and of all races have been driven, that underlying all phenomena is one primal and adequate Cause, the Essence of all Existence. This conclusion he expressed

in a philosophic apothegm which was preserved by his disciples, in these words:—

Ipan in chicunauitlamanpan meztica in tloque nahuaque palne nohuani teyocoyani icel teotl oquiyocox in ixquex quexquex in ittoni ihuan amo ittoni.

"In the ninth series is the Cause of All, of us and of all created things, the one only God who created all things both visible and invisible."⁵⁰

To perpetuate the memory of this philosophic deduction he caused to be constructed at Tezcuco a stone tower nine stories in height, the ruins of which were visible long after the Spanish occupation. To this tower he gave the name Chililitli, a term of uncertain meaning, but which we find was applied in Tenochtitlan to a building sacred to the Nine Winds.⁵¹ To explain the introduction of this number, I should add that a certain school of Nahuatl priests taught that the heaven above and the earth below were each divided into nine concentric arcs, each leading farther and farther away from the conditions of the present life. Hence, there were nine heavens, abodes of the gods, and nine lower regions, abodes of the souls of the dead. Another school taught that there were not nine but thirteen of these stages.

The sixty poems by Nezahualcoyotl are mentioned by various writers as in existence after the Conquest, reduced to writing in the original tongue, and of several of them we have translations or abstracts.⁵² Of four the translations claim to be complete, and were published entire for the first time in the original Spanish by Lord Kingsborough in the ninth volume of his great work on the *Antiquities of Mexico*. Since then they have received various renderings in prose and verse into different languages at the hands of modern writers.

I shall give a literal prose translation from the Spanish, numbering the poems and their verses, for convenience of reference, in the order in which they appear in the pages of Lord Kingsborough.

The first is one referred to, and partly translated by Ixtlilxochitl, in his *Historia Chichimeca* (cap. 47). He calls it a *xopancuicatl* (see ante, p. 15), and states that it was composed and sung on the occasion of the banquet

when the king laid the foundations of his great palace. He gives the first words in the original as follows:—

Tlaxoconcaguican ani Nezahualcoyotzin;

And the translation:—

"Hear that which says the King Nezahualcoyotl."

Restoring the much mutilated original to what I should think was its proper form, the translation should read:—

"Listen attentively to what I, the singer, the noble Nezahualcoyotl, say:"—

I.

1. Listen with attention to the lamentations which I, the King Nezahualcoyotl, make upon my power, speaking with myself, and offering an example to others.

2. O restless and striving king, when the time of thy death shall come, thy subjects shall be destroyed and driven forth; they shall sink into dark oblivion. Then in thy hand shall no longer be the power and the rule, but with the Creator, the All-powerful.

3. He who saw the palaces and court of the old King Tezozomoc, how flourishing and powerful was his sway, may see them now dry and withered; it seemed as if they should last forever, but all that the world offers is illusion and deception, as everything must end and die.

4. Sad and strange it is to see and reflect on the prosperity and power of the old and dying King Tezozomoc; watered with ambition and avarice, he grew like a willow tree rising above the grass and flowers of spring, rejoicing for a long time, until at length, withered and decayed, the storm wind of death tore him from his roots, and dashed him in fragments to the ground. The same fate befell the ancient King Colzatzli, so that no memory was left of him, nor of his lineage.

5. In these lamentations and in this sad song, I now call to memory and offer as an example that which takes place in the spring, and the end which

overtook King Tezozomoc; and who, seeing this, can refrain from tears and wailing, that these various flowers and rich delights are bouquets that pass from hand to hand and all wither and end even in the present life!

6. Ye sons of kings and mighty lords, ponder well and think upon that which I tell you in these my lamentations, of what takes place in spring and of the end which overtook King Tezozomoc; and who, seeing this, can refrain from tears and wailing that these various flowers and rich delights are bouquets that pass from hand to hand and all wither and end even in the present life!

7. Let the birds now enjoy, with melodious voices, the abundance of the house of the flowery spring, and the butterflies sip the nectar of its flowers.

The second song is preserved in a Spanish metrical translation only, but which from internal evidence I should judge to be quite literal. The words of the poem do not represent it as a composition by the royal poet, but one which was sung before him, and addressed to him. It admonishes him to rejoice in the present moment, as the uncertainties of life and fate must at some time, perhaps very soon, deprive him of their enjoyment.

II.

1. I wish to sing for a moment, since time and occasion are propitious; I hope to be permitted, as my intention merits it, and I begin my song, though it were better called a lamentation.

2. And thou, beloved companion, enjoy the beauty of these flowers, rejoice with me, cast out fears, for if pleasure ends with life, so also does pain.

3. I, singing, will touch the sonorous instrument, and thou, rejoicing in the flowers, dance and give pleasure to God the powerful. Let us be happy in the present, for life is transitory.

4. Thou hast placed thy noble court in Acolhuacan, thine are its lintels, thou hast decked them, and one may well believe that with such grandeur thy state shall increase and grow.

5. O prudent Yoyontzin, famous king and peerless monarch, rejoice in the present, be happy in the springtime, for a day shall come in which thou shalt vainly seek these joys.

6. Then thy destiny shall snatch the sceptre from thy hand, thy moon shall wane, no longer wilt thou be strong and proud, then thy servants shall be destitute of all things.

7. In this sad event, the nobles of thy line, the provinces of might, children of noble parents, lacking thee as their lord, shall taste the bitterness of poverty.

8. They shall call to mind how great was thy pomp, thy triumphs and victories, and bewailing the glory and majesty of the past, their tears will flow like seas.

9. These thy descendants who serve thy plume and crown, when thou art gone, will forsake Culhuacan, and as exiles will increase their woes.

10. Little will fame have to tell of this wondrous majesty, worthy of a thousand heralds; the nations will only remember how wisely governed the three chieftains who held the power,

11. At Mexico, Montezuma the famous and valorous, at Culhuacan the fortunate Nezahualcoyotl, and at the stronghold of Acatlapan, Totoquilhuatli.

12. I fear no oblivion for thy just deeds, standing as thou dost in thy place appointed by the Supreme Lord of All, who governs all things.

13. Therefore, O Nezahualcoyotl, rejoice in what the present offers, crown thyself with flowers from thy gardens, hear my song and music which aim to please thee.

14. The pleasures and riches of this life are but loaned, their substance is vain, their appearance illusory; and so true is this that I ask thee for an answer to these questions:

15. What has become of Cihuapan? Of the brave Quantzintecomatzin? Of Conahuatzin? What of all these people? Perhaps these very words have already passed into another life.

16. Would that we who are now united by the ties of love and friendship could foresee the sharp edge of death, for nothing is certain, and the future ever brings changes.

The third is a "spring song" in which the distinguished warriors of the king are compared to precious stones. Such jewels were believed by the Nahuas to possess certain mysterious powers as charms and amulets, a belief, it is needless to say, found among almost all nations. In verse 18 there is a reference to the superstition that at dawn, when these jewels are exposed to the first rays of the sun, they emit a fine vapor which wafts abroad their subtle potency. The poem is in Spanish verse, and the original is said to have been written down by Don Fernando de Avila, governor of Tlalmanalco, from the mouth of Don Juan de Aguilar, governor of Cultepec, a direct descendant of Nezahualcoyotl.

III

1. The flowery spring has its house, its court, its palace, adorned with riches, with goods in abundance.
2. With discreet art they are arranged and placed, rich feathers, precious stones, surpassing in luster the sun.
3. There is the valued carbuncle, which from its beauteous center darts forth rays which are the lights of knowledge.
4. There is the prized diamond, sign of strength, shooting forth its brilliant gleams.
5. Here one sees the translucent emerald suggesting the hope of the rewards of merit.
6. Next follows the topaz, equaling the emerald, for the reward it promises is a heavenly dwelling.
7. The amethyst, signifying the cares which a king has for his subjects, and moderation in desires.

8. These are what kings, princes and monarchs delight to place upon their breasts and crowns.

9. All these stones with their varied and singular virtues, adorn Thy house and court, O Father, O Infinite God!

10. These stones which I the King Nezahualcoyotl have succeeded in uniting in loving liens,

11. Are the famous princes, the one called Axaxacatzin, the other Chimalpopoca, and Xicomatzintlamata.

12. To-day, somewhat rejoiced by the joy and words of these, and of the other lords who were with them,

13. I feel, when alone, that my soul is pleased but for a brief time, and that all pleasure soon passes.

14. The presence of these daring eagles pleases me, of these lions and tigers who affright the world,

15. These who by their valor win everlasting renown, whose name and whose deeds fame will perpetuate.

16. Only to-day am I glad and look upon these rich and varied stones, the glory of my bloody battles.

17. To-day, noble princes, protectors of the realm, my will is to entertain you and to praise you.

18. It seems to me that ye answer from your souls, like the fine vapor arising from precious stones,—

19. "O King Nezahualcoyotl, O royal Montezuma, your subjects sustain themselves with your soft dews.

20. "But at last a day shall come which will cut away this power, and all these will be left wretched orphans.

21. "Rejoice, mighty King, in this lofty power which the King of Heaven has granted you, rejoice and be glad.

22. "In the life of this world there is no beginning anew, therefore rejoice, for all good ends.

23. "The future promises endless changes, griefs that your subjects will have to undergo.

24. "Ye see before you the instruments decked with wreaths of odorous flowers; rejoice in their fragrance.

25. "To-day there are peace, and goodfellowship; therefore let all join hands and rejoice in the dances,

26. "So that for a little while princes and kings and the nobles may have pleasure in these precious stones,

27. "Which through his goodness the will of the King Nezahualcoyotl has set forth for you, inviting you to-day to his house."

The fourth song has been preserved in an Otomi translation by the Mexican antiquary Granados y Galvez⁵³ and in an abstract by Torquemada.⁵⁴ The latter gives the first words as follows:—

Xochitl mamani in huehuetitlan:

Which he translates:—

"There are fresh and fragrant flowers among the groves."

It is said to have been composed at the time the king dedicated his palace.

IV.

1. The fleeting pomps of the world are like the green willow trees, which, aspiring to permanence, are consumed by a fire, fall before the axe, are upturned by the wind, or are scarred and saddened by age.

2. The grandeurs of life are like the flowers in color and in fate; the beauty of these remains so long as their chaste buds gather and store the rich pearls of the dawn and saving it, drop it in liquid dew; but scarcely has the Cause

of All directed upon them the full rays of the sun, when their beauty and glory fail, and the brilliant gay colors which decked forth their pride wither and fade.

3. The delicious realms of flowers count their dynasties by short periods; those which in the morning revel proudly in beauty and strength, by evening weep for the sad destruction of their thrones, and for the mishaps which drive them to loss, to poverty, to death and to the grave. All things of earth have an end, and in the midst of the most joyous lives, the breath falters, they fall, they sink into the ground.

4. All the earth is a grave, and nought escapes it; nothing is so perfect that it does not fall and disappear. The rivers, brooks, fountains and waters flow on, and never return to their joyous beginnings; they hasten on to the vast realms of Tlaloc, and the wider they spread between their margins the more rapidly do they mould their own sepulchral urns. That which was yesterday is not to-day; and let not that which is to-day trust to live to-morrow.

5. The caverns of earth are filled with pestilential dust which once was the bones, the flesh, the bodies of great ones who sate upon thrones, deciding causes, ruling assemblies, governing armies, conquering provinces, possessing treasures, tearing down temples, flattering themselves with pride, majesty, fortune, praise and dominion. These glories have passed like the dark smoke thrown out by the fires of Popocatepetl, leaving no monuments but the rude skins on which they are written.

6. Ha! ha! Were I to introduce you into the obscure bowels of this temple, and were to ask you which of these bones were those of the powerful Achalchiuhtlanextin, first chief of the ancient Toltecs; of Necaxecmitl, devout worshiper of the gods; if I inquire where is the peerless beauty of the glorious empress Xiuhtzal, where the peaceable Topiltzin, last monarch of the hapless land of Tulan; if I ask you where are the sacred ashes of our first father Xolotl; those of the bounteous Nopal; those of the generous Tlotzin; or even the still warm cinders of my glorious and immortal, though unhappy and luckless father Ixtlilxochitl; if I continued thus questioning about all our august ancestors, what would you reply? The same that I reply—I know not, I know not; for first and last are confounded in the common clay. What was their fate shall be ours, and of all who follow us.

7. Unconquered princes, warlike chieftains, let us seek, let us sigh for the heaven, for there all is eternal, and nothing is corruptible. The darkness of the sepulchre is but the strengthening couch for the glorious sun, and the obscurity of the night but serves to reveal the brilliancy of the stars. No one has power to alter these heavenly lights, for they serve to display the greatness of their Creator, and as our eyes see them now, so saw them our earliest ancestors, and so shall see them our latest posterity.

It will be seen that the philosophy of these songs is mostly of the Epicurean and *carpe diem* order. The certainty of death and the mutability of fortune, observations which press themselves upon the mind of man everywhere, are their principal staples, and cast over them a hue of melancholy, relieved by exhortations to enjoy to the utmost what the present moment offers of pleasure and sensual gratification. Here and there a gleam of a higher philosophy lights the sombre reflections of the bard; his thoughts turn toward the infinite Creator of this universe, and he dimly apprehends that by making Him the subject of his contemplation, there is boundless consolation even in this mortal life.

Both these leading *motifs* recur over and over again in the songs printed in the original in the present volume, and this similarity is a common token of the authenticity of the book.

§ 10. THE HISTORY OF THE PRESENT COLLECTION.

The most recent Mexican writers formally deny that any ancient Mexican poetry is now extant. Thus the eminent antiquary, Don Alfredo Chavero, in his elaborate work, *México á través de los Siglos*, says, "the truth is, we know no specimens of the ancient poetry, and those, whether manuscript or printed, which claim to be such, date from after the Conquest."⁵⁵ In a similar strain the grammarian Diario Julio Caballero, writes: "There has never come into our hands a single poetic composition in this language. It is said that the great King Nezahualcoyotl was a poet and composed various songs; however that may be, the fact is that we have never seen any such compositions, nor met any person who has seen them."⁵⁶

It is important, therefore, to state the exact provenance of the specimens printed in this volume, many of which I consider to have been composed previous to the Conquest, and written down shortly after the Nahuatl language had been reduced to the Spanish alphabet.

All of them are from a MS. volume in the library of the University of Mexico, entitled *Cantares de los Mexicanos y otros opusculos*, composed of various pieces in different handwritings, which, from their appearance and the character of the letter, were attributed by the eminent antiquary Don José F. Ramirez, to the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries.

The copy I have used is that made by the late Abbé Brasseur (de Bourbourg). It does not appear to be complete, but my efforts to have it collated with the original have not been successful. Another copy was taken by the late well-known Mexican scholar Faustino Chimalpopoca, which was in the possession of Señor Ramirez and sold at the vendue of his books in 1880. It is No. 511 of the catalogue.

The final decision of the age of the poems must come from a careful scrutiny of the internal evidence, especially the thoughts they contain and the language in which they are expressed. In applying these tests, it should be remembered that a song may be almost wholly ancient, that is, composed anterior to the Conquest, and yet display a few later allusions introduced by the person who preserved it in writing, so as to remove from it the flavor of heathenism. Some probable instances of this kind will be pointed out in the Notes.

The songs are evidently from different sources and of different epochs. There are two notes inserted in the MS. which throw some light on the origin of a few of the poems. The first is in connection with No. XII. In my copy of the MS, the title of this song is written twice, and between the two the following memorandum appears in Spanish:

"Ancient songs of the native Otomis, which they were accustomed to sing at their festivals and marriages, translated into the Mexican language, the play and the spirit of the song and its figures of speech being always retained; as Your Reverence will understand, they displayed considerable style and beauty, better than I can express with my slight talent; and may Your

Reverence at your convenience approve and be entertained by them, as a skilled master of the tongue, as Your Reverence is."

From its position and from the titles following, this note appears to apply only to No. XII.

The second note is prefixed to No. XIV, which has no title. It is in Nahuatl, and reads as follows:—

†
I H S

Nican ompehua in cuicatl motenehua melahuac Huexotzincayotl ic moquichitoya in tlatoque Huexotzinca mani mecatca; yexcan inic tlatlamantitica, teuccuicatl ahnoço quauhcuicatl, xochicuicatl, icnocuicatl. Auh inic motzotzona huehuetl cencamatl mocauhtiuh, auh in occencamatl ipan huetzi yetetl ti; auh in huel ic ompehua centetl ti; auh inic mocuepa quiniquac iticpa huehuetzi y huehuetl, zan mocemana in maitl; auh quiniquac iyeinepantla occeppa itenco hualcholoa in huehuetl; tel yehuatl itech mottaz, ynima ynaquin cuicani quimati iniuh motzotzona; auh yancuican yenoceppa inin cuicatl ychan D. Diego de Leon, Gobernador Azcapotzalco; yehuatl oquitzotzon in D. Frco Placido ypan xihuitl 1551, ypan in ezcalilitzin tl Jesu Christo.

This may be freely translated as follows:—

"Here begins a song called a plain song of Huexotzinco as it was recited by the lords of Huexotzinco. These songs are divided into three classes, the songs of the nobles or of the eagles, the flower songs, and the songs of destitution. (Directions follow for beating the drum in unison with the voices.) This song was sung at the house of Don Diego de Leon, Governor of Azcapotzalco; he who beat the drum was Don Francisco Placido; in the year of the resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ 1551."

This assigns beyond doubt the song in question to the first half of the sixteenth century, and we may therefore take its phraseology as a type of the

Nahuatl poetry shortly after the Conquest. It is also stated to be a native composition, and from its contents, it was clearly composed by one of the converts to the Christian faith.

ANCIENT NAHUATL POEMS.

I. *CUICAPEUHCAYOTL.*

1. Ninoyolnonotza, campa nicuiz yectli,
ahuiaca xochitl:—Ac nitlatlaniz? Manozo
yehuatl nictlatlani in quetzal huitzitziltin, in
chalchihuh huitzitzicatzin; manozo ye
nictlatlani in zaquan papalotl; ca yehuantin
in machiz, ommati, campa cueponi in yectli
ahuiac xochitl, tla nitlahuihuitequi in nican
acxoyatzinitzcanquauhtla, manoze
nitlahuihuitequi in
tlauhquecholxochiquauhtla; oncan
huihuitolihui ahuach tonameyotoc in oncan
mohehcmelquixtia; azo oncan niquimittaz
intla onechittitique; nocuexanco nictemaz
ic niquintlapaloz in tepilhuan, ic
niquimellelquixtiz in teteuctin.

I. *SONG AT THE BEGINNING.*

1. I am wondering
where I may gather
some pretty, sweet
flowers. Whom shall I
ask? Suppose that I ask
the brilliant humming-
bird, the emerald
trembler; suppose that I
ask the yellow butterfly;
they will tell me, they
know, where bloom the
pretty, sweet flowers,
whether I may gather
them here in the laurel
woods where dwell the
tzinitzcan birds, or
whether I may gather
them in the flowery
forests where the
tlauquechol lives. There
they may be plucked
sparkling with dew,
there they come forth in
perfection. Perhaps
there I shall see them if

they have appeared; I
shall place them in the
folds of my garment,
and with them I shall
greet the children, I
shall make glad the
nobles.

2. Tlacazo nican nemi, ye nicaqui in
ixochicuicatzin yuhqui tepetl
quinnananquilia; tlacazo itlan in
meyaquetzalatl, xiuhtotoameyalli, oncan
mocuica, momotla, mocuica; nananquilia in
centzontlatolli; azo quinnananquilia in
coyoltototl, ayacachiçahuacatimani, in
nepapan tlazocuicani totome. Oncan
quiyectenehua in tlalticpaque
hueltozcatemique.

2. Truly as I walk along
I hear the rocks as it
were replying to the
sweet songs of the
flowers; truly the
glittering, chattering
water answers, the bird-
green fountain, there it
sings, it dashes forth, it
sings again; the
mockingbird answers;
perhaps the coyol bird
answers, and many
sweet singing birds
scatter their songs
around like music. They
bless the earth pouring
out their sweet voices.

3. Nic itoaya, nitlaocoltzatzia; ma
namechellelti y tlazohuane, niman
cactimotlalique, niman hualtato in quetzal
huitzitziltin. Aquin tictemohua,
cuicanitzine? Niman niquinnanquilia
niquimilhuia: Campa catqui in yectli,
ahuiaxochitl ic niquimellelquixtiz in
amohuampotzitzinhuan? Niman
onechicacahuatzque ca nican tlatimitzittitili

3. I said, I cried aloud,
may I not cause you
pain ye beloved ones,
who are seated to listen;
may the brilliant
humming-birds come
soon. Whom do we
seek, O noble poet? I
ask, I say: Where are
the pretty, fragrant

ticuicani azo nelli ic tiquimellelquixtiz in
toquichpohuan in teteuctin.

flowers with which I
may make glad you my
noble compeers? Soon
they will sing to me,
"Here we will make
thee to see, thou singer,
truly wherewith thou
shalt make glad the
nobles, thy
companions."

4. Tepeitic tonacatlalpa, xochitlalpa
nechcalaqueo oncan on
ahuachtotonameyotimani, oncan
niquittacaya in nepapan tlazoahuiaxochitl,
tlazohuelic xochitl ahuach quequentoc,
ayauhcozamalonameyotimani, oncan
nechilhuia, xixochitetequi, in catlehuatl
toconnequiz, ma mellelquiza in ticuicani,
tiquinmacataciz in tocnihuan in teteuctin in
quellelquixtizque in tlalticpaque.

4. They led me within a
valley to a fertile spot, a
flowery spot, where the
dew spread out in
glittering splendor,
where I saw various
lovely fragrant flowers,
lovely odorous flowers,
clothed with the dew,
scattered around in
rainbow glory, there
they said to me, "Pluck
the flowers, whichever
thou wishest, mayest
thou the singer be glad,
and give them to thy
friends, to the nobles,
that they may rejoice on
the earth."

5. Auh nicnocuecuxantia in nepapan
ahuiaxochitl, in huel teyolquima, in huel
tetlamacti, nic itoaya manozo aca tohuanti
hual calaquini, ma cenca miec in
ticmamani; auh ca tel ye onimatico
nitlanonotztahciz imixpan in tocnihuan

5. So I gathered in the
folds of my garment the
various fragrant
flowers, delicate
scented, delicious, and I
said, may some of our

nican mochipa tiqualtetequizque in tlazo
nepapan ahuiac xochitl ihuan ticuiquihui in
nepapan yectliyancuicatl ic
tiquimellelquixtizque in tocnihuan in
tlalticpactlaca in tepilhuan quauhtliya
ocelotl.

people enter here, may
very many of us be
here; and I thought I
should go forth to
announce to our friends
that here all of us
should rejoice in the
different lovely,
odorous flowers, and
that we should cull the
various sweet songs
with which we might
rejoice our friends here
on earth, and the nobles
in their grandeur and
dignity.

6. Ca moch nicuitoya in nicuicani ic
niquimicpac xochiti in tepilhuan inic
niquimapan in can in mac niquinten; niman
niquehuaya yectli yacuicatl ic netimalolo in
tepilhuan ixpan in tloque in nahuaque, auh
in atley y maceuallo.

6. So I the singer
gathered all the flowers
to place them upon the
nobles, to clothe them
and put them in their
hands; and soon I lifted
my voice in a worthy
song glorifying the
nobles before the face
of the Cause of All,
where there is no
servitude.

7. Can quicuiz? Can quitlaz in huelic
xochitl? Auh cuix nohuan aciz aya in
xochitlalpan, in tonacatlalpan, in atley y
macehuallo in nentlamati? Intla y tlacohua
in tlalticpac ca çan quitemacehualtica in
tloque in nahuaque, in tlalticpac; ye nican

7. Where shall one
pluck them? Where
gather the sweet
flowers? And how shall
I attain that flowery
land, that fertile land,
where there is no

ic chocan noyollo noconilnamiquia in ompa
onitlachiato y xochitlalpana nicuicani.

servitude, nor
affliction? If one
purchases it here on
earth, it is only through
submission to the Cause
of All; here on earth
grief fills my soul as I
recall where I the singer
saw the flowery spot.

8. Auh nic itoaya tlacazo amo qualcan in
tlalticpac ye nican, tlacazo occecní in
huilohuayan, in oncan ca in netlamachtilli;
tlezannen in tlalticpac? tlacazo occecní
yoliliz ximoayan, ma ompa niauh, ma
ompa inhuan noncuicati in nepapan
tlazototome, ma ompa nicnotlamachti
yectliya xochitl ahuiaca xochitl, in
teyolquima, in zan tepacca, teahuiaca
yhuintia, in zan tepacca, ahuiaca yhuintia.

8. And I said, truly there
is no good spot here on
earth, truly in some
other bourne there is
gladness; For what
good is this earth? Truly
there is another life in
the hereafter. There may
I go, there the sweet
birds sing, there may I
learn to know those
good flowers, those
sweet flowers, those
delicious ones, which
alone pleurably,
sweetly intoxicate,
which alone
pleurably, sweetly
intoxicate.

Notes for Song I

**II. XOPANCUICATL, OTONCUICATL,
TLAMELAUHCAYOTL.**

**II. A SPRING SONG,
AN OTOMI SONG, A
PLAIN SONG.**

1. Onihualcalac nicuicani nepapan
xochitlalpan, huel teellalquixtican,
tetlamachtican, oncan ahuach
tonameyoquiauhtimani, oncan cuicuica in
nepapan tlazototome, on cuicatlaza in
coyoltototl cahuantimani inin tozquitzin in
quellalquixtia in tloque in nahuaque yehuan
Dios, ohuaya, ohuaya.

2. Oncan nicaqui in cuicanelhuayotl in
nicuicani, tlacazo amo tlalticpac in peuh
yectli yancuicatl, tlacazo ompa in ilhuicatl
itic hual caquizti in conehua in
tlazocoyoltototl in quimehuilia in nepapan
teoquecholme zacuantototl, oncan tlacazo
quiyectenehua in tloque in nahuaque,
ohuaya, ohuaya.

1. I, the singer, have
entered many flower
gardens, places of
pleasance, favored
spots, where the dew
spread out its glittering
surface, where sang
various lovely birds,
where the coyol birds
let fall their song, and
spreading far around,
their voices rejoiced the
Cause of All, He who is
God, ohuaya! ohuaya!

2. It is there that I the
singer hear the very
essence of song;
certainly not on earth
has true poesy its birth;
certainly it is within the
heavens that one hears
the lovely coyol bird lift
its voice, that the
various quechol and
zacuan birds speak
together, there they
certainly praise the
Cause of All, ohuaya!
ohuaya!

3. Niyolpoxahua in nicaquia ni cuicani,
acoquiza in notlalnamiquilizo quin
pepetlatiquiza in ilhuicame, nelcicihuiliz
ehecayotih in iquinalquixtia in ompa
ontlatenehua in zacuanhuitzitzil in ilhuicatl
itic, ohuaya, ohuaya.

4. Auh nohuiampa nictlachialtia in noyollo
auh tlacazo nelli in amo ixquich quehua in
tlazotototl, tlacazo ye oc tlapanahuia in
ilhuicatl itic y yollo in tloque in nahuaque
mochiuhtica, ca intlacamo teuhytih in
notlalnamiquiliz azo huelquinalquixtica
ittazo in tlamahuizolli in ilhuicac ic
papaqui in ilhuicac tlazototome ixpan in
tloque nahuaque, ohuaya, ohuaya.

5. Quenin ah nichocaz in tlalticpac? ye
nican onca nemoayá ninoztlacahuia, nicitoa
aço zan ye ixquich in nican in tlalticpac
ontlamian toyolia, macuele ehuatl in tloque
in nahuaque, ma ompa inhuan

3. I, the singer, labor in
spirit with what I heard,
that it may lift up my
memory, that it may go
forth to those shining
heavens, that my sighs
may be borne on the
wind and be permitted
to enter where the
yellow humming bird
chants its praises in the
heavens, ohuaya!
ohuaya!

4. And as in my
thoughts I gaze around,
truly no such sweet bird
lifts its voice, truly the
things made for the
heavens by the Cause of
All surpass all others,
and unless my memory
tends to things divine
scarcely will it be
possible to penetrate
these and witness the
wondrous sights in
heaven, which rejoice
the sweet heavenly
birds before the face of
the Cause of All.

5. How much, alas,
shall I weep on earth?
Truly I have lived here
in vain illusion; I say
that whatever is here on

nimitznocuicatili in ilhuicac
mochanecahuan ca noyollo ehua ompa
nontlachia in monahuac in motloc
tipalnemohua, ohuaya, ohuaya.

earth must end with our
lives. May I be
permitted to sing to
thee, the Cause of All,
there in the heaven, a
dweller in thy mansion,
there may my soul lift
its voice and be seen
with Thee and near
Thee, Thou by whom
we live, ohuaya!
ohuaya!

6. Ma xicaquin nocuic in tinocniuh
xochihuehuetl inic tzotzonaya
ilhuicacuicatl in nicchuaya, ic
niquimellelquixtia in teteucti, xochicueponi
in noyollo izqui xochitl nictzetzelohuaya ic
malitiuh in no cuicatzin ixpan in tloque in
nahuaque, ohuaya, ohuaya.

6. List to my song, thou
my friend, and to the
flower-decked drum
which kept time to the
heavenly song which I
sang, that I might make
glad the nobles, raining
down before them the
flowery thoughts of my
heart as though they
were flowers, that my
noble song might grow
in glory before the face
of the Cause of All,
ohuaya! ohuaya!

[Notes for Song II](#)

III. OCCE AL MISMO TONO TLAMELAUHCAYOTL.

III. ANOTHER PLAIN SONG, TO THE SAME TUNE.

1. Xochicalco nihualcalaquia in nicuicani,
oncan icac in chalchiuhuehuetl, oncan
chialon ipalnemohuani in teteuctin xochitl
tztetzeluhtimani, tolquatectitla,
xoyacaltitlan, onahuiaxtimani in xochicopal
tlenamactli huel teyolquima, cahuia ca
ihuintia in toyollo ixpan in tloque in
nahuaque.

2. Ic motomá tocuic xochiahuia ca ihuinti
in toyollo? Aoc ticmati inic nepapan
xochicuicatl ic ticcecemeltia in tloque
nahuaque quen ahtontlaelehuian; tinocniuh
ma nohuehuetitlan ximoquetzaya nepapan
xochitl ic ximopanaya chalchiuh ocoxochitl
mocpac xicmanaya xicehuayan yectli
yancuicatl ic mehelquixtia in tloque in
nahuaque.

1. I, the singer, entered
into the house strewn
with flowers, where
stood upright the
emerald drum, where
awaiting the Giver of
Life the nobles strewed
flowers around, the
place where the head is
bowed for lustration,
the house of corrupt
odors, where the
burning fragrant
incense spreads and
penetrates, intoxicating
our souls in the
presence of the Cause
of All.

2. Where shall we
obtain the fragrance
which intoxicates our
souls? We do not yet
know the various
flower-songs with
which we may rejoice
the Cause of All,
however desirous we
are; thou my friend,
would that thou bring to
my instrument various
flowers, that thou
shouldst clothe it in
brilliant oco flowers,
that thou shouldst offer
them, and lift thy voice
in a new and worthy

3. Tleymach tiquilnamiquia can mach in
nemian moyollo ic timoyol cecenmanaya
ahuicpa tichuica timoyol popoloaya in
tlalticpac? Ca mach titlatiuh
xihualmocuepaya xiccaquin yectli
yancuicatl ximoyolciahuaya xochiaticaya
onahuiaxtimani oncan nicehuaya in yectli
yancuicatl nicuicani ic nicellelquixtia in
tloque in nahuaque.

4. Xihuallachian tinocniuh in oncan icayan
xochihuehuatl tonameyo ontotonauhtimani
quetzal ecacehuazticaya on xopaleuhtimani
in oncan ic chialo ic malhuilo inipetl in
icpal in tloque in nahuaque; xic cahuaya in
mixtecomatla xihualmocuepaya tohuan, xic
ehua in yancuicatl nicuicani ic
niquellelquixtia in tloque in tlaneciz inic
moyollo caltitlan.

song to rejoice the
Cause of All.

3. Wherefore should we
recall while the soul is
in life that our souls
must be scattered hither
and thither, and that
wherever we go we are
to be destroyed on
earth? Rather let us hide
it, turn from it, and
listen to some worthy
new song; delight thy
soul with the pervading
fragrance of flowers, as
I the singer lift my
voice in a new song that
I may rejoice the Cause
of All.

4. Come hither, thou my
friend, to where stands
the drum, decked with
flowers, gleaming with
brightness, green with
the outspread plumes of
the quetzal bird, where
are looked for and cared
for the seats near the
Cause of All; leave the
place of night and
clouds, turn hither with
us, lift thy voice in the
new song I sing so that
I may rejoice the Cause
of All, as the dawn

5. Tleçannen in nicyocoya in nitlaocolcuica
inic niquimilnamiqui in tepilhuan, in
tlazomaquiztin, in tlazoteoxiuhme, in
quetzaltotome, in moteyotico, in
motleyotico in tlalticpac? in ocnoma
caquizti inin tenyo, inin cahuanca, campa
neltiazque? Ca zan titlacatico ca ompa huel
tochan in canin ximoayan inocapa in
yolihuayan aic tlamian.

approaches in the house
of thy heart.

5. Of what use is it that
I frame my sad songs,
that I recall to mind the
youths, the beloved
children, the precious
relatives, the dear
friends, famous and
celebrated as they were
on earth? Who now
hears their fame, their
deeds? Where can they
find them? All of us are
but mortal, and our
home is there in the
Hereafter, where there
is life without end.

Notes for Song III

IV. MEXICA OTONCUICATL.

1. Nicchalchihuhtonameyopetlahuaya,
nictzinitzcanihuicaloaya, niquilnamiquia
nelhuayocuicatl, nic zacuanhuipanaya
yectli yancuicatl nicuicani,
nicchalchihuhtlazonenelo ic nichualnextia in
xochicueponallotl ic nicellelquixtia in
tloque in nahuaque.

IV. AN OTOMI SONG OF THE MEXICANS.

1. I, the singer, polished
my noble new song like
a shining emerald, I
arranged it like the
voice of the tzinitzcan
bird, I called to mind
the essence of poetry, I
set it in order like the
chant of the zacuan
bird, I mingled it with

the beauty of the
emerald, that I might
make it appear like a
rose bursting its bud, so
that I might rejoice the
Cause of All.

2. Zacuantlazoihuicaya tzinitzcan
tlaunquechol ic nicyaimatia, nocuicatzin
teocuitlatzitzilini nocuic nitoz; miahuatototl
nocuica cahuantimania, nicehuaya
xochitzetzelolpá ixpan in tloque nahuaque.

2. I skillfully arranged
my song like the lovely
feathers of the zacuan
bird, the tzinitzcan and
the quechol; I shall
speak forth my song
like the tinkling of
golden bells; my song is
that which the miaua
bird pours forth around
him; I lifted my voice
and rained down
flowers of speech
before the face of the
Cause of All.

3. Qualli cuicanelhuayotlo,
teocuitlaquiquizcopa nicehuaya, ilhuicac
cuicatlo nictenquixtia, nitoz miahuatototl,
chalciuhtonameyotica, niccueponaltia yectli
yancuicatlo, nicehuaya
xochitlenamaquilizticaya ic nitlaahuialia
nicuicani ixpan in tloque nahuaque.

3. In the true spirit of
song I lifted my voice
through a trumpet of
gold, I let fall from my
lips a celestial song, I
shall speak notes
precious and brilliant as
those of the miaua bird,
I shall cause to blossom
out a noble new song, I
lifted my voice like the
burning incense of
flowers, so that I the
singer might cause joy

before the face of the
Cause of All.

4. Teoquecholme nechnananquilia in
nicuicani coyolicahuacaya yectli
yacuicatlan, cozcapedtaticaya
chachalchiuhquetzalitztonameyo
xopaleuhtimania xopan xochicuiatl
onilhuica ahuiaxtimanio, xochiahuachtitlan
nihualcuicaya nicuicani.

4. The divine quechol
bird answers me as I,
the singer, sing, like the
coyol bird, a noble new
song, polished like a
jewel, a turquoise, a
shining emerald, darting
green rays, a flower
song of spring,
spreading celestial
fragrance, fresh with
the dews of roses, thus
have I the poet sung.

5. Nictlapalimatia nicxoxochineloaya yectli
yancuicatlan cozcapedtaticaya, etc.

5. I colored with skill, I
mingled choice roses in
a noble new song,
polished like a jewel,
etc. (as in v. 4).

6. Nocontimaloaya nocontlamachtiao
xochiteyolquima cuicatlan poyomapoctli ic
ye ahuiān ye noyollo,
nihualyolcucuechahuaya, nicinecuia
ahuiāca, xocomiqui in noyolia, nicinecuia
yectliya xochitla netlamachtilyan, xochi
ye ihuinti noyolia.

6. I was glorified, I was
enriched, by the flower-
sweet song as by the
smoke of the poyomatl,
my soul was contented,
I trembled in spirit, I
inhaled the sweetness,
my soul was
intoxicated, I inhaled
the fragrance of
delicious flowers in the
place of riches, my soul
was drunken with the
flowers.

[Notes for Song IV](#)

**V. OTRO MEXICA
TLAMELAUHCACUICAYOTL.**

1. Zanio in xochitl tonequimilol, zanio in
cuicatl ic huehuetzi in teller in Dios ye
mochan.

2. In mach noca ompolihuiz in cohuayotl
mach noca in icniuhyotl in ononoya in ye
ichan; ye nio Yoyontzin on cuicatillano ye
ipalnemohuani.

3. Ma xiuhquechol xochi, zan in tzinitzcan
malintoca zan miqui huaqui xochitl zan ic
tonmoquimilola can titlatoani ya ti
Nezahualcoyotl.

4. Ma yan moyoliuh quimati in antepilhuan
in anquauhtin amo celo ca mochipan
titocnihuan, zancuel achic nican
timochitonyazque o ye ichano.

**V. ANOTHER PLAIN
SONG OF THE
MEXICANS.**

1. I alone will clothe
thee with flowers, mine
alone is the song which
casts down our grief
before God in thy
house.

2. True it is that my
possessions shall perish,
my friendships, their
home and their house;
thus I, O Yoyontzin,
pour forth songs to the
Giver of Life.

3. Let the green quechol
birds, let the tzinitzcan
twine flowers for us,
only dying and withered
flowers, that we may
clothe thee with
flowers, thou ruler, thou
Nezahualcoyotl.

4. Ye youths and ye
braves, skilled in
wisdom, may you alone
be our friends, while for

5. Ca ye ompolihuiz in moteyo Nopiltzin, ti Tezozomoctli áca cá ye in mocuica? aye a nihualchocao ca nihualicnotlamatica notia ye ichan.

6. An ca nihuallaocoya onicnotlamati ayo quico, ayoc quemanian, namech aitlaquiuh in tlalticpac y icanontia ye ichan.

Notes for Song V

VI. OTRO CHALCAYOTL, CANTO DE TETLEPAN QUETZANITZIN.

1. Aua nocnihue ninentlamatia zan ninochoquilia in monahuac aya yehuan Dios, quexquich onmitzicnotlamachtia momacehual cemamanahuac ontonitlanililo in ic tontlahuica tontecemilhuilitia in tlalticpac.

a moment here we shall enjoy this house.

5. For thy fame shall perish, Nopiltzin, and thou, Tezozomoc, where are thy songs? No more do I cry aloud, but rest tranquil that ye have gone to your homes.

6. Ye whom I bewailed, I know nevermore, never again; I am sad here on earth that ye have gone to your homes.

VI. ANOTHER CHALCO-SONG, A POEM OF TETLEPAN QUETZANITZIN.

1. Alas, my friend, I was afflicted, I cried aloud on thy account to God. How much compassion hast thou for thy servant in this world sent here by thee to be thy subject for the

2. Macazo tleon xoconyoyocoya ti noyollo,
yehua cuix ic nepohualoyan in oncan
nemohua yehua, in atle tlahuelli in
antecocolia huel on yecnemiz in tlalticpac.

3. In quimati noyollo nichoca yehua huel
eza ye nelli in titicnihuan, huellenelli
nemoa in tlalticpac in tonicniuh tlatzihuiz
yehuan Dios.

4. Xontlachayan huitztlampayan, iquizayan
in tonatiuh, ximoyollehuayan oncan manian
teoatl tlachinolli, oncan mocuica in teucyotl
in tlatocayotl yectliya xochitl in amo
zannen mocuia, in quetzallalpilo niaya
macquauhtica, chimaltica neicaloloyan in
tlalticpac ic momacehuaya in yectliya
xochitl in tiquelehuia in ticnequia in
tinocniuh in quitemacehualtia in
quitenemactia in tloque in nahuaque.

space of a day on this
earth!

2. However that may
be, mayst thou so
dispose my heart, that it
may pass through this
place of reckoning,
without anger, without
injury, and live a good
life on earth.

3. My heart knows how
truly I weep for my
friend, how truly as it
lives on earth it cries
aloud for thee, my
friend, to God.

4. Let thy soul awake
and turn toward the
south, toward the rising
of the sun, rouse thy
heart that it turn toward
the field of battle, there
let it win power and
fame, the noble flowers
which it will not grasp
in vain; adorned with a
frontlet of quetzal
feathers I went forth
armed with sword and
shield to the battlefield
on earth, that I might
merit these noble
flowers with which we
may rejoice as we wish

5. Nentiquelehuia in tictemoaya in
tinocniuh yectliya xochitl can ticuiz
intlacamo ximicaliya, melchiquiuhcaya,
mitonalticaya ticmacehuaya in
yectli yaxochitla, yaochoquiztli ixayoticaya
in quitemacehualtica in tloque in nahuaque.

our friends, as the
Cause of All may
reward and grant to us.

5. Vainly, O friends, do
we desire and seek
where we may cull
those noble flowers
unless we fight with
bared breasts, with the
sweat of the brow,
meriting these noble
flowers, in bitter and
painful war, for which
the Cause of All will
give reward.

Notes for Song VI

VII. OTRO.

1. Tleinmach oamaxque on in antocnihuan
in an Chiapaneca Otomi, omachamelelacic:
in ic oamihuintiqueo octicatl in oanquique
ic oamihuintique, xicualcuican, in amo ma
in anhuehuetztoqueo, ximozcalicano in
antocnihuan nipatiazque in tochano,
xopantlalpan ye nican, ma quiza in
amihuintiliz, on xitlachiacano ohuican ye
anmaquia, O!

VII. ANOTHER.

1. What have you done,
O you our friends, you
Chiapanecs and Otomis,
why have you grieved,
that you were drunken
with the wine which
you took, that you were
drunken? Come hither
and sing: do not lie
stretched out; arise, O
friends, let us go to our
houses here in this land
of spring; come forth
from your drunkenness,

2. Ca yeppa yuhqui in tizaoctli in tlalticpac,
quitemacao ohuican ic tecalaquiao teoatl
tlachinolli quitoao texaxamatza
teopopoloao on canin xaxamano in
tlazochalchihiuitl, in teoxihuitl, in
maquitzli tlazotetl in tepilhuan in coninio in
xochitizaoctlio cuet can in antocnihuan in
tonicahuacao.

3. Ma ye ticiti in xochitlalpan in tochan
xochitlalticpacilhuicacpaco in huet ic
xochiamemeyallotl on ahuiaxtimani,
teyolquima yoliliz ahuah xochitl in tochan
in Chiappan, oncan timalolo in teucyotl in
tlatocayotl in chimalxochitl
oncuepontimani tonacatlalpan.

see in what a difficult
place you must take it.

2. For formerly it was
so on earth that the
white wine was taken in
difficult places, as on
entering the battlefield,
or, as it was said, where
the stones were broken
and destroyed, where
were broken into
fragments the lovely
emeralds, the
turquoises, the honored
precious stones, the
youths, the children;
therefore take the
flowery white wine, O
friends and brothers.

3. Let us drink it in the
flowery land, in our
dwelling surrounded by
the flowery earth and
sky, where the fountains
of the flowers send their
sweetness abroad; the
delicious breath of the
dewy flowers is in our
homes in Chiapas; there
nobility and power
make them glorious,
and the war-flowers
bloom over a fertile
land.

4. Quemach in amo antlacaquio in
antocnihuan tohuian tohuiano xicahuacano,
in tizaoctlio teotlachinolotli; ma ye ticitl
in ompa tinectilo in tochan
xochiahuachotli, zan ic ahuiaca ihuinti in
toyollo, tetlamachtio teyolquimao
tixochiachichinatihui netlamachtilyan in
toquizayan xochitlalpan tonacatlalpan:
tlemach oamaxqueo? xichualcaquican in
tocuic in tamocnihuan, etc.

4. Is it possible, oh
friends, that you do not
hear us? Let us go, let
us go, let us pour forth
the white wine, the
wine of battle; let us
drink where the wine
sweet as the dew of
roses is set forth in our
houses, let our souls be
intoxicated with its
sweetness; enriched,
steeped in delight, we
shall soak up the water
of the flowers in the
place of riches, going
forth to a land of
flowers, a fertile spot.
What have you done?
Come hither and listen
to our songs, O friends.

Notes for Song VII

VIII. OTRO, QUEUH CE TLATOHUANI IN QUIMILNAMIQUI IN TLATOQUE.

1. Tlaocolxochi ixayoticaya ic nichuipana
in nocuic nicuicani, niquimilnamiqui in
tepillhuan, in teintoque, in tlaçotitoque in
campa in ximohuaya, in oteuctico, in
otlatocatico in tlallia icpac, in
quetzalhuahuaciuhtoque in

VIII. COMPOSED BY A CERTAIN RULER IN MEMORY OF FORMER RULERS.

1. Weeping, I, the
singer, weave my song
of flowers of sadness; I
call to memory the
youths, the shards, the
fragments, gone to the

chalchiuhteintoque in tepilhuan, in maoc
imixpan in maoc oquitlani; in ye itto in
tlalticpac iximachoca in tloque in
nahuaque.

2. Y yo ya hue nitlaocolcuicaya in
niquimilnamiqui in tepilhuan, ma zan itla
ninocuepa, ma niquimonana, ma
niquinhualquixti in ompa in ximoayan, ma
oc oppa tihua in tlalticpac, ma oc
quimahuizoqui in tepilhuan in ticmahuizoa,
azo huel yehuantin tlatlazomahuizozquia in
ipalnemohualoni, quemmach tomazehual in
tlazaniuh ticmatican in ticnopillahueliloque
ic choca in noyollo nino tlalnamiquiliz
huipana in nicuicani choquiztica tlaocoltica
nitlalnamiquia.

land of the dead; once
noble and powerful here
on earth, the youths
were dried up like
feathers, were split into
fragments like an
emerald, before the face
and in the sight of those
who saw them on earth,
and with the knowledge
of the Cause of All.

2. Alas! alas! I sing in
grief as I recall the
children. Would that I
could turn back again;
would that I could grasp
their hands once more;
would that I could call
them forth from the
land of the dead; would
that we could bring
them again on earth,
that they might rejoice
and we rejoice, and that
they might rejoice and
delight the Giver of
Life; is it possible that
we His servants should
reject him or should be
ungrateful? Thus I weep
in my heart as I, the
singer, review my
memories, recalling
things sad and grievous.

3. Manozo zan nicmati in nechcaquizque
intla itla yectli cuicatl niquimehuili in ompa
ximohuayan, ma ic niquipapacti, ma ic
niquimacotlaza inin tenez inin
chichinaquiliz in tepilhuan. Cuix on
machiaz? Quennel nihualnellaquahua?
Aquen manian ompa niquimontocaz? Ano
niquin nonotztaciz in ye yuh quin in
tlalticpac.

3. Would only that I
knew they could hear
me, there in the land of
the dead, were I to sing
some worthy song.
Would that I could
gladden them, that I
could console the
suffering and the
torment of the children.
How can it be learned?
Whence can I draw the
inspiration? They are
not where I may follow
them; neither can I
reach them with my
calling as one here on
earth.

Notes for Song VIII

IX. OTRO TLAOCOLCUICA OTOMITL. IX. AN OTOMI SONG OF SADNESS.

1. In titloque in tinahuaque
nimitzontlaocolnonotzaya, nelcicihuiliz
mixpantzinco noconiyahuaya, ninentlamati
in tlalticpac ye nican nitlatematia,
ninotolinia, in ayc onotechacic in pactli, in
necuiltonolli ye nican; tlezannen naicoyc
amo y mochiuhyān, tlaçazo atle nican
xotlacueponi in nentlamachtillia, tlaçazo
zan ihuian in motloc in monahuac;
Macuelehuatl ma xicmonequilti ma
monahuactzinco oc ehuiti in noyolia,

1. To thee, the Cause of
All, to thee I cried out
in sadness, my sighs
rose up before thy face;
I am afflicted here on
earth, I suffer, I am
wretched, never has joy
been my lot, never good
fortune; my labor has
been of no avail,
certainly nothing here

ninixayohuatzaz in motloc monahuac
tipalnemohuani.

lessens one's suffering;
truly only to be with
thee, near thee; may it
be thy will that my soul
shall rise to thee, may I
pour out my tears to
thee, before thee, O
thou Giver of Life.

2. Quemachamiqueo in motimalotinemi co
y in tlalticpac in ayac contenmatio in
atlamachilizneque o tlacazo can moztla
cahuia on in āmitztenmati in titloque in
tinahuaque inic momatio ca mochipa
tlalticpac, nemizqueo ninotlamatli
motlaliao niquimittao, tlacazo mixitl tlapatl
oquiqueo ic nihualnelaquahua in
ninotolinia o tlacazo ompa in ximohuayan
neittotiu h o, cazo tiquenamiqueo quiniquac
ye pachihuiz ye teyolloa.

2. Happy are those who
walk in thy favor here
on earth, who never
neglect to offer up
praise, nor, leaving till
to-morrow, neglect
thee, thou Cause of All,
that thou mayest be
known in all the earth; I
know that they shall
live, I see that they are
established, certainly
they have drunk to
forgetfulness while I am
miserable, certainly I
shall go to see the land
of the dead, certainly
we shall meet where all
souls are contented.

3. Ma cayac quen quichihuaya in iyollo in
tlalticpac ye nican in titlaocaxtinemi in
tichocatinemia, ca zacuel achic ontlanizoo,
tlacazo zan tontlatocatihuio in yuho
otlatocatque tepilhuan, ma ic ximixcuiti in
tinocniuh in atonahuia in atihuelamati in
tlalticpac o; ma oc ye ximāpana in
tlaocolxochitl, choquizxochitl,

3. Never were any
troubled in spirit on the
earth who appealed to
thee, who cried to thee,
only for an instant were
they cast down, truly
thou caused them to
rule as they ruled

xoyocatimalo o xochielcicihuiliztlio in
ihuicpa toconiyahuazon in tloque in
nahuaque.

4. Ica ye ninapanao tlaocolxochicozcatlon,
nomac ommanian
elcicihuilizchimàlxochitlon, nic ehuaya in
tlaocolcuicatloo,
nicchalchiuhcocahuicomana yectli
yancuicatl, nic ahuachxochilacatzoa, yn o
chalchiuhuehueuhilhuitl, itech nictlaxilotia
in nocuicatzin in nicuicani ye niquincuilia
in ilhuicac chanequeo zacuantototl,
quetzaltzinitzcantototl teoquechol inon
tlātoa quechol in qui cecemeltia in tloque,
etc.

before: Take as an
example on earth, O
friend, the fever-
stricken patient; clothe
thysself in the flowers of
sadness, in the flowers
of weeping, give praises
in flowers of sighs that
may carry you toward
the Cause of All.

4. I array myself with
the jewels of saddest
flowers; in my hands
are the weeping flowers
of war; I lift my voice
in sad songs; I offer a
new and worthy song
which is beautiful and
melodious; I weave
songs fresh as the dew
of flowers; on my drum
decked with precious
stones and plumes I, the
singer, keep time to my
song, as I take it from
those dwellers in the
heavens, the zacuan
bird, the beautiful
tzinitzcan, the divine
quechol, those
melodious birds who
give joy to the Cause of
All.

[Notes for Song IX](#)

***X. MEXICA XOPANCUICATL
TLAMELAUHCAYOTL.***

1. Tlaocoya in noyollo nicuicanitl
nicnotlamatia, yehua za yey xochitl y zan
ye in cuicatlin, ica nitlacocoa in tlalticpac
ye nican, ma nequitocan intech cocolia
intech miquitlani moch ompa onyazque
cano y ichan, ohuaya.

2. I inquemanian in otonciahuic, in
otontlatzihuic tocon ynayaz in momahuizco
in motenyo in tlalticpac, ma nenquitocane,
ohuaya, etc.

3. Inin azan oc huelnemohuan in tlalticpac
mazano ihuian yehuan Dios quinquac
onnetemoloa in tiaque in canin ye ichan,
ohuaya.

4. Hu inin titotolinia ma yuhquitimiquican
ma omochiuh in mantech onittocan in
tocnihuan in matech onahuacan in quauhtin
y a ocelotl.

***X. A SPRING SONG
OF THE MEXICANS,
A PLAIN SONG.***

1. My heart grieved, I,
the singer, was afflicted,
that these are the only
flowers, the only songs
which I can procure
here on earth; see how
they speak of sickness
and of death, how all go
there to their homes,
alas.

2. Sometimes thou hast
toiled and acquired
skill, thou takest refuge
in thy fame and renown
on earth; but see how
vain they speak, alas.

3. As many as live on
earth, truly they go to
God when they descend
to the place where are
their homes, alas.

4. Alas, we miserable
ones, may it happen
when we die that we
may see our friends,
that we may be with

5. Mazo quiyocoli macaoc xictemachican,
can antlahuicaya y caya amechmotlatili in
ipalnemohuani, ohuaya.

6. Ay ya yo xicnotlamatican Tezcacoacatl,
Atecpanecatl mach nel amihuihuinti in
cozcatl in chalchihuitli, ma ye anmonecti,
ma ye antlaneltocati.

Notes for Song X

XI. OTRO.

1. Nicchocaehua, nicnotlamati,
nicelnamiqui ticauchtehuazque yectliya
xochitl yectli yancuicatl; ma
ohtonahuiacan, ma oc toncuicacan cen
tiyahui tipolihui ye ichan, etc.

2. Achtleon ah yuhquimati in tocnihuan
cocoya in noyollo qualani yehua ay oppan

them in grandeur and
strength.

5. Although He is the
Creator, do not hope
that the Giver of Life
has sent you and has
established you.

6. Be ye grieved, ye of
Tezcucuo and Atecpan,
that ye are intoxicated
with gems and precious
stones; come forth to
the light, come and
believe.

XI. ANOTHER.

1. I lift my voice in
wailing, I am afflicted,
as I remember that we
must leave the beautiful
flowers, the noble
songs; let us enjoy
ourselves for a while,
let us sing, for we must
depart forever, we are to
be destroyed in our
dwelling place.

2. Is it indeed known to
our friends how it pains

in tlacatihua ye ay oppa piltihuaye yece
yequi xoantlalticpac.

and angers me that
never again can they be
born, never again be
young on this earth?

3. Oc achintzinca y tetloc ye nican
tenahuacan aic yezco on aic nahuiatz aic
nihuelamatiz.

3. Yet a little while with
them here, then
nevermore shall I be
with them, nevermore
enjoy them, nevermore
know them.

4. In can on nemian noyollo yehua? Can
huel ye nochan? Can huel nocallamanian?
Ninotolinia tlalticpac.

4. Where shall my soul
dwell? Where is my
home? Where shall be
my house? I am
miserable on earth.

5. Zan ye tocontemaca ye tocontotoma in
mochalchiuh, ye on quetzalimalintoc,
zacuan icpac xochitl, za yan tiquinmacayan
tepilhuan O.

5. We take, we unwind
the jewels, the blue
flowers are woven over
the yellow ones, that we
may give them to the
children.

6. In nepapan xochitl conquimilo, conihuiti
ye noyollo niman nichocaya ixpan niauh in
tonan.

6. Let my soul be
draped in various
flowers; let it be
intoxicated by them, for
soon must I weeping go
before the face of our
mother.

7. Zan nocolhuia: ipalnemohua ma ca ximozoma, ma ca ximonenequin tlalticpac, mazo tehuantin motloc tinemican y, zan ca ye moch ana ilhuicatlitica.

8. Azo tle nello nicyaitohua nican ipalnemohua, zan tontemiqui y, zan toncochitlehuaco, nicitoa in tlalticpac ye ayac huel tontiquilhuia ye nicana.

9. In manel ye chalchihuitl, mantlamatilolli, on aya mazo ya ipalnemohuani ayac hueltic ilhuia nicana.

7. This only do I ask:—
Thou Giver of Life, be
not angry, be not severe
on earth, let us live with
thee on earth, take us to
the Heavens.

8. But what can I speak
truly here of the Giver
of Life? We only dream,
we are plunged in sleep;
I speak here on earth;
but never can we speak
in worthy terms here.

9. Although it may be
jewels and precious
ointments (of speech),
yet of the Giver of Life,
one can never here
speak in worthy terms.

Notes for Song XI

XII. XOPANCUICATL NENONOTZALCUICATL IPAMPA IN AQUIQUE AMO ON MIXTILIA IN YAOC.

1. Nictzotzonan nohuehueuh
nicuicatlamatquetl ic niquimonixitia ic
niquimitlehua in tocnihuan in atle in yollo

XII. A SPRING SONG, A SONG OF EXHORTATION, BECAUSE CERTAIN ONES DID NOT GO TO THE WAR.

1. I strike on my drum,
I the skillful singer, that
I may arouse, that I may

quimati in aic tlathui ipan inin yollo
yaocochmictoque in inpan motimaloa in
mixtecomatlayohualli anen niquito huay
motolinia y, maquicaqui qui y
xochitlathuicacuicatl occeh tzetzeuhtimania
huehuetitlana, ohuaya, ohuai.

fire our friends, who
think of nothing, to
whose minds plunged in
sleep the dawn has not
appeared, over whom
are yet spread the dark
clouds of night; may I
not call in vain and
poorly, may they hear
this song of the rosy
dawn, poured abroad
widely by the drum,
ohe! ohe!

2. Tlahuizcalteochitla oncuepontimani in
ixochiquiyaopan in tloque in nahuaque,
onahuachtotonameyotimani in teyolquima;
ma xiquilitacan in atle ipan ontlatao,
zannen cuepontimanio ayac mahaca
quelehuiao in antocnihuan amo zannen ya
xochitl yoliliztlapalneucxochitla e.

2. The divine flowers of
dawn blossom forth, the
war flowers of the
Cause of All; glittering
with dew they scatter
abroad their fragrance;
bring them hither that
they be not hidden nor
bloom in vain, that they
may rejoice you our
friends, and not in vain
shall be the flowers, the
living, colored, brilliant
flowers.

3. Quiyolcaihuintiaya in teyolia, zan oncan
ye omania, zan oncan ye oncuepontimania
quauhtepetitlan in ya hualihcancopa y
ixtlahuatlitica oncan inemaya oc teoatl
tlachinolli a. Oncan in epoyahuayan in
teoquauhtli oncan iquiquinacayan, in
ocelotl, ipixauhyan in nepapan
tlazomaquiztetl, in emomolotzayan in

3. They intoxicate the
soul, but they are only
found, they blossom
only on the lofty
mountains, on the broad
plains where glorious
war finds its home.
There is where the

nepapan tlazopilihuitl, oncan teintoque
oncan xamantoque in tepilhuan.

eagles gather in bands
of sixties, there the
tigers roar, there the
various beloved stones
rain down, there the
various dear children
are cut to pieces; there
the youths are split into
shards and ground into
fragments.

4. Tlacuah yehuantin in tepilhuani
conelehuiao, in tlahuizcalxochitlan ya
nemamallihuao ic tetlanēnectiao, in
ilhuicac onoc on iceolitzin yn iotepiltzina
quitzetzelotimania a in tepilhuan in
quauhtliya ocelotl, in quimemactiao in
xochicueponalotlon in quimihuintia
yeyolxochiahuechtia.

4. Stoutly do those
youths rejoice, laboring
for the rose of the dawn
that they may win it;
and in heaven, He, the
only one, the noble one,
pours down upon the
youths strength and
courage, that they may
pluck the budding
flowers of the pathway,
that they may be
intoxicated with the
dew-damp flowers of
the spirit.

5. In ic timomatia in tinocniuh zan ne yan
xochitlon in tiquelehuiaon in tlalticpac,
quen toconcuizon quen ticyachihuazon,
timotolinia in tiquimiztlacoa a in tepilhuan
xochitica cuicatica; ma xihuallachican in
atle y ica mitl, ehuaon zan moch yehuantin
in tepilhuan
zacuanmeteoquecholtitzinitzcatlatlahuquec
holtin moyeh yectitinemio in onmatio in
ixtlahuatlitan.

5. Know, my friend,
that these are the only
flowers which will give
thee pleasure on earth;
mayest thou take them
and make them; O poor
one, search out for thy
children these flowers
and songs. Look not
hither without arrows,

6. Chimalxochitl, quauhpilolxochitl ic
oquichtlamatimani in y antepilhuan
xochicozcaocoxochitl ic mapantimani,
quitimaloao yectliya cuicatl, yectliya
xochitl, imezo imelchiquih patiuh
mochihuaya in quicelia on in teotl
tlachinolli; y iantocnihuan tiliuhquitepeca
in tiyaotehua huey otlipana, ma huel
xoconmanao y ye mochimalo, huel
xonicaon in ti quauhtliya ocelotla.

let all the youths lift up
their voices, like zacuan
birds, divine quechols,
tzinitzcans, and red
quechols, who live
joyous lives, and know
the fields.

6. O youths, here there
are skilled men in the
flowers of shields, in
the flowers of the
pendant eagle plumes,
the yellow flowers
which they grasp; they
pour forth noble songs,
noble flowers; they
make payment with
their blood, with their
bare breasts; they seek
the bloody field of war.
And you, O friends, put
on your black paint, for
war, for the path of
victory; let us lay hands
on our shields, and raise
aloft our strength and
courage.

[Notes for Song XII](#)

XIII. HUEXOTZINCAYOTL.

XIII. A SONG OF HUEXÔTZINCO.

1. Zan tlaocolxochitl, tlaocolcuicatl on
mania Mexico nican ha in Tlatilolco, in
yece ye oncan on neiximachoyan, ohuaya.

2. Ixamayo yectli in zan ca otitech icneli
ipalnemohuani, in za can tipopolihuizque in
timacehualta, ohuaya.

3. Ototlahueliltic, zan titotolinia
timacehualtinquezo huel tehuantin,
otiquittaque in cococ ye machoyan, ohuaya.

4. Ticmomoyahua, ticxoxocoyan in
momacehualy in Tlatilolco cococ moteca
cococ ye machoyan ye ic ticiahuia
ipalnemoani, ohuaya.

5. Choquiztli moteca ixayotl pixahui oncan
a in Tlatilolco; in atlan yahqueon o in
Mexica ye cihua nelihui ica yehuilo a
oncan ontihui in tocnihuan a, ohuaya.

1. Only sad flowers, sad
songs, are here in
Mexico, in Tlatilolco, in
this place these alone
are known, alas.

2. It is well to know
these, if only we may
please the Giver of Life,
lest we be destroyed,
we his subjects, alas.

3. We have angered
Him, we are only
wretched beings, slaves
by blood; we have seen
and known affliction,
alas.

4. We are disturbed, we
are embittered, thy
servants here in
Tlatilolco, deprived of
food, made acquainted
with affliction, we are
fatigued with labor, O
Giver of Life, alas.

5. Weeping is with us,
tears fall like rain, here
in Tlatilolco; as the
Mexican women go
down to the water, we
beg of them for
ourselves and our
friends, alas.

6. In ic neltic o ya cahua Atloyantepetl o in Mexico in poctli ehuatoc ayahuitl onmantoc, in tocon ya chihuaya ipalnemoani, ohuaya.

7. In an Mexica ma xiquilnamiquican o yan zan topan quitemohuia y ellelon i mahuizo yehuan zan yehuan Dios, yehua anquin ye oncan in coyonacazco, ohuaya.

8. Za can ye oncan zan quichoquiz tlapaloa o anquihuitzmanatl incan yeŭch motelchiuh on ya o anquin ye mochin, ha in tlayotlaqui, ah in tlacotzin, ah in tlacateuctli in oquichtzin y huihui ica ça ye con yacauhqui in Tenochtitlan, ohuaya.

9. In antocnihuan ma xachocacan aya ma xăconmatican ica ye ticcauhque Mexicayotl huiya, zan ye yatł chichixhuiya no zan ye tlaqualli chichixaya zan con aya chiuahqui in ipalnemoani ha in Tlatilolco y, ohuaya.

6. Even as the smoke, rising, lies in a cloud over Mount Atloyan, in Mexico, so does it happen unto us, O Giver of Life, alas.

7. And you Mexicans, may you remember concerning us when you descend and suffer before the majesty of God, when there you shall howl like wolves.

8. There, there will be only weeping as your greeting when you come, there you will be accursed, all of you, workers in filth, slaves, rulers or warriors, and thus Tenochtitlan will be deserted.

9. Oh friends, do not weep, but know that sometime we shall have left behind us the things of Mexico, and then their water shall be made bitter and their food shall be made bitter, here in Tlatilolco, as never before, by the Giver of Life.

10. Tel ah zan yhuian huicoque hon in
motelchihuitzin ha in tlacotzin zan mocuica
ellaquauhque ac achinanco in ahiquac in
tlepan quixtiloto in coyohuacan, ohuaya.

10. The disdained and
the slaves shall go forth
with song; but in a little
while their oppressors
shall be seen in the fire,
amid the howling of
wolves.

[Notes for Song XIII](#)

XIV.

1. Zan tzinitzcan impetlatl ipan, ohuaya; on
tzinitzcan iceliztoca oncan izan in
ninentlamatia, in zan icnoxochicuicatica
inocon ya temohua ya ohuaya, ohuaya.

2. In canin nemiya icanon in nemitconchia
ye nican huehuetitlan a ayiahue, ye
onnentlamacho, ye mocatlaocoyalo ay
xopancaliteca, ohuaya, ohuaya.

3. Ac ipiltzin? Achanca ipiltzin yehuayan
Dios Jesu Christo can quicuilo antlacuiloa
quicuilo ancuicatl a ohuaya, ohuaya.

4. O achan canel ompa huiz canin ilhuicac
y xochintlacuilo xochincalitec a ohuaya
ohuaya.

XIV.

1. Only the tzinitzcan is
in power, the tzinitzcan
arouses me in my
affliction, letting fall its
songs like sad flowers.

2. Wherever it wanders,
wherever it lives, one
awaits it here with the
drum, in affliction, in
distress, here in the
house of spring.

3. Who is the royal son?
Is not the royal son, the
son of God, Jesus
Christ, as was written in
your writings, as was
written in your songs?

4. Is not the flowery
writing within the house
of flowers that he shall

5. In ma ontlachialoya in ma
ontlātlamahuicolo in tlapapalcalimanican y
ipalnemoa y tlayocol yehuan Dios, ohuaya.

6. Tectolinian techtlātlanectia y
icuicaxochiamilpan, intechontlātlachialtian
ipalnemohua itlayocol yehuan Dios a
ohuaya.

7. Ya ixopantla ixopantlatinenemi ye nican
ixtlahuatl yteey, za xihquechol quiahuitl
zan topan xaxamacay in atlixco ya ohuaya,
ohuaya.

8. Zan ye nauhcampay ontlapepetlantoc,
oncan onceliztoc in cozauihxochitl, oncan
nemi in Mexica in tepilhuan a ohuaya
ohuaya.

come there from
heaven?

5. Look around and
wonder at this scene of
many colored houses
which God has created
and endowed with life.

6. They make us who
are miserable to see the
light among the flowers
and songs of the fertile
fields, they cause us to
see those things which
God has created and
endowed with life.

7. They dwell in the
place of spring, in the
place of spring, here
within the broad fields,
and only for our sakes
does the turquoise-
water fall in broken
drops on the surface of
the lake.

8. Where it gleams forth
in fourfold rays, where
the fragrant yellow
flowers bud, there live
the Mexicans, the
youths.

***XV. TEZOZOMOCTLI IC MOTECPAC. XV. THE REIGN OF
TEZOZOMOCTLI.***

1. Zan ca tzihuactitlan, mizquititlan,
aiyahue Chicomoztocpa, mochi ompa
yahuitze antlātohuan ye nican, ohuaya,
ohuaya.

2. Nican momalinaco in colcahuahtecpillotl
huiya nican milacatzoa in Colhuaca
Chichimecayotl in toteuchuahua.

3. Ma oc achitzinca xomotlanecuican
antepilhuan huiya tlacateuhtzin
Huitzilihuitl a ya cihuacoatl y Quauhxilotl
huia totomihuacan Tlalnahuacatl aya zan ca
xiuhtototl Ixtlilxochitl y quenman tlatzihuiz
quimohmoyahuaquih yauh y tepeuh
yehuan Dios ica ye choca Tezozomocitli
ohuaya ohuaya.

4. Yenoceppa mizquitl yacahuantimani
Hueytlalpani, anquican itlatol yehuan Dios
a ohuaya, ohuaya.

1. From the land of the
tzihuac bushes, from
the land of the mezquite
bushes, where was
ancient Chicomoztoc,
thence came all your
rulers hither.

2. Here unrolled itself
the royal line of
Colhuacan, here our
nobles of Colhuacan,
united with the
Chichimecs.

3. Sing for a little while
concerning these, O
children, the sovereign
Huitzilihuitl, the judge
Quauhxilotl, of our bold
leader Tlalnahuacatl, of
the proud bird
Ixtlilxochitl, those who
went forth, and
conquered and ruled
before God, and bewail
Tezozomocitli.

4. A second time they
left the mezquite bushes

5. Can onyeyauh xochitl, can oyeyauh yeh
intoca quauhtli ocelotl huia ya moyahuaya
xelihuia Atloyantepetl Hueytlalpan y
anquizan itlatol ipalnemohua ohuaya
ohuaya.

6. Oncuiltonoloc, onechtlachtiloc, in
teteuctin cemanahuac y huel zotoca
huipantoca y tlātol ipalnemohuani, huel
quimothuitico, huel quiximatico y yollo
yehuan Dios huiya chalchihuitl maquiztliya
tlamatelolliya tizatla ihuitla za xochitl
quimatico yaoyotla ohuaya ohuaya.

7. Oya in Tochin y miec acalcatli,
Acolmiztlan teuctli zan Catocih teuctli
Yohuallatonoc y yehuan Cuetzpaltzin
Iztaccoyotl totomihuacan Tlaxcallan
ohuaye Coatziteuctli Huitlalotzin za xochitl
quimatico yaoyotla ohuaya ohuaya.

in Hue Tlalpan, obeying
the order of God.

5. They go where are
the flowers, where they
may gain grandeur and
power, dividing asunder
they leave the mountain
Atloyan and Hue
Tlalpan, obeying the
order of the Giver of
Life.

6. It is cause of
rejoicing, that I am
enabled to see our
rulers from all parts
gathering together,
arranging in order the
words of the Giver of
Life, and that their souls
are caused to see and to
know that God is
precious, wonderful, a
sweet ointment, and
that they are known as
flowers of wise counsel
in the affairs of war.

7. There were Tochin,
with many boats, the
noble Acolmiztlan, the
noble Catocih,
Yohuallatonoc, and
Cuetzpaltzin, and
Iztaccoyotl, bold
leaders from Tlaxcalla,

8. Tley an quiyocoya anteteuctin y
Huexotzinca? ma xontlachiacan
Acolihuācan in quatlapanca oncan ye
Huexotla itztapallocan huia yeyahuatimani
Atloyantepetl a ohuaya.

9. Oncan in pochotl ahuehuetl oncan icaca
mizquitl ye oztotlhuiā tetlaquahuac
quimatia ipalnemohuani oyao ai ya hue
ohuaya.

10. Tlacateotl nopiltzin Chichimecatl y
tleonmach itla techcocolia Tezozomochtli
tech in micitlani ye ehuaya atayahuili
quinequia yaoyotl necaliztton quima
Acolhuacan ohuaya.

and Coatziteuctli, and
Huitlalotzin, famed as
flowers on the field of
battle.

8. For what purpose do
you make your rulers,
men of Huexotzinco?
Look at Acolhuacan
where the men of
Huexotzinco are broken
with toil, are trod upon
like paving stones, and
wander around the
mountain Atloyan.

9. There is a ceiba tree,
a cypress tree, there
stands a mezquite bush,
strong as a cavern of
stone, known as the
Giver of Life.

10. Ruler of men,
Nopiltzin, Chicimec, O
Tezozomochtli, why hast
thou made us sick, why
brought us to death,
through not desiring to
offer war and battle to
Acolhuacan?

11. Tel ca tonehua ticahuiltia
ipalnemohuani Colihua o o Mexicatl y
tlahcateotl huiaya atayahuili quinequia
yaoyotl necaliztl qui mana Acolhuacan a
ohuaya ohuaya.

11. But we lift up our
voice and rejoice in the
Giver of life; the men of
Colhuacan and the
Mexican leader have
ruined us, through not
desiring to offer war
and battle to
Acolhuacan.

12. Zan ye on necuiltonolo in tlalticpac ay
oppan titlano chimalli xochitl ay oppan
ahuiltion ipalnemohua; ye ic anauia in
tlailotlaqui xayacamacha huia ho ay ya yi
ee ohuaya ha ohuaya.

12. The only joy on
earth will be again to
send the shield-flower,
again to rejoice the
Giver of Life; already
are discontented the
faces of the workers in
filth.

13. Inacon anquelehuia chimalli xochitl y
yohual xochitli tlāchinol xochitl; ye ic
neyahpanalo antepilhuan huiya
Quetzalmamatzin Huitznahuacatl ohuaye
ho ha yia yi ee oua yi aha ohuaya.

13. Therefore you
rejoice in the shield-
flowers, the flowers of
night, the flowers of
battle; already are ye
clothed, ye children of
Quetzalmamatzin and
Huitznahuacatl.

14. Chimal tenamitl oncan in nemohua
yehua necalia huilotl oyahualla icahuaca
yehuaya on canin ye nemi in tecpipiltin
Xiuhtzin xayacamachani amehuano o
anconahuiltia ipalnemohua ohuaya.

14. Your shield and
your wall of safety are
where dwells the sweet
joy of war, where it
comes, and sings and
lifts its voice, where
dwell the nobles, the
precious stones, making
known their faces; thus

you give joy to the
Giver of Life.

15. In ma huel netotilo mannemamanaloya
yaonahuac a on netlamachtiloyan ipan
nechihuallano ohuaye in tepiltzin can ye
mocuetlaca ohuaya, ohuaya.

15. Let your dancing,
and banqueting be in
the battle, there be your
place of gain, your
scene of action, where
the noble youths perish.

16. Quetzalipantica oyo huiloa ahuiltiloni
ipalnemohuan yectlahuacan in
tapalcayocan a ohuaya ohuaya.

16. Dressed in their
feathers they go
rejoicing the Giver of
Life to the excellent
place, the place of
shards.

17. Oyo hualahuaya ye totalipan oyohua
yehua Huexotzincatl y tototihua o o
Iztaccoyotla ohuaya ohuaya.

17. He lifted up his
voice in our houses like
a bird, that man of
Huexotzinco,
Iztaccoyotl.

18. Ace melle ica tonācoquiza y nican
topantilemonti Tlaxcaltecatl itocoya cacalia
in altepetl y Huexochinco ya ohuaya.

18. Whoever is
aggrieved let him come
forth with us against the
men of Tlaxcallan, let
him follow where the
city of Huexotzinco lets
drive its arrows.

19. Cauhtimanizo polihuiz tlalli yan
totomihuacan huia cehuiz yiollo o
antepilhuan a Huexotzinca y ohuaya
ohuaya.

19. Our leaders will lay
waste, they will destroy
the land, and your
children, O
Huexotzincos, will have
peace of mind.

20. Mizquitl y mancan tzihuactli y mancan
ahuehuetl onicacahuia ipalnemohua,
xonicnotlamati mochi elimanca
Huexotzinco ya zanio oncan in huel on
mani tlalla ohuaya ohuaya.

20. The mezquite was
there, the tzihuac was
there, the Giver of Life
has set up the cypress;
be sad that evil has
befallen Huexotzinco,
that it stands alone in
the land.

21. Zan nohuian tlaxixinia tlamomoyahua y
ayoc anmocehuia momācehual y hualcaco
mocuic in icelteotl oc xoconyocoyacan
antepilhuan a ohuaya ohuaya.

21. In all parts there are
destruction and
desolation, no longer
are there protection and
safety, nor has the one
only God heard the
song; therefore speak it
again, you children;

22. Zan mocuepa itlatol conahuiloa
ipalnemohua Tepeyacac ohuaye
antepilhuan ohuaya ohuaya.

22. That the words may
be repeated, you
children, and give joy to
the Giver of Life at
Tepeyacan.

23. Canel amonyazque xoconmolhuican an
Tlaxcalteca y Tlacomihuatzin hui oc oyauh
itlachinol ya yehuan Dios a ohuaya.

23. And since you are
going, you Tlaxcallans,
call upon
Tlacomihuatzin that he

may yet go to this
divine war.

24. Cozcatl ihuihui quetzal něhuihua oc zo
conhuipanque zan Chichimeca y Totomihua
a Iztaccoyotl a ohuaya ohuaya.

24. The Chichimecs and
the leaders and
Iztaccoyotl have with
difficulty and vain labor
arranged and set in
order their jewels and
feathers.

25. Huexotzinco ya zan quiauhtzinteuctli
techcocolia Mexicatl itechcocolia
Acolihuiiao ach quennelotihua tonyazque
quenonamican a ohuaye ohuaye.

25. At Huexotzinco the
ruler Quiauhtzin hates
the Mexicans, hates the
Acolhuacans; when
shall we go to mix with
them, to meet them?

26. Ay antlayocoya anquimitoa in
amotahuan an teteuctin ayoquantzin ihuan a
in tlepetztic in cacha ohuaya tzihuacpopoca
yo huaya.

26. Set to work and
speak, you fathers, to
your rulers, to your
lords, that they may
make a blazing fire of
the smoking tzihuac
wood.

27. Ca zan catcan Chalco Acolihuaca huia
totomihuacan y amilpan in Quauhquecholla
quixixinia in ipetl icpal yehuan Dios
ohoaya ohuaya.

27. The Acolhuacans
were at Chalco, the
Otomies were in your
cornfields at
Quauhquechollan, they
laid them waste by the
permission of God.

28. Tlazoco a ye nican tlalli tepetl
yecocoliloya cemanahuac a ohuaya.

28. The fields and hills
are ravaged, the whole

29. Quennel conchihuazque atl popoca
itlacoh in teuctli tlalli mocuepaya Mictlan
onmatia Cacamatl onteuctli, quennel
conchihuazque, ohuaya ohuaya.

land has been laid
waste.

29. What remedy can
they turn to? Water and
smoke have spoiled the
land of the rulers; they
have gone back to
Mictlan attaching
themselves to the ruler
Cacamatl. What remedy
can they turn to?

[Notes for Song XV](#)

XVI.

1. On onellelacic quexquich nic ya ittoa
antocnihuan ayiaue noconnenemititica
noyollon tlalticpac y noconycuilotica, ay
niyuh can tinemi ahuian yeccan, ay
cemellecan in tenahuac y, ah
nonnohuicallan in quenon amican ohuaya.

XVI.

1. It is a bitter grief to
see so many of you,
dear friends not walking
with me in spirit on the
earth, and written down
with me; that no more
do I walk in company to
the joyful and pleasant
spots; that nevermore in
union with you do I
journey to the same
place.

2. Zan nellin quimati ye noyollo za nelli
nicittoa antocnihuan, ayiahue aquin
quitlatlauhtia icelteotl yiollo itlacoca con
aya macan. Machamo oncan? In tlalticpac
machamo oppan piltihua. Ye nelli nemoa in

2. Truly I doubt in my
heart if I really see you,
dear friends; Is there no
one who will pray to the
one only God that he
take this error from

quenon amican ilhuicatl y itec icanyio
oncan in netlamachtilo y ohuaya.

your hearts? Is no one
there? No one can live a
second time on earth.
Truly they live there
within the heavens,
there in a place of
delight only.

3. O yohualli icahuacan teuctlin popoca
ahuiltlon Dios ipalnemohuani: chimalli
xochitl in cuecuepontimani in mahuiztli
moteca molinian tlalticpac, ye nican ic
xochimicohuayan in ixtlahuac itec a ohuaya
ohuaya.

3. At night rises up the
smoke of the warriors, a
delight to the Lord the
Giver of Life; the
shield-flower spreads
abroad its leaves,
marvelous deeds agitate
the earth; here is the
place of the fatal
flowers of death which
cover the fields.

4. Yaonauac ye oncan yaopeuhca in
ixtlahuac itec iteuhlinpopoca ya
milacatzoa y momalacachoa
yaoxochimiquiztica antepilhuan in
anteteuctin zan Chichimeca y ohuaya.

4. The battle is there,
the beginning of the
battle is in the open
fields, the smoke of the
warriors winds around
and curls upward from
the slaughter of the
flowery war, ye friends
and warriors of the
Chichimecs.

5. Maca mahui noyollo ye oncan ixtlahuatl
itic, noconele hua in itzimiquiliztli zan
quinequin toyollo yaomiquiztla ohuaya.

5. Let not my soul
dread that open field; I
earnestly desire the
beginning of the
slaughter, may thy soul

6. O anquin ye oncan yaonahuac,
noconelehuia in itzi miquiliztli can
quinequin toyollo yaomiquiztla ohuaya
ohuaya.

7. Mixtli ye ehuatimani yehuaya
moxoxopan ipalnmohuani ye oncan
celiztimani a in quauhtlin ocelotl, ye oncan
cueponio o in tepilhuan huiya in tlachinol,
ohuaya ohuaya.

8. In ma oc tonahuican antocnihuan
ayahuc, ma oc xonahuiacan antepilhuan in
ixtlahuatl itec, y nemoaquihuic zan
tictotlanehuia o a in chimalli xochitl in
tlachinoll, ohuaya, ohuaya, ohuaya.

Notes for Song XVI

XVII. XOCHICUICATL.

1. Can ti ya nemia ticuicanitl ma ya
hualmoquetza xochihuehuatl quetzaltica

long for the murderous
strife.

6. O you who are there
in the battle, I earnestly
desire the beginning of
the slaughter, may thy
soul long for the
murderous strife.

7. The cloud rises
upward, rising into the
blue sky of the Giver of
Life; there blossom
forth prowess and
daring, there, in the
battle field, come the
children to maturity.

8. Let us rejoice, dear
friends, and may ye
rejoice, O children,
within the open field,
and going forth to it, let
us revel amid the
shield-flowers of the
battle.

XVII. A FLOWER SONG.

1. Where thou walkest,
O singer, bring forth thy

huiconticac teocuitlaxochinenepaniuhticac
y ayamo aye iliamo aye huiy ohuaya,
ohuaya.

flowery drum, let it
stand amid beauteous
feathers, let it be placed
in the midst of golden
flowers;

2. Tiquimonahuiltiz in tepilhuan teteucto in
quauhtlo ocelotl ayamo, etc.

2. That thou mayest
rejoice the youths and
the nobles in their
grandeur.

3. In tlacăce otemoc aya huehuetitlan ya
nemi in cuicanitlhuia zan qui quetzal in
tomaya quexexeloa aya icuic ipalnemoa qui
ya nanquilia in coyolyantototl
oncuicatinemi xochimanamanaya taxocha
ohuaya, ohuaya.

3. Wonderful indeed is
it how the living song
descended upon the
drum, how it loosened
its feathers and spread
abroad the songs of the
Giver of Life, and the
coyol bird answered,
spreading wide its
notes, offering up its
flowery songs of
flowers.

4. In canon in noconcaqui in tlatol aya
tlacazo yehuatl ipalnemoa quiyananquilia
quiyananquilia in coyolyantototl on
cuicatinemi xochimanamanaya, etc.

4. Wherever I hear
those words, perhaps
the Giver of Life is
answering, as answers
the coyol bird,
spreading wide its
notes, offering up its
flowery song of
flowers.

5. In chalchihuitl ohuayee on quetzal
pipixauhtimania in amo tlatolhuia, noyuh
ye quittoa yayoquan yehuayan cuetzpal

5. It rains down
precious stones and
beauteous feathers

ohuaye anquinelin ye quimatin ipalnemoa
ohuaya.

rather than words; it
seems to be as one
reveling in food, as one
who truly knows the
Giver of Life.

6. Noyuh quichihua con teuctlon timaloa
yecan quetzalmaquiztla matilolticoya
conahuiltia icelteotlhuia achcanon azo a
yan ipalnemoa achcanon azo tle nel in
tlalticpac ohuaya.

6. Thus do the nobles
glorify themselves with
things of beauty, honor
and delight, that they
may please the one only
god, though one knows
not the dwelling of the
Giver of Life, one
knows not whether he is
on earth.

7. Macuelachic aya maoc ixquich cahuitl
niquin notlanehui in chalchiuhtini in
maquiztini in tepilhuan aya; zan
nicxochimalina in tecpillotl huia: zan ca
nican nocuic ica ya nocon ilacatzohua a in
huehuetitlan a ohuaya ohuaya.

7. May I yet for a little
while have time to revel
in those precious and
honorable youths; may I
wreathe flowers for
their nobility; may I
here yet for a while
wind the songs around
the drum.

8. Oc noncoati nican Huexotzinco y
nitlātohuani ni teca ehuatzin huiya
chalchiuhti zan quetzalitztin y,
niquincenquixtia in tepilhuan aya zan
nicxochimalina in tecpillotl huia ohuaya
ohuaya.

8. I am a guest here
among the rulers of
Huexotzinco; I lift up
my voice and sing of
precious stones and
emeralds; I select from
among the youths those
for whom I shall
wreathe the flowers of
nobility.

9. A in ilhuicac itic ompa yeya huitz in
yectliyan xochitl yectliyan cuicatl y,
conpolo antellel conpolo antotlayocol y in
tlacazo yehuatl in Chichimecatl teuctli in
teca yehuatzin ica xonahuiacan a ohuaya
ohuaya.

10. Moquetzal izqui xochintzetzelo in
icniuhyotl aztlacaxtlatlapantica ye
onmalintiac in quetzalxiloxochitl imapan
onnēnemi conchichichintinemi in teteuctin
in tepilhuan.

11. Zan teocuitlacoyoltototl o huel yectli
namocuic huel yectli in anq'ehua anquin ye
oncan y xochitl y ya hualyuhcan y xochitl
imapan amoncate in amontlatlātoa ye
ohuaya ohui ohui ilili y yao ayya hue ho
ama ha ilili ohua y yaohuia.

9. There comes from
within the heavens a
good flower, a good
song, which will
destroy your grief,
destroy your sorrow;
therefore, Chief of the
Chichimecs, be glad
and rejoice.

10. Here, delightful
friendship, turning
about with scarlet dyed
wings, rains down its
flowers, and the
warriors and youths,
holding in their hands
the fragrant xilo
flowers, walk about
inhaling the sweet odor.

11. The golden coyol
bird sings sweetly to
you, sweetly lifts its
voice like a flower, like
sweet flowers in your
hand, as you converse
and lift your voice in
singing, etc.

12. O ach ancati quechol in ipalnemoa o
ach ancati tlatocauh yehuan Dios huiya
achto tiamehuan anquitztoque tlahuizcalli
amoncuicatinemi ohui, ohui, ilili, etc.

12. Even like the
quechol bird to the
Giver of Life, even as
the herald of God, you
have waited for the
dawn, and gone forth
singing ohui, etc.

13. Maciuhtiao o in quinequi noyollo, zan
chimalli xochitl mixochiuh ipalnemoani,
quen conchihuaz noyollo yehua onentacico
tonquizaco in tlalticpac a ohuaya ohuaya.

13. Although I wish that
the Giver of Life shall
give for flowers the
shield-flower, how shall
I grieve that your efforts
have been in vain, that
you have gone forth
from the world.

14. Zan ca yuhqui noyaz in o ompopoliuh
xochitla antlenotleyoye in quemmanian,
antlenitacihcayez in tlalticpac. Manel
xochitl manel cuicatl, quen conchihuaz
noyollo yehua onentacico tonquizaco in
tlalticpac ohuaya ohuaya.

14. Even as I shall go
forth into the place of
decayed flowers, so
sometime will it be with
your fame and deeds on
earth. Although they are
flowers, although they
are songs, how shall I
grieve that your efforts
have been in vain, that
you have gone forth
from the world.

15. Manton ahuiacan antocnihuan aya ma
on nequech nahualo nican huiya a
xochintlalticpac ontianemi yenican ayac
quitlamitehuaz in xochitl in cuicatl in mani
a ichan ipalnemohuani yi ao ailili yi ao aya
hue aye ohuaya.

15. Let us be glad, dear
friends, let us rejoice
while we walk here on
this flowery earth; may
the end never come of
our flowers and songs,
but may they continue

16. In zancuelachitzincan tlalticpac aya
ayaoc noiuhcan quennonamicani
cuixocpacohua icniuhthiway auh in amo
zania nican totiximatizo in tlalticpac y yiao
ha ilili yiao.

17. Noconca con cuicatl noconca o quin
tlapitzaya xochimecatl ayoquan teuctliya
ahuayie, ohuayiao ayio yo ohua.

18. Zan mitzyananquili omitzyananquili
xochincalaitec y in aquiauhatzin in
tlacateuhtli ayapancatl yahuayia.

19. Can tinemi noteouh ipalnemohuani
mitztemohua in quemmanian y
mocanitlaocoyan, nicuicanitlhuia, zan ni
mitzahuiltiaya ohuiyan tililiyanco huia
ohuaya ohuaya.

in the mansion of the
Giver of Life.

16. Yet a little while and
your friends must pass
from earth. What does
friendship offer of
enjoyment, when soon
we shall no longer be
known on earth?

17. This is the burden of
my song, of the garland
of flowers played on the
flute, without equal in
the place of the nobles.

18. Within the house of
flowers the Lord of the
Waters, of the Gate of
the Waters, answers
thee, has answered thee.

19. Where thou livest,
my beloved, the Giver
of Life sends down
upon thee sometimes
things of sadness; but I,
the singer, shall make
thee glad in the place of
difficulty, in the place
of cumber.

20. In zan ca izqui xochitl in quetzalizqui
xochitl pixahui ye nican xopancalaitec i
tlacuiloalcalitec, zan nimitzahahuiltiaya
ohui.

20. Here are the many
flowers, the beautiful
flowers, rained down
within the house of
spring, within its
painted house, and I
with them shall make
thee glad.

21. O anqui ye oncan Tlaxcala, ayahue,
chalchiuhtetzilacuicatoque in huehuetitlan
ohuaye, xochin poyon ayiahue Xicontecat
teuctli in Tizatlacatzin in camaxochitzin
cuicatica y melelquiza xochiticaya on
chielo itlatol ohuay icelteotl ohuaya.

21. O, you there in
Tlaxcala, you have
played like sweet bells
upon your drums, even
like brilliantly colored
flowers. There was
Xicontecat, lord of
Tizatlan, the rosy-
mouthed, whose songs
gave joy like flowers,
who listened to the
words of the one only
God.

22. O, anqui nohuia y, ye mochan
ipalnemohua xochipetlatl ye noca xochitica
on tzauhticac oncan mitztlatlauhtia in
tepilhua ohuaya.

22. Thy house, O Giver
of Life is in all places;
its mats are of flowers,
finely spun with
flowers, where thy
children pray to thee.

23. In nepapan xochiquahuitl onicac, aya,
huehuetitlan a a yiahue, can canticaya
quetzaltica malintimani, ya, yecxochitl
motzetzeloaya ohuaya ohuaya.

23. A rain of various
flowers falls where
stands the drum,
beauteous wreaths
entwine it, sweet
flowers are poured
down around it.

24. Can quetzatzal petlacoatl yepac o, ye
nemi coyoltototl cuicatinemiya, can
quinanquili teuctli ya,
conahuiltianquauhtloocelotl ohuaya
ohuaya.

24. Where the brilliant
scolopender basks, the
coyol bird scatters
abroad its songs,
answering back the
nobles, rejoicing in
their prowess and
might.

25. Xochitzetzeliuhtoc y, niconnetolilo
antocnihuan huehuetitlan ai on chielo can
nontlamati toyollo yehua ohuaya ohuaya.

25. Scattering flowers I
rejoice you, dear
friends, with my drum,
awaiting what comes to
our minds.

26. In zan ca yehuan Dios tlaxic, ya,
caquican yehual temoya o ilhuicatl itic, y,
cuicatihuitz, y, quinanquilia o, angelotin
ontlapitztihuitzteaya oyiahue yaia o o
ohuaya ohuaya.

26. It reaches even to
God, he hears it seeking
him within the heavens,
the song comes and the
angels answer, playing
on their flutes.

27. Zan ninentlamatia can niquauhtenco
ayahue can. * * *

27. But I am sad within
this wood.

[Notes for Song XVII](#)

**XVIII. NICAN OMPEHUA
TEPONAZCUICATL.**

*Tico, tico, toco, toto, auh ic ontlantiuh
cuicatl, tiqui, ti ti, tito, titi.*

1. Tollan aya huapalcalli manca, nozan in
mamani coatlaquetzalli yaqui yacauhtehuac
Nacxitl Topiltzin, onquiquiztica ye
choquililo in topilhuan ahuay yeyauh in
polihuitiuh nechcan Tlapallan ho ay.

2. Nechcayan Cholollan oncan tonquizaya
Poyauhtecatitlan, in quiyapanhuiya y
Acallan anquiquiztica ye choquililon ye.

3. Nonohualco ye nihuitz ye nihui quecholi
nimamaliteuctla, nicnotlamatia oyah quin
noteuc ye ihuitimali, nechya icnocauhya
nimatlac xochitl, ayao ayao o ayya y yao
ay.

**XVIII. HERE BEGIN
SONGS FOR THE
TEPONAZTLI.**

*Tico, tico, toco, toto,
and as the song
approaches the end,
tiqui, titi, tito, titi.*

1. At Tollan there stood
the house of beams,
there yet stands the
house of plumed
serpents left by Nacxitl
Topiltzin; going forth
weeping, our nobles
went to where he was to
perish, down there at
Tlapallan.

2. We went forth from
Cholula by way of
Poyauhtecatli, and ye
went forth weeping
down by the water
toward Acallan.

3. I come from
Nonohualco as if I
carried quechol birds to
the place of the nobles;
I grieve that my lord
has gone, garlanded
with feathers; I am

4. In tepetl huitomica niyaychocaya,
axaliqueuhca nicnotlamatiya o yaquin
noteuc (etc. as v. 3).

5. In Tlapallan aya mochieloca
monahuatiloca ye cochiztla o anca ca zanio
ayao, ayao, ayao.

6. Zan tiyaolinca ye noteuc ic ihuitimali,
tinahuatilo ya ye Xicalanco o anca zacanco.

7. Ay yanco ay yanco ayamo aya ayhuiya
ayanco ayyanco ayamo aye ahuiya que ye
mamaniz mocha moquiapana, oquen ye
mamaniz moteuccallatic ya icnocauhqui
nican Tollan Nonohualco ya y ya y ya o ay.

8. In ye quinti chocaya teuctlon, timalon
que ye mamaniz mochan (etc. as v. 7).

wretched like the last
flower.

4. With the falling down
of mountains I wept,
with the lifting up of
sands I was wretched,
that my lord had gone.

5. At Tlapallan he was
waited for, it was
commanded that there
he should sleep, thus
being alone.

6. In our battles my lord
was garlanded with
feathers; we were
commanded to go alone
to Xicalanco.

7. Alas! and alas! who
will be in thy house to
attire thee? Who will be
the ruler in thy house,
left desolate here in
Tollan, in Nonohualco?

8. After he was drunk,
the ruler wept; we
glorified ourselves to be
in thy dwelling.

9. In tetl, in quahuatl o on timicuilotehuac
nachcan Tollan y inon can in otontlatoco
Naxitl Topiltzin y aye polihuiz ye motoca
ye ic ye chocaz in momacehual ay yo.

10. Zan can xiuhcalliya cohuacallaya in
oticmatehuac nachcan Tollan y inon can yn
otontlatoco Naxitl Topiltzin (etc. as in v. 9).

9. Misfortune and
misery were written
against us there in
Tollan, that our leader
Nacxitl Topiltzin was to
be destroyed and thy
subjects made to weep.

10. We have left the
turquoise houses, the
serpent houses there in
Tollan, where ruled our
leader Nacxitl Topiltzin.

Notes for Song XVIII

XIX.

*Tico toco toco ti quiti quiti quiti quito; can
ic mocneptiuh.*

1. Tlapapal xochiceutli niyolaya nepapan
tonacan xochitl moyahuaya oncueponti
moquetzaco ya naya aya ye teo ya ixpan
tonaa Santa Maria ayyo.

2. An ya ya cuicaya zan quetzala xihuitl
tomolihui yan aya ye nitlachihual icelteotl
y ye Dios aya ni itlayocolaoya yecoc ya.

XIX.

*Tico, toco, toco, tiquiti,
quiti, quiti, quito; where
it is to turn back again.*

1. Resting amid parti-
colored flowers I
rejoiced; the many
shining flowers came
forth, blossomed, burst
forth in honor of our
mother Holy Mary.

2. They sang as the
beauteous season grew,
that I am but a creature
of the one only God, a

3. Zan ca tlaauilolpan nemia moyollo
amoxpetlatl ipan toncuicaya
tiquimonyaitotia teteuctin aya in obispo ya
zan ca totatzin aya oncan titlatoa atlitepan
ay yo.

4. Yehuan Dios mitzyocox aya xochitla ya
mitztlacatilo yancuicatl mitzicuiloa Santa
Maria in obispo ya.

Notes for Song XIX

XX.

1. Tolteca icuilihuia ahaa ya ha on tlantoc
amoxtli ya moyollo ya on aya
mochonaciticac o o Toltecayootl aic aya
ninemiz ye nican ay yo.

2. Ac ya nechcuiliz, ac ye nohuan oyaz o,
nicaz a anni icuihuan aya y yancuicanitl y

work of his hands that
he has made.

3. Mayst thy soul walk
in the light, mayst thou
sing in the great book,
mayst thou join the
dance of the rulers as
our father the bishop
speaks in the great
temple.

4. God created thee, he
caused thee to be born
in a flowery place, and
this new song to Holy
Mary the bishop wrote
for thee.

XX.

1. The Toltecs have
been taken, alas, the
book of their souls has
come to an end, alas,
everything of the
Toltecs has reached its
conclusion, no longer
do I care to live here.

2. Who will take me?
Who will go with me? I
am ready to be taken,

yehetl y noxochiuh non cuica ihuitequi
onteixpan ayyo.

3. Huey in tetl nictequintomahuac quahuatl,
nicicuiloa yancuicatl itech aya oncan
nomitoz in quemmanian in can niyaz
nocuica machio nicyacauhtiaz in tlalticpac,
y onnemiz noyol zan ca ye nican ya hualla
y yancoya nolnamicoca nemiz ye noteyo ay
yo.

4. Nichocaya niquittoaya nicnotza noyollo
ma niquitta cuicanelhuayotl ayama
nicyatlalaquiya ma ya ica tlalticpac
quimman mochihua onnenemiz noyol y.
Zan ca teucxochitl ahuiaca ipotocaticac
mocepanoayan toxochiuh ay ye ayao ohuiy
on can quiya itzmolini ye nocuic celia
notlatollaquillo ohua in toxochiuh icac
iquiapani ayao.

alas. All that was fresh,
the perfume, my
flowers, my songs, have
gone along with them.

3. Great is my
affliction, weighty is
my burden; I write out a
new song concerning it,
that some time I may
speak it there where I
shall go, a song to be
known when I shall
leave the earth, that my
soul shall live after I
have gone from here,
that my fame shall live
fresh in memory.

4. I cried aloud, I
looked about, I
reflected how I might
see the root of song,
that I might plant it here
on the earth, and that
then it should make my
soul to live. The sweet
exhalations of the
lovely flowers rose up
uniting with our
flowers; one hears them
growing as my song
buds forth, filled with
my words our flowers
stand upright in the
waters.

5. Tel ca cahua xochitl ahuiac xeliuhtihuitz
a ipotocaya in ahuiyac poyomatlin pixahua
oncan ninenenemi nicuicanitl y ye aya o
ohui y on ca quiya itzmolinī ye nocuic
celia, etc.

5. But the flowers
depart, their sweetness
is divided and exhales,
the fragrant poyomatl
rains down its leaves
where I the poet walk in
sadness; one hears them
growing, etc.

[Notes for Song XX](#)

XXI. HUEXOTZINCAYOTL.

**XXI. A SONG OF
THE
HUEXOTZINCOS.**

*Viniendo los de Huexotzinco à pedir
socorro à Moteuczoma Tlaxcalla.*

*Coming to Ask Aid of
Montezuma Against
Tlaxcalla.*

1. Tlacuiloltzetzeliuhticac moyoliol
tiMoteuczomātzi nichuicatihuitz
nictzetzelotihuitz y o huetzcani
xochinquetzalpapalotl
moquetzalizouhtihuitz noconitotia
chalchihuahlaquiquizcopa niyahueloncuica
chalchihuahhuilacapitzli nictocuitlapitza ya
ho ay la ya o haye ohuichile amiyacale.

1. Raining down
writings for thy mind, O
Montezuma, I come
hither, I come raining
them down, a very
jester, a painted
butterfly; stringing
together pretty objects,
I seem to be as one
cementing together
precious stones, as I
chant my song on my
emerald flute, as I blow
on my golden flute, ya
ho, ay la, etc.

2. Ohuaya ye onniceelehuia moxochiuh aya
ipalnemoani yehuayā Dios aya ilihuāca
nahuiche nictzetzeloaya noncuicatilo yaha
y.

2. Yes, I shall cause thy
flowers to rejoice the
Giver of Life, the God
in heaven, as hither I
come raining down my
songs, ya ho.

3. Tozmilini xochitl in noyolyol ay yahue
tozmilini xochitl noteponaz ayanco
ayancayome oncana y yahue
nicxochiamoxtozimmanaya itlatol ayanco
ayanca yomeho.

3. A sweet voiced
flower is my mind, a
sweet voiced flower is
my drum, and I sing the
words of this flowery
book.

4. Xompaqui xonahuia
annochipanicantiyazque ye ichano
nohueyetzinteuctli Moteuczomatzi,
totlaneuh tlp̄c totlaneuh uelic xochitl o
ayanco.

4. Rejoice and be glad
ye who live amid the
flowers in the house of
my great lord
Montezuma, we must
finish with this earth,
we must finish with the
sweet flowers, alas.

5. Tlachinoltepec yn ahuicacopa
tixochitonameyo timoquetzaco y yehuan
Dios a ocelozacatl ypan quauhtli choca
ymopopoyauhtoc y yanco y liyan cay
yahue ayli y yacalco y ya y ycho zaca y
yahue.

5. At the Mount of
Battle we bring forth
our sweet and glittering
flowers before God,
plants having the lustre
of the tiger, like the cry
of the eagle, leaving
glorious memory, such
are the plants in this
house.

6. Ohuaya yehe nipa tlantinemia ixpan Dios
a ninozozohuayatlahquechol, zaquan

6. Alas! in a little while
there is an end before

quetzal in tlayahualol papalotl
mopilihuitzetzeloa teixpana
xochiatlaquiquizcopa oh tlatoca ye nocuic y
yanco ili, etc.

God to all living; let me
therefore string together
beauteous and yellow
feathers, and mingling
them with the dancing
butterflies rain them
down before you,
scattering the words of
my song like water
dashed from flowers.

7. Nehcoya ompa ye nihiuithuiya xoxouhqui
hueyatla ymancan zanniman olini pozoni
tetecuica ic nipa tlania, zan iquetzal in
tototl xiuhquechol tototl no chiuhtihuitz'y
ni yahuinac ya Huexotzinco Atzalan
ayome.

7. I would that I could
go there where lies the
great blue water
surging, and smoking
and thundering, till after
a time it retires again: I
shall sing as the quetzal,
the blue quechol, when
I go back to
Huexotzinco among the
waters (*or, and*
Atzalan).

8. Zan niquintocaz aya niquimiximatitih
nohueyotzitzinhuan chalchiuhquechol y
canca xiuhquechol in teocuitlapapalotl in
cozcatototl ontlapia ye onca Huexotzinco
Atzalan ayame;

8. I shall follow them, I
shall know them, my
beloved Huexotzincos;
the emerald quechol
birds, the green
quechol, the golden
butterflies, and yellow
birds, guard
Huexotzinco among the
waters (*or, and*
Atzalan).

9. Xochi Atzalaan teocuitlaatl chalchihuahli
y nepaniuhyan itlatoaya in quetzalcanauhtli
quetzalnocuitlapilli cuecueyahuaya yliya
yliya yaho ayli yaho aye huichile anicale.

10. Huecapan nicac nicuicanitl huiya
zaquan petlatolini, ma nica yeninemia
nicyeyectian cuicatla in nic xochiotia
yayaho yahii.

Notes for Song XXI

XXII.

*Tico tico ticoti tico tico ticoti auh ic
ontlantiuk in cuicatl totoco totoco.*

1. Xichocayan nicuicanitl nicitta noxochiuh
zan nomac ommania zan quihuintia ye
noyollo ni cuicatl aya nohuian nemia, zan
ca ye noyollo notlayocola in cayo.

2. Xiuhtlamatelolla quetzalchalchihuahli
ipan ye nicmatia nocuic aya ma
yectlaxochitl y, zan nomac ton mania, etc.

9. Among the flowery
waters, the golden
waters, the emerald
waters, at the junction
of the waters which the
blue duck rules moving
her spangled tail.

10. I the singer stand on
high on the yellow
rushes; let me go forth
with noble songs and
laden with flowers.

XXII.

*Tico, tico, ticoti, tico,
tico, ticoti, and then the
song ends with totoco,
totoco.*

1. In the place of tears I
the singer watch my
flowers; they are in my
hand; they intoxicate
my soul and my song,
as I walk alone with
them, with my sad soul
among them.

2. In this spot, where
the herbage is like
sweet ointment and

green as the turquoise
and emerald, I think
upon my song, holding
the beauteous flowers in
my hand, etc. (as in v.
1).

3. In quetzalin chalchihutla ipan ye
nicmatia yectli ye nocuic yectli noxochiuh
annicuihuan tepilhuan aya xonahuiacan a
ayac onnemiz o in tlalticpac ayo.

3. In this spot of
turquoise and emerald, I
think upon beauteous
songs, beauteous
flowers; let us rejoice
now, dear friends and
children, for life is not
long upon earth.

4. O an niquitquiz ye niaz yectli nocuic
yectli noxochiuhui annicuihuan tepilhuan
aya.

4. I shall hasten forth, I
shall go to the sweet
songs, the sweet
flowers, dear friends
and children.

5. O huayanco o nichocaya a huayanco o
cahua y yahue nictzetzelo xochitl ay yo.

5. O he! I cried aloud;
O he! I rained down
flowers as I left.

6. Mach nohuan tonyaz quennonamica o ah
nicitquiz xochitl zan nicuicanitl huiya ma
yo a xonahuiyacan to ya nemia ticaqui ye
nocuic ahuaya.

6. Let us go forth
anywhere; I the singer
shall find and bring
forth the flowers; let us
be glad while we live;
listen to my song.

7. Ay ca nichocaya nicuicanitl ya icha
ahuicaloyan cuicatl ha Mictlan temohuiloya
yectliya xochitl onca ya oncaa y yao
ohuayan ca ya ilaca tziuhan ca na y yo.

8. Amo nequimilool amo neccuiltonol
antepilhuan aychaa ohuicaloyan cuicatl.

7. I the poet cry out a
song for a place of joy,
a glorious song which
descends to Mictlan,
and there turns about
and comes forth again.

8. I seek neither
vestment nor riches, O
children, but a song for
a place of joy.

[Notes for Song XXII](#)

**XXIII. YCUIC NEZAHUALCOYOTZIN. XXIII. SONGS OF
THE PRINCE
NEZAHUALCOYOTL.**

*Totoco totoco tico, totoco totoco ic
ontlantiuh tico titico ti tico tico.*

1. Nicaya quetza con tohuehueuh
aoniquimitotia quauhtlocelo yn ca
tiyayhcac in cuicaxochitl, nictemoan cuicatl
ye tonequimilol ayyo.

*Totoco, totoco, tico,
totoco totoco, then it
ends with tico titico,
titico, tico.*

1. I bring forth our
drum that I may show
the power and the
grandeur in which thou
standest, decked with
flowers of song: I seek
a song wherewith to
drape thee, ah! oh!

2. Ti Nopiltzi o ti Nezahualcoyotl o tiya
Mictl a quenonamica y yece mioncan ay
yo.

2. Thou, my Lord, O
thou Nezahualcoyotl,
thou goest to Mictlan in
some manner and at a
fixed time, ere long.

3. Quiyon quiyon caya nichocaya ya ni
Nezahualcoyotl huiya queni yeno yaz o ya
nipolihuiz oya miquitla ye nimitzcahua
noteouh ypalnemo o tinechnahuatia ye niaz
nipolihuiz aya, yo.

3. For this, for this, I
weep, I Nezahualcoyotl,
inasmuch as I am to go,
I am to be lost in death,
I must leave thee; my
God, the Giver of Life,
thou commandest me,
that I go forth, that I be
lost, alas.

4. Quenon maniz tlallin Acolihuacan huiya
cuixoca quen mano o ticmomoyahuaz in
momacehuali ye nimitzcahua noteouh, etc.

4. How shall the land of
Acolhuacan remain,
alas? How shall we, thy
servants, spread abroad
its fame? I must leave
thee; my God, etc.

5. Can yio cuicatli tonequimilol quipoloaya
a in totlacuiloli tepilhuan oo maya o
huitihua nican aya ayac ichan tlalticpac oo
ticyacencahuazque huelic ye xochitl ayio.

5. Even this song for
thy draping may perish,
which we have written
for our children, it will
no longer have a home
here on earth when we
shall wholly leave these
fragrant flowers.

6. O ayac quitlamitaz monecuiltonol
ypalnemoa a noyolquimati cuelachic
otictlanehuico Nezahualcoyotzin ay
oppatihua nican anaya y chan tlpac. Oon yn

6. Alas! thy riches shall
end; the Giver of Life
teaches me that but for
a little while do we

ay oppatihua in tlalticpacqui, zan
nicuicanitl ayaho onnichocaya
niquelnamiqui Nezahualcoyotl aya ho.

7. Xo acico ye nican in teotl aya
ypalnemoa, ayaho on nichocaya a
niquelnamiqui Nezalhuacoyotl ayio.

Notes for Song XXIII

XXIV.

*Quititi, quititi, quititi tocoto, tocoti tocoto
tocoti zan ic mocueptiuh.*

1. Ma xochicuicoya ma ichtoa nichuana
ayyahue teyhuinti xochitl ao ya noyehcoc
ye nica poyoma xahuallan timaliuhtihuitz
ay yo.

enjoy the prince
Nezahualcoyotl, nor a
second time will he
come to his house on
earth; no second time
will he rejoice on earth;
but I the singer grieve,
recalling to memory
Nezahualcoyotl.

7. Let us seek while
here the god, the Giver
of Life; I grieve,
recalling to memory
Nezahualcoyotl.

XXIV.

*Quititi, quititi, quititi
tocoto, tocoti, tocoto,
tocoti, then it is to turn
back again.*

1. Let me pluck
flowers, let me see
them, let me gather the
really intoxicating
flowers; the flowers are
ready, many colored,
varied in hue, for our
enjoyment.

2. Ma xochitl oyecoc ye nican ayyahuc can
tlaahuixochitla moyahuaya motzetzelo
ancazo yehuatl in nepapaxochitl ayyo. Zan
commoni huchuetl ma ya netotilo.

2. The flowers are ready
here in this retired spot,
this spot of fragrant
flowers, many sorts of
flowers are poured
down and scattered
about; let the drum be
ready for the dance.

3. Yn quetzal poyomatl ayc ihcuilihuic
noyol nicuicanitl in xochitl ayan tzetzelihui
ya ancuel ni cuiya ma xonahuacan ayio zan
noyolitic ontlapanion cuicaxochitl
nicyamoyahuaya yxoochitla.

3. I the singer take and
pour down before you
from my soul the
beautiful poyomatl, not
to be painted, and other
flowers; let us rejoice,
while I alone within my
soul disclose the songs
of flowers, and scatter
them abroad in the
place of flowers.

4. Cuicatl ya ninoquinilotehuaz in
quemmanian xochineneliuhtiaz noyollo
yehuan tepilhuan oonteteuctin in ca yio.

4. I shall leave my
songs in order that
sometime I may mingle
the flowers of my heart
with the children and
the nobles.

5. Zan ye ic nichoca in quemanian zan
nicaya ihtoa noxochiteyo nocuicatoca
nictlalitehuaz in quemanian
xochineneliuhtiaz, etc.

5. I weep sometimes as
I see that I must leave
the earth and my
flowers and songs, that
sometime these flowers
will be vain and useless.

XXV.

Tico toco tocoto ic ontiantiuh ticoto ticoto.

1. Toztliyan quechol nipa tlantinemia in
tlallaicpac oquihuinti ye noyol ahua y ya i.

2. Ni quetzaltototl niyecoya ye iquiapan
ycelteotl yxochiticipac nihueloncuica oo
nicuicaihtoa paqui ye noyol ahua.

3. Xochiatl in pozontimania in tlallaicpac
oquihuinti ye noyol ahua.

4. Ninochoquilia niquinotlamati ayac in
chan oo tlallicpac ahua.

5. Zan niquittoaya ye ni Mexicatl mani ya
huiya nohtlatoca tequantepec ni yahui
polihuin chittepehua a ya ye choca in
tequantepehua o huaye.

XXV.

*Tico, toco, tocoto, and
then it ends, ticoto,
ticoto.*

1. The sweet voiced
quechol there, ruling
the earth, has
intoxicated my soul.

2. I am like the quetzal
bird, I am created in the
house of the one only
God; I sing sweet songs
among the flowers; I
chant songs and rejoice
in my heart.

3. The fuming dew-
drops from the flowers
in the field intoxicate
my soul.

4. I grieve to myself
that ever this dwelling
on earth should end.

5. I foresaw, being a
Mexican, that our rule
began to be destroyed, I
went forth weeping that
it was to bow down and
be destroyed.

6. Ma ca qualania nohueyotehua Mexicatli polihui chile.

7. Citlalin in popocaya ipan ye moteca y za ye polihui a zan ye xochitecatl ohuaye.

8. Zan ye chocaya amaxtecatl aya caye chocaya tequantepesua.

6. Let me not be angry that the grandeur of Mexico is to be destroyed.

7. The smoking stars gather together against it; the one who cares for flowers is about to be destroyed.

8. He who cared for books wept, he wept for the beginning of the destruction.

[Notes for Song XXV](#)

XXVI.

*Toto tiquiti tiquiti ic ontiantiuh tocotico
tocoti toto titiqui toto titiquiti.*

1. Oya moquetz huel oon ma on netotilo teteuctin aya ma onnetlanehuihuilo chalchihuitl on quetzali patlahuac, ayac ichan tlalticpac, ayio zan nomac onmania ooo y xochiuh aya ipalnemoa ma onnetlanehuilo chalchihuitl.

XXVI.

*Toto tiquiti tiquiti, then
it ends tocotico, tocoti
toto titiqui toto titiquiti.*

1. Come forth to the dance, ye lords, let there be abundance of turquoise and feathers; our dwelling on earth is not for long; only let the gods give me flowers to my hand, give me abundance of turquoises.

2. Oyohual in colinia o on in icelteotl
ipalnemaa Anahuac o onnemia noyol ayio.

2. Come let us move in
the dance in honor of
the one only god, the
Giver of Life, while my
soul lives by the waters
(or, in Anahuac).

3. In yancuica oncan quixima ipalnemoani
ca ye Nonoalco ahuilizapan i in teuctli
yehua Nezahualpilli y yece ye oncan aya in
tlacoch tenanpan Atlixco ayio.

3. The Giver of Life
made known a new
song after the lord
Nezahualpilli entered
the strongholds of
Nonoalco and sped his
arrows within the walls
of Atlixco.

4. Zan momac otitemic motlahuan zomal a
ica ticahuiltia icelteotl in teuctli yehua.

4. Thou hast filled thy
plate and thy cup in thy
hands and hast rejoiced
in the one only God, the
Lord.

5. Y yeho aye icnotlamati noyollo, zan
niNonoalcatl, zan can nicolintototl o
nocamapan aya Mexicatl in ca yio.

5. Alas, how I am
afflicted in my soul, I, a
resident of Nonoalco; I
am like a wild bird, my
face is that of a
Mexican.

6. On quetzal pipixauhtoc
motlachinolxochiuh in ipalnemoa zan ca
nicolintototl, etc.

6. The beauteous
flowers of thy battles lie
abundantly snowed
down, O Giver of Life;
I am like a wild bird,
etc.

XXVII.

*Toco toco tiqui tiqui ic ontiantiuh toco tico
tocoti.*

1. Ma ya pehualo ya nicuihua in ma ya on
acico ye nicaan aya oya yēcoc yehuan Dios
in cayio in ma ya ca ya onahuilihuan
tepilhuan a ayamo acico ya yehuan Dios
oncan titemoc yehuan Dios a oncan huel in
oncan tlacat y ye Yesu Cristo in ca yio.

2. In oncan tlahuizcalli milintimani mochan
aya moxochiuhaya Dios aya
chalchiuhcueponi maquitzetzelihui
onnetlamachtilya in ca yio in oncan ya o
nepapan izhuayo moxochiuh aya Dios a.

3. Zan ye xochitl moyahua oo zan ca itlatol
in ipalnemoani o ontepan ye moteca
anahuac ooica tichuelmana atl on yan tepetl
ayio.

XXVII.

*Toco, toco, tiqui, tiqui,
and then it ends toco,
tico, tocoli.*

1. Let my song be
begun, let it spread
abroad from here as far
as God has created;
may the children be
glad, may it reach to
God, there to God
whom we seek, there
where is Jesus Christ
who was born.

2. There the dawn
spreads widely over the
fields, over thy house,
and thy flowers, O God,
blossom beauteous as
emeralds; they rain
down in wondrous
showers, in that place of
happiness; there alone
may my flowers, of
various leaves, be
found, O God.

3. There the flowers are
the words of the Giver
of Life; they are upon
the mountains and by

4. Zan temomac mania cemilhuitl in niman
ye tehuatl toconyaittoaya ipalnemoani.

the waters; we find
them alike by the water
and the mountain.

4. Our day is in thy
hand, and soon we shall
see thee, thou Giver of
Life.

[Notes for Song XXVII](#)

NOTES.

NOTES FOR SONG I.

The song is an allegory, portraying the soul-life of the poet. By the flowers which he sets forth to seek, we are to understand the songs which he desires to compose. He asks himself where the poetic inspiration is to be sought, and the answer is the same as was given by Wordsworth, that it is to the grand and beautiful scenes of Nature that the poet must turn for the elevation of soul which will lift him to the sublimest heights of his art. But this exaltation bears with it the heavy penalty that it disqualifies for ordinary joys. As in medieval tales, he who had once been admitted to fairyland, could nevermore conquer his longing to return thither, so the poet longs for some other condition of existence where the divine spirit of song may forever lift him above the trials and the littleness of this earthly life.

There is no sign of Christian influence in the poem, and it is probably one handed down from a generation anterior to the Conquest.

1. The word *peuhcayotl* from *peua*, to begin, intimates that this was a song chanted at the beginning of a musical entertainment. The verses are longer, and the phraseology plainer than in many of those following. There is also an absence of interjections and lengthened vowels, all of which indicate that the time was slow, and the actions of the singer temperate, as was the custom at the beginning of a *baile*. (See Introd., p. 20.)

1. *Ninoyolnonotza*, a reflexive, frequentative form from *notza*, to think, to reflect, itself from the primitive radicle *no*, mind, common to both the Nahuatl and Maya languages. The syllable *yol* is for *yollotl*, heart, in its figurative sense of soul or mind. The combination of *yolnonotza* is not found in any of the dictionaries. The full sense is, "I am thinking by myself, in my heart."

ahuiaca, an adverbial form, usually means "pleasant-smelling," though in derivation it is from the verb *ahuia*, to be satisfied with.

quetzal, for *quetzalli*, a long, handsome blue feather from the quetzal bird, often used figuratively for anything beautiful or precious.

chalchihuh for *chalchiuitl*, the famous green-stone, jade or emerald, so highly prized by the Mexicans; often used figuratively for anything noble, beautiful and esteemed.

huitzitzicatin, a word not found in the dictionaries, appears to be from *tzitzilca*, to tremble, usually from cold, but here applied to the tremulous motion of the humming bird as it hovers over a flower.

zacuan, the yellow plumage of the zacuan bird, and from similarity of color here applied to the butterfly. The zacuan is known to ornithologists as the *Oriolus dominicensis*. These birds are remarkably gregarious, sometimes as many as a hundred nests being found in one tree (see Eduard Mühlenpfort, *Versuch einer getreuen Schilderung der Republik Mexiko*, Bd. I, p. 183).

acxoyatzinitzcanquauhtla; composed of *acxoyatl*, the wild laurel; *tzinitzcan*, the native name of the *Trogon mexicanus*, renowned for its beautiful plumage; *quauhtli*, a tree; and the place-ending *tla*, meaning abundance.

tlauquecholxochiquauhtla; composed of *tlauquechol*, the native name of the red, spoon-billed heron, *Platalea ajaja*; *xochitl*, flower; *quauhtli*, tree; and the place-ending *tla*.

tonameyotoc, the root is the verb *tona*, to shine, to be warm; *tonatiuh*, the sun; *tonameyotl*, a ray of the sun, etc. As warmth and sunlight are the conditions of growth and fertility, many derivatives from this root signify abundance, riches, etc.

mocehcmelquixtia; *mo* is the reflexive pronoun, 3d sing., often used impersonally; *cehcmel*, is a reduplicated form of the numeral *ce*, one; it conveys the sense of entire, whole, perfect, and is thus an interesting illustration of the tendency of the untutored mind to associate the idea of unity with the notion of perfection; *quixtia* is the compulsive form of *quiza*, to go forth.

onechittitique; 3d person plural, preterit, of the causative form of *itta*, to see; *ittitia*, to cause to see, to show; *nech*, me, accusative form of the pronoun.

nocuexanco; from *cuexantli*, the loose gown worn by the natives, extending from the waist to the knees. Articles were carried in it as in an apron; *no-cuexan-co*, my-gown-in, the terminal *tli* being dropped on suffixing the postposition.

tepilhuan; from *pilli*, boy, girl, child, young person, with the relative, indefinite, pronominal prefix *te*, and the pronominal plural termination *huan*, to take which, *pilli* drops its last syllable, *li*; hence, *te-pil-huan*, somebody's children, or in general, the young people. This word is of constant occurrence in the songs.

teteuctin, plural with reduplication of *teuctli*, a noble, a ruler, a lord. The singer addresses his audience by this respectful title.

2. *ixochicuicatzini*; *i*, poss. pron. 3d sing.; *xochitl*, flower; *cuicatl*, song; *tzin*, termination signifying reverence or affection; "their dear flower-songs."

juhqui tepetl, etc. The echo in the Nahuatl tongue is called *tepeyolotl*, the heart or soul of the mountain (not in Simeon's *Dictionnaire*, but given by Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, p. 202).

meyaquetzalatl; from *meya*, to flow slowly, to trickle; *quetzalli*, beautiful; *atl*, water.

xiuhtotoameyalli; the root *xiuh* meant originally green (or blue, as they were not distinguished apart); hence *xiuitl*, a leaf or plant, the green herbage; as where the Nahuas then were this was renewed annually, *xiuitl* came to mean a year; as a comet seems to have a bunch of fiery flames growing from it, this too was *xiuitl*, and a turquoise was called by the same term; in the present compound, it is employed adjectively; *xiuh-totol*, turquoise-bird, is the *Guiraca caerulea*, Linn.; *ameyalli*, from *atl*, water, *meya*, to trickle, and the noun ending.

mo-motla; to throw one's self, to dash one's self against something, etc.

centzontlatolli; literally, "four hundred speeches." The numeral four hundred was employed, like the Greek "myriad," to express vaguely any extraordinary number. The term may be rendered "the myriad-voiced," and was the common name of the mocking-bird, called by ornithologists *Turdus polyglottus*, *Calandria polyglotta*, and *Mimus polyglotta*.

coyoltototl, literally, "the rattle-bird," so called from its peculiar notes (*coyolli* = a rattle), is one of the *Tanagridae*, probably the *Piranga hepatica*.

ayacachicahuactimani; composed of *ayacachtli*, the rattle (see *ante*, page 24); and *icahuaca*, to sing (of birds); to the theme of this verb is added the connective syllable *ti*, and the verb *mani*, which, in such connection, indicates that the action of the former verb is expended over a large surface, broadly and widely (see Olmos, *Gram. de la Lengua Nahuatl*, p. 155, where, however, the connective *ti* is erroneously taken for the pronoun *ti*).

hueltozcatemique; composed of *huel*, good or well; *tetozca*, from *tozquitl*, the singing voice; and *temo*, to let fall, to drop; *que* is the plural verbal termination.

3. *ma n-amech-ellelti*, vetative causative from *elleloa*, to cause pain.

cactimotlali, appears to be a compound of *caqui*, to listen, to hear, and *tlalia*, to seat, to place.

amohuampotzitzinhuan, a compound based on the pronoun of the second person plural, *amo*, the particle *po*, which means similarity or likeness, and the reduplicated reverential plural termination. The same particle *po*, appears a few lines later in *toquichpohuan*; *potli* = comrade, compeer.

4. *Tepeitic*, from *tepetl*, mountain, *ititl*, belly, from which is derived the proposition *itic*, within, among. The term is applied to a ravine or sequestered valley.

5. *quauhtliya ocelotl*, the expression *quauhtli*, *ocelotl*, is of frequent occurrence in the ancient Nahuatl writers. The words mean literally "eagle, tiger." These were military titles applied to officers commanding small bodies of troops; figuratively, the words mean control, power, and dignity; also, bravery and virtue. Comp. Agustin de Vetancurt, *Teatro Mexicano*, Tratado II, cap. 3.

6. *in tloque in nahuaque*; this expression, applied by the ancient Nahuas to the highest divinity, is attributed by some to Nezahualcoyotl (see above, p. 36). It is composed of two postpositions *tloc* and *nahaac*, and in the form given conveys the meaning "to whom are present and in whom are immanent all things having life." See Agustin de la Rosa, *Analisis de la Platica Mexicana sobre el Misterio de la Santisima Trinidad*, p. 11 (Guadalajara, 1871). The epithet was applied in heathen times to the supreme divinity Tonacateotl; see the *Codex Telleriano-Remensis*, in Kingsborough's *Mexico*, Vol. VI, p. 107.

8. *ximoayan*; this word does not appear in the dictionaries of Molina or Simeon, and is a proof, as is the sentiment of the whole verse, that the present poem belongs to a period previous to the Conquest. The term means "where all go to stay," and was the name of the principal realm of departed souls in the mythology of the ancient Nahuas. See Bartholome de Alva, *Confessionario en Lengua Mexicana*, fol. 13 (Mexico, 1634); Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 55; D.G. Brinton; *The Journey of the Soul* (in Aztec and Aryan Myths), Philadelphia, 1883.

yhuintia, causative form of *ihuinti*, to make drunk. The Nirvana of the Nahuas was for the soul to lie in dense smoke and darkness, filled with utter content, and free from all impressions ("en lo profundo de contento y obscuridad," Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 55).

NOTES FOR SONG II.

On the signification of the titles given to this poem see the Introduction, § 3.

1. *yehnan Dios*; literally "who are God;" the introduction of the Spanish *Dios*, God, is in explanation of *in tloque in nahuaque*; so far from proving that this song is of late date, this vouches for its genuine ancient character, through the necessity for such explanation.

2. *nelhuayotl*, the essence or source of something, its true nature; probably from *nelli*, true.

teoquecholme; the prefix *teotl*, divine, is often added as an expression of admiration. Sahagun mentions the *teoquechol* as a bird of brilliant plumage.

NOTES FOR SONG III.

The poet recalls a recent attendance on the obsequies of an acquaintance, and seeks to divert his mind from the gloomy contemplation of death and the ephemeral character of mortal joys by urging his friend to join in the pleasure of the hour, and by suggesting the probability of an after life.

1. *xochicalco*; compounded of *xochitl*, flower; *calli*, house; and the postposition, *co*. The term was applied to any room decorated with flowers; here, to the mortuary chamber, which Tezozomoc tells us was decked with roses and brilliant feathers.

ipalnemohuani, literally "the one by whom life exists." The composition is *i*, possessive pronoun, third person, singular; *pal*, postposition, by; *nemoani*, singular of the present in *ni* of the impersonal form of the verb *nemi*, to live, with the meaning to do habitually that which the verb expresses. It is an ancient epithet applied to the highest divinity, and is found in the *Codex Telleriano-Remensis*, Kingsborough's *Mexico*, Vol. VI, p. 128, note.

tolquatectitlan, from *toloa*, to lower, to bow; *quatequia*, to immerse the head; *tlan*, place ending. In the ancient funeral ceremonies the faces of the assistants were laved with holy water. On this rite see the note of Orozco y Berra to his edition of the *Cronica Mexicana* of Tezozomoc, p. 435 (Mexico, 1878).

xoyacaltitlan; from *xoyaui*, to spoil, to decay, whence *xoyauhqui*, rank, unpleasant, like the odor of decaying substances.

xochicopal tlenamactli, "the incense of sweet copal," which was burned in the funeral chamber (see Tezozomoc's description of the obsequies of Axayaca, *Cron. Mex.*, cap. 55).

2. The translation of this verse offers some special difficulties.

NOTES FOR SONG IV.

A poem of unusually rich metaphors is presented, with the title "A Song of the Mexicans, after the manner of the Otomis." It is a rhapsody, in which the bard sings his "faculty divine," and describes the intoxication of the poetic inspiration. It has every inherent mark of antiquity, and its thought is free from any tincture of European influence.

2. *miahuatototl*, literally, "the corn-silk bird," *miahua* being the term applied to the silk or tassel of the maize ear when in the milk. I have not found its scientific designation.

6. *poyomatli*; the *poyomatli* is described by Sahagun (*Hist. de la Nueva España*, Lib. X, cap. 24) as a species of rose, portions of which were used to fill the cane tubes or pipes used for smoking. He names it along with certain fungi employed for the same purpose, and it probably produced a narcotic effect.

NOTES FOR SONG V.

From the wording, this appears to be one of the lost songs of Nezahualcoyotl, either composed by him or sung before him. (See the Introduction, p. 35.) It is a funeral dirge, dwelling on the fact of universal and inevitable death, and the transitoriness of life. There is in it no hint of Christian consolation, no comfortable hope of happiness beyond the grave. Hence it dates, in all likelihood, from a period anterior to the arrival of the missionaries.

1. *tonequimilol*; I take this to be a derivative from *quimiloa*, to wrap up, especially, to shroud the dead, to wrap the corpse in its winding sheets, as was the custom of the ancient Mexicans. The word, however, seems an archaic form, as it does not lend itself readily to analysis.

The expression *in Dios*, I explain as in the note to II, 1, and do not consider that it detracts from the authentic antiquity of the poem.

2. *yoyontzin*; on the significance of this appellation of Nezahualcoyotl, see Introduction, p. 35.

3. *ti Nezahualcoyotl*; "thou Nezahualcoyotl." The princely poet may have addressed himself in this expression, or we may suppose the song was chanted before him.

5. *Nopiltzin*; the reference is to Quetzalcoatl, the famous "fair God" of the Nahuas, and in myth, the last ruler of the Toltecs. See D.G. Brinton, *American Hero Myths* (Philadelphia, 1882). The term means "my beloved Lord." On Tezozomoc, see Introduction, p. 35.

6. The text of the latter part or refrain of verses 5 and 6 is corrupt, and my translation is doubtful.

NOTES FOR SONG VI.

Most of the poems in this collection are not assigned to any author, but this, and apparently the one following, are recorded as the compositions of Tetlapan Quetzanitzin. He is evidently the personage spoken of by Sahagun as "King of Tlacopan," as present with Montezuma on the occasion of his first interview with Cortez. Later in the struggle Tetlapan appears as the associate of Quauhtemoctzin, the "King of Mexico." (See Sahagun, *Hist. de la Nueva España*, Lib. XII, cap. 16 and 40.) M. Rémi Simeon explains the name to mean "he who deceives the people by magic;" deriving it from *quetza*, he places; *te*, the people, *tlepan*, on the fire. A simpler derivation seems to me possible from *tetlapanqui*, miner, or quarryman (literally, stone-breaker), and *quetzalli*, red; *quetzatzin*, the lord or master of the miners.

Both this and the following are war songs, and have marked similarity in thought and wording. The introduction of the Spanish *Dios* was doubtless substituted by the scribe, for the name of some native god of war, perhaps Huitzilopochtli.

1. *Aua*; this word I take to be a form of the interjection *yahue*, or, as Olmos gives it in his *Grammar*, *aa*.

2. *nepohualoyan*; "the place of counting or reckoning," from *pohua*, to count. The reference is not clear, and the translation uncertain. In some

parts of ancient Mexico they used in their accounting knotted cords of various colors, like the Peruvian *quipus*. These were called *nepohualtzitzin*.

4. This verse is remarkable for its sonorous phrases and the archaic forms of the words. Its translation offers considerable difficulty.

xontlachayan, I take to be an imperative form from *tlachia*, to look, with the euphonic *on*.

teoatl tlachinolli, literally "the divine water (i.e. blood), the burning," and the expression means war, battle. In one of his sermons Fray Juan Bautista describes the fall of Jericho in the words, *otlaltitechya in altepetl teuatl tlachinolli ye opoliuh*, and explains it, "the town was destroyed with fire and blood" (*Sermones en Lengua Mexicana*, p. 122). The word *tlachinolli* is from *chinoa*, to burn.

quetzalalpilo; a compound of *quetzalli*, a beautiful feather, and *tlalpiloni*, the band which passed around the head to keep the hair in place.

5. *melchiquiuh ticaya*; "he who presented his breast," an imperfect, reflexive form. Molina gives *melchiquiuh petlauhqui*, with the translation *despechugado*. *Vocabulario Mexicana*, s.v.

NOTES FOR SONG VII.

The second specimen from the muse of Tetlapan Quetzanitzin is the noblest war song in the collection. It is an appeal to his friends to join in a foray to Chiapas. The intoxication of the battle field is compared to that produced by the strong white wine prepared from maguey, which was drunk only on solemn occasions. The bard likens the exhaustion of his fellow warriors from previous conflicts, to the stupor which follows a debauch, and he exhorts them to throw it aside.

1. *oamaxque*, o, pret. *am*, you, *axque*, 2d pl. pret. from *ay*, to do.

octicatl, apparently an old form from *octli*, the intoxicating beverage prepared from the maguey.

oanquique, 2d pl. pret. from *cui*, to take.

ohuican, a place of difficulty and danger. The frequent addition of the terminal *o* in this and the succeeding verses is merely euphonic.

2. *teoatl tlachinolli*; see note VI, 4.

in maquiztli tlazotetl, the beloved jewels, a phrase which indicates that the broken stones and splintered emeralds referred to are the young warriors who fall in battle, the pride of their parents' hearts, who are destroyed in the fight.

The *tizaoctli*, white wine (*tizatli*, chalk, hence white, and *octli*, wine), referred to in this passage, is said by Sahagun to have been drunk especially at the feast of the god Papaztac, one of the many gods of the wine cup. *Hist. de Nueva España*. Lib. II, App. Tezozomoc mentions it as handed to the mourners at funeral ceremonies. *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 55.

3. *xochitlalticpacilhuitacpao*; in this long compound of *xochitl*, flower, *tlalti*, earth, and *ilhuicatl*, sky, with various postpositions and the euphonic terminal *o*, the final *pa* gives the sense of location, towards, in the direction of.

chimalxochiti; "the shield flower," the shield or buckler of the ancient warriors, ornamented with tassels and feathers, is not unaptly called the flower of war.

NOTES FOR SONG VIII.

The entire absence in this lament for the dead of any consolation drawn from Christian doctrines, points clearly to a date for its composition earlier than the teachings of the missionaries. Its cry of woe is hopeless, and the title attributes its authorship to one of the old chieftains, *tlatoani*, who held the power before the Spaniard arrived.

1. *quetzalhuahuaciuhtoque*, from *quetzalli*, *huaqui*; in *teintoque*, the splinters; the same simile is employed in VII, 2.

2. *ximoayan*, see note to I, 8. The occurrence of this term here and in verse 3 testifies to the fact of a composition outside of Christian influences.

NOTES FOR SONG IX.

The title does not necessarily mean that this song is a translation from the Otomi language, but merely that the time to which it was chanted was in the Otomi style; or, the term *Otomi* may have reference to the military officer so called. The word is perhaps a compound of *otli*, path, and *mitl*, arrow.

The bard sings the vanity of earthly pleasures, and the reality of earthly pains; he exhorts himself and his hearers not to neglect the duties of religion, and lauds his own skill in song, which he compares to the sweet voices of melodious birds. There is nothing in the poem which reflects European influence.

1. *xotlacueponi*; the meaning of this compound is obscure. It is not found in the dictionaries.

2. The terminal *o* is inserted several times in the passage to express emotion and fill the metre.

mixitl tlapatl. A phrase signifying the stupor or drunkenness that comes from swallowing or smoking narcotic plants. See Olmos, *Grammaire de la Langue Nahuatl*, pp. 223, 228; *oquiqueo* is from *i*, to drink, or *cui*, to take, the *o* terminal being euphonic.

NOTES FOR SONG X.

The poet expresses his grief that his songs all dwell on painful topics; he exhorts his hearers of the vanity of fame and skill in handicrafts, and of the uncertainty of life; closing, he appeals especially to those of Tezcucó and Atecpan to listen and believe his warnings.

In spite of the introduction of the Spanish word *Dios*, and the exhortation to "believe," in the last line, it is possible that the substance of this song was due to purely native inspiration; yet it may have been, like Song XIX, one of those written at an early period for the converts by the missionaries.

NOTES FOR SONG XI.

In a similar strain as in the last poem, the bard bewails the briefness of human life and friendships. He closes with an appeal to the Master of Life, of whom no mortal tongue can speak in worthy and appropriate terms.

6. *ihuiti*, apparently a form of *ihuintia*.

tonan; the reference appears to be to *Tonantzin*, Our Mother, otherwise known as Cihuacoatl, the Serpent Woman. She was the mythical mother of the human race, and dispensed afflictions and adverse fortune. See Sahagun, *Hist. de la Nueva España*, Lib. I, cap. 6. The name is a proof of the antiquity of the poem, which is throughout in the spirit of the ancient religion.

NOTES FOR SONG XII.

As stated in the Introduction (§ 10), a note prefixed to this song introduces it as a translation from the Otomi into the Nahuatl tongue. It admirably illustrates the poetic flexibility of the Nahuatl.

3. *epoyhuayan*, from *epoalli*, sixty; *teoquauhtli ocelott*, "divine eagles, tigers." These terms refer to the warriors bearing these titles.

tlazomaquiztetl, "beloved, precious stones," a figure of speech referring to the youths who go to war. The same or similar metaphors are used in previous songs.

5. The fifth and sixth verses present serious difficulties of construction which I do not flatter myself I have overcome.

NOTES FOR SONG XIII.

The inhabitants of Huexotzinco were in frequent strife with those of Mexico-Tenochtitlan, and on various occasions the latter captured many prisoners. The present poem is represented to be a composition of one of

these prisoners when he and his companions were confined in Tlatilolco, one of the suburbs of Tenochtitlan. It breathes hatred against his captors and an ardent thirst for vengeance. The latest date at which I find captives from Huexotzinco detained in Mexico is 1511, and it is to this year, therefore, that I assign the composition of the poem.

5. *Atloyantepetl*; this name possibly means "the mountain of the place of the water-falcons" (*atl*, water; *tlatli*, falcon; *yan*, place-ending; *tepetl*, mountain). I have not found it in other writers. (See Index.)

8. *tlaylotlaqui*; Siméon, on the authority of Aubin, explains this term as the name of a tribe living near Tezcucó. In derivation it appears to be a term of contempt, "workers in filth or refuse," scum, offscourings. It also appears in Song XV.

10. The construction of this verse is so obscure, or the text so imperfect, that the translation is doubtful.

NOTES FOR SONG XIV.

This poem, chanted in 1551 before the Governor of Azcapotzalco, by Francisco Placido, a native of Huexotzinco, is a Christian song in the style and metre of the ancient poetry. See the Introduction, p. 51.

1. *impetlatl*; the ordinary meaning of *petlatl* is a mat or rug; it is here to be taken in its figurative sense of power or authority, chiefs and other prominent persons being provided with mats at the councils, etc.

NOTES FOR SONG XV.

This extremely difficult composition seems to be a war song, in which the bard refers to the traditional history of the Nahuas, names some of their most prominent warriors, and incites his hearers to deeds of prowess on the battle field. I do not claim for my version more than a general correspondence to the thought of the original. In several parts, especially verse 18, the text is obviously defective.

1. *tzihuactitlan*; "the land of the tzihuac bushes." The *tzihuactli* is a small kind of maguey which grows in rocky localities. The tenth edifice of the great temple at Tenochtitlan was a wall surrounding an artificial rockery planted with these bushes. Sahagun, who mentions this fact, adds that the name of this edifice was *Teotlalpan*, which literally means "on holy ground." (*Hist. de la Nueva España*, Lib. II, App.) The *mizquitl* is the common *Mimosa circinalis*.

Chicomoztoc; "at the Seven Caves," a famous locality in Mexican legend, and the supposed birthplace of their race.

2. *Colhuacan* is probably for Acolhuacan; the early rulers of the latter were of the blood of the Chichimec chiefs of the Tepanecas.

4. *Hueytlalpan*, "at the ancient land," perhaps for Huetlapallan, a locality often referred to in the migration myths of the Nahuas.

5. *Atloyan*; see note to XIII, 6.

9. The ceiba and cypress trees were employed figuratively to indicate protection and safeguard. See Olmos, *Gram. de la Lengua Nahuatl*, p. 211.

12. On *tlailotlaqui*, see note to XIII, 8. The interjectional appendages to this and the following verse are increased.

15. Tepeyacan was the name of a mountain on which before the Conquest was a temple dedicated to the "Mother of our Life," Tonantzin.

16. *tlapalcayocan*, "the place of shards," of broken pieces, i.e., the field of battle.

19. The word *totomihuacan*, which has already occurred in vv. 3 and 7, I have translated as referring to the war captains of the Mexican armies, called *otomi* (see Bandelier, *On the Art of War of the Ancient Mexicans*, p. 117). I am quite open for correction however.

27. *in ipetl icpal*; in a translation of an ancient song, Ixtlilxochitl renders the expression *in ipetl icpal in teotl*, "en el trono y tribunal de Dios," *Historia Chichimeca*, cap. 32.

29. *Mictlan*; the place of departed souls in Aztec mythology.

NOTES FOR SONG XVI.

In this stirring war-song, the poet reproaches his friends for their lukewarmness in the love of battle. He reminds them that life is transitory, and the dead rise not again, and that the greatest joy of the brave is on the ringing field of fray where warriors win renown. It is in the spirit of the Scotch harper:—

"'Twere worth ten years of peaceful life,

One hour of such a day."

1. Each verse terminates with an interjectional refrain. The frequent introduction of the particle *on* is intended to add strength and gravity to the oration.

2. *oppan piltihua*. Compare this expression with that in v. 22, p. 44.

3. *xochimicohuayan*, should perhaps be translated, "where the captives to be immolated to the Gods are taken." The *xochimique*, "those destined to a flowery death" were the captives who were reserved for sacrifice to the gods. See Joan Bautista, *Sermonario en Lengua Mexicana*, p. 180.

4. *yaoxochimiquiztica*, "pertaining to the slaughter of the flowery war." This adjective refers to the peculiar institution of the "flowery war," *guerra florida*, which obtained among the ancient Mexicans. It appears to have been a contest without provocation, and merely for the display of prowess and to take captives to supply the demand for human sacrifices in the religious rites. On this see Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 96.

NOTES FOR SONG XVII.

In this long fragment—the closing strophes are missing in my MS.—the bard represents himself as a stranger appearing before the nobles of Huexotzinco at some festival. The first two verses appear to be addressed to him by the nobles. They ask him to bring forth his drum and sing. He begins with a laudation of the power of music, proceeds to praise the noble company present, and touches those regretful chords, so common in the

Nahuatl poetry, which hint at the ephemeral nature of all joy and the certainty of death and oblivion. An appeal is made to the Master of Life who inspires the soul of the poet, and whose praises should be ever in mind.

The words *Dios* and *angelotin*, in verse 26th, indicate that the poem has received some "recension" by the Spanish copyist; but the general tone impresses me as quite aboriginal in character.

2. *quauhtlocelotl*, see note to I, 5.

3. In this verse, as frequently elsewhere, the syllable *ya* is introduced merely to complete the metre. Ordinarily it is the sign of the imperfect tense, and has other meanings (see the Vocabulary), but in many instances does not admit of translation.

8. *noncoati*, for *ni-on-coatl*, I am a guest.

18. The references in this verse are obscure, and I doubt if I have solved them.

20. "The house of spring;" compare the expression in v. 1, of Nezahualcoyotl's song, p. 42.

21. A long oration of Xicontecatli, lord of Tizatlan, may be found in Clavigero, *Hist. Antica di Messico*, Tom. III, p. 40. The expression in *camaxochitzin*, from *camatl*, mouth, *xochitl*, rose, flower, and the reverential *tzin*, is noteworthy.

24. *petlacoatl*, the centipede or scolopender; from *petlatl*, mat, and *coatl*, serpent, as they are said to intertwine with each other, like the threads of a mat (Sahagun, Lib. XII, cap. 4).

NOTES FOR SONG XVIII.

At this portion of the MS. several poems are preceded by a line of syllables indicating their accompaniment on the *teponaztli* (see Introduction, p. 32).

The present number is one of the most noteworthy songs of the collection. It belongs to the ancient cyclus of Quetzalcoatl myths, and gives a brief

relation of the destruction of Tollan and the departure and disappearance of the Light God, Quetzalcoatl Ce Acatl. As I have elsewhere collated this typical myth at length, and interpreted it according to the tenets of modern mythologic science, I shall not dwell upon it here (see D.G. Brinton, *American Hero Myths*, Phila., 1882).

The text of the poem is quite archaic, and presents many difficulties. But my translation, I think, gives the general sense correctly.

1. *huapalcalli*; literally, "the house constructed of beams." This name was applied to the chief temple of the Toltecs; the ruins of an ancient structure at Tollantzinco were pointed out at the time of the Conquest as those of this building (see Sahagun, *Hist. de la Nueva España*, Lib. X, cap. 29).

coatlaquetzalli; this edifice, said to have been left incomplete by Quetzalcoatl, when he forsook Tollan, had pillars in the form of a serpent, the head at the base, the tail at the top of the pillar. (See Orozco y Berra, *Hist. Antigua de Mexico*, Tom. III, pp. 30 and 46.) The structure is mentioned as follows in the *Anales de Cuauhtitlan*:—

Auh iniquac nemia Quetzalcoatl quitzintica, quipeuahtica iteocal quimaman coatlaquetzali ihuan amo quitzonquixti, amo quipantlaz."

"And when Quetzalcoatl was living, he began and commenced the temple of his which is the Coatlaquetzali (Serpent Plumes), and he did not finish it, he did not fully erect it."

Nacxiti Topiltzin, "Our Lord the four-footed." *Nacxiti* appears to have been the name of Quetzalcoatl, in his position as lord of the merchants. Compare Sahagun, *ubi supra*, Lib. I, cap. 19.

2. *Poyauhtecatli*, a volcano near Orizaba, mentioned by Sahagun. *Acallan*, a province bordering on the Laguna de los Terminos. The myth reported that Quetzalcoatl journeyed to the shores of the Gulf about the isthmus of Tehuantepec and there disappeared.

3. *Nonohualco*; the reference is to the *cerro de Nonoalco*, which plays a part in the Quetzalcoatl myth. The words of the song are almost those of Tezcatlipoca when he is introduced to Quetzalcoatl. Asked whence he came,

he replied, "Nihuitz in Nonohualcatepetl itzintla, etc." (*Anales de Cuauhtitlan*).

4. The occurrences alluded to are the marvels performed by Quetzalcoatl on his journey from Tulan. See my *American Hero Myths*, p. 115.

5. The departure of Quetzalcoatl was because he was ordered to repair to Tlapallan, supposed to be beyond Xicalanco.

8. *quinti*, for *iquintia*; the reference is to the magic draught given Quetzalcoatl by Tezcatlipoca.

9. *In tetl, in quahuitl*; literally, "stone and stick;" a very common phrase in Nahautl, to signify misfortunes.

NOTES FOR SONG XIX.

In this song we have avowedly a specimen of an early chant prepared probably by Bishop Zumarraga for the native converts. The accompaniment on the teponaztli is marked at the beginning. The language is noticeably different from the hymn to Quetzalcoatl just given (XVIII).

NOTES FOR SONG XX.

Another song of the antique Quetzalcoatl cyclus. It bewails the loss of Tulan, and the bard seeks in vain for any joyous theme to inspire his melody, reflecting on all that has bloomed in glory and now is gone forever.

3. *Tetl-quahitl*; see note to XVIII, 9.

NOTES FOR SONG XXI.

The occurrence to which this poem alludes took place about the year 1507. The chroniclers state that it was in the early period of the reign of Montezuma II, that the natives of Huexotzinco, at that time allies of the

Mexicans, were severely harassed by the Tlascallans, and applied, not in vain, to their powerful suzerain to aid them. (See Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 97.)

The poet does not appear to make a direct petition, but indirectly praises the grandeur of Montezuma and expresses his own ardent love for his native Huexotzinco. The song would appear to be used as a delicate prelude to the more serious negotiations. It is one of the few historical songs in the collection. From the references in verses 1 and 3 we infer that this singer held in his hand the painted book from which he recited the couplets. This may explain the presentation of the piece.

1. *huetzcani*; one who laughs, a jester, perhaps the designation of one who sang cheerful songs.

chalchihuahlatlaquiquizcopa; a. word of difficult analysis. I suspect an omission of an *l*, and that the compound includes *tlaquilqui*, one who fastens and puts together, a mason, etc.

5. The sense is that the warriors of Montezuma when on the field of battle, shine in their deeds like beautiful flowers in a field, and win lasting fame by their exploits.

mopopoyauhtoc. The grammarian Olmos explains the reflexive verb *mopopoyauhtiuh* to signify "he leaves an honored memory of his exploits." See Siméon, *Dictionnaire de la Langue Nahuatl*, sub voce.

7. *Huexotzinco atzalan*; "Huexotzinco amid the waters." This expression, repeated in verse 8, appears inappropriate to the town of Huexotzinco, which lies inland. In fact, the description in verse 7 applies to Tenochtitlan rather than the singer's own town. But the text does not admit this translation. Perhaps we should read "Huexotzinco and Atzalan," as there are yet two villages of that name in the state of Puebla (which embraced part of ancient Huexotzinco).

10. *petiatolini*, I have derived from *petlatl*, suspecting an error in transcription. The reference is to the rushes in the mat on which the singer stood.

NOTES FOR SONG XXII.

The ordinary sad burden of the Nahuatl poets is repeated with emphasis in this plaint. It is a variation of the Epicurean advice, "Eat, drink, and be merry, for to-morrow we die." Both the sentiment and the reference to Mictlan in verse 7, point it out as a production uninfluenced by Christian teaching.

7. The word *ahuicaloyan*, place of sweetness, would seem to be identical with *ohuicaloyan*, place of difficulty, in v. 8; I have regarded the latter as an error of transcription.

NOTES FOR SONG XXIII.

Although No. V. is probably one of the lost songs of Nezahualcoyotl, the present is the only one of the collection which is definitely attributed to him. The language is very archaic, and in the sentiment there is every mark of antiquity.

The text is apparently a dialogue, which was chanted as strophe and antistrophe, the one singer speaking for the King, the other for the bard himself.

The word *teotl* is used for divinity, and it is doubtless this word for which the copyists of some of the other songs have substituted the Spanish *Dios*, thus conveying an impression that the chants themselves were of late date.

The last verse, however, seems to be by one who lives after the time of the great poet-prince, and is calling him to memory.

NOTES FOR SONG XXIV.

It will be seen that there is a wearisome sameness in the theme of most of the short poems. Probably the bards followed conventional models, and feared for the popularity of their products, did they seek originality. Here

again are the same delight in flowers and songs, and the same grief at the thought that all such joys are evanescent and that soon "death closes all."

I consider the poem one of undoubted antiquity and purely native in thought and language.

NOTES FOR SONG XXV.

The destruction of the Mexican state was heralded by a series of omens and prodigies which took place at various times during the ten years preceding the arrival of Cortes. They are carefully recorded by Sahagun, in the first chapter of the 12th book of his history. They included a comet, or "smoking star," as these were called in Nahuatl, and a bright flame in the East and Southeast, over the mountains, visible from midnight to daylight, for a year. This latter occurred in 1509. The song before us is a boding chant, referring to such prognostics, and drawing from them the inference that the existence of Mexico was doomed. It was probably from just such songs that Sahagun derived his information.

1. *toztliyan*, I suppose from *tozquitl*, the singing voice, in the locative; literally, "the quechol in the place of sweet-singing."

2. *iquiapan*, from *i*, possessive prefix, *quiauatl*, door, entrance, house, *pan*, in.

5. An obscure verse; *tequantepec*, appears to be a textual error; *tequani*, a ravenous beast, from *qua* to eat; *tepec*, a mountain; but *tequantepehua* occurring twice later in the poem induces the belief *tequani* should be taken in its figurative sense of affliction, destruction, and that *tepec* is an old verbal form.

7. *Xochitecatl*, "one who cares for flowers," is said by Sahagun to have been the name applied to a woman doomed to sacrifice to the divinities of the mountains (*Hist. Nueva España*, Lib. II, cap. 13).

8. *amaxtecatl*, or *amoxtecatl*, as the MS. may read, from *amoxtli*, a book.

NOTES FOR SONG XXVI.

This seems to be a song of victory to celebrate an attack upon Atlixco by the ruler of Tezcucó, the famous Nezahualpilli. This monarch died in 1516, and therefore the song must antedate this period, if it is genuine. It has every intrinsic evidence of antiquity, and I think may justly be classed among those preserved from a time anterior to the Conquest. According to the chronologies preserved, the attack of Nezahualpilli upon Atlixco was in the year XI *tochtli*, which corresponds to 1490, two years before the discovery by Columbus (see Orozco y Berra, *Hist. Antigua de Mexico*, Tom. III, p. 399).

NOTES FOR SONG XXVII.

My MS. closes with a Christian song in the style of the ancient poetry. It is valuable as indicating the linguistic differences between these later productions of the sixteenth century and those earlier ones, such as XXVI, which I have not hesitated to assign to an epoch before the Spaniards landed upon the shores of New Spain.

VOCABULARY.

The Roman numerals refer to the songs, the Arabic to the verses, in which the word occurs. Abbreviations: *lit.*, literally; *ref.*, reflexive; *pret.*, preterit; *rev.*, reverential; *freq.*, frequentative; *post.*, postposition; *Span.*, a Spanish word.

A, *adv.* No, not, in comp.

A, *n.* For atl, water, in comp.; as *acalli*, water-house, *i.e.*, a boat.

A, *interj.* Oh! ah! placed after the word on which stress is laid.

AC, *pron.*, *interj.* Who?

ACA, *pron.* Some, any; somebody.

ACALLI, *n.* A boat, of any kind.

ACH, *dubitative particle.* Indeed? is it not? etc.

ACHITZINCA, *adv.* A little while, a short time.

ACHQUEN, *adv.* At what time? When?

ACI, *v.* To reach, to acquire.

ACOHUETZI, *v.* To console, to make glad. I, 3.

ACOQUIZA, *v.* To lift up, to raise, to increase in dignity or power.

ACOTLAZA, *v.* To console.

ACXOYATL, *n.* The wild laurel.

AHAUIA, *v.* To rejoice, take pleasure in; freq. of *ahuia*.

AHUACHIA, *v.* To wet one's self, to bathe. VII, 4.

AHUACHTLI, *n.* Dew, moisture.

AHUEHUETL, *n.* The cypress tree; *Cupressus disticha*.

AHUIA, *v.* To rejoice, to be joyful.

AHUIAC, *adj.* Agreeable, pleasant, sweet.

AHUIAN, *adj.* Content, satisfied.

AHUICPA, *adv.* From one place to another. III, 3.

AIC, *adv.* Never.

ALTEPETL, *n.* Town, city, citadel.

AMECH, *pron. ret.* You, to you.

AMEYALLI, *n.* A fountain, a stream; *lit.*, flowing water.

AMILLI, *n.* Watered and arable land. XIV, 6.

AMO, *adv.* No, not; *amo ma*, no other; *amo zannen*, not in vain; *pron.*, you, yours.

AMOXPETLATL, *n.* Book-mat. See XIX, 3.

AMOXTECATL, *n.* See XXV, 8, note.

AN, *pron.* You.

ANA, *v.* To take, to grasp, to seize.

ANAHUIA, *v.* To be dissatisfied.

ANCA, *adv.* Of the kind that. XVII, 12.

ANE, *adv.* Hollo! in calling.

ANGELOTIN, *n.* Angels. Span. XVII, 26.

ANO, *adv.* As little, neither.

ANOZO, *conj.* Or, perhaps.

AOC, *adv.* Not yet.

APANA, *v.* To clothe.

APANO, *v.* To ford, to cross water. XVIII, 2.

AQUEN, *adv.* Nothing, in no manner.

AQUIN, *pron.* Who? *in aquin*, he who.

AT, *adv.* Perhaps, perchance.

ATAYAHUILI, for *at aya ueli*. Not yet, not even.

ATIHUELMATI, *v.* Not to be well. IX, 3.

ATL, *v.* Water.

ATLAMACHTIA, *v.* To praise one; *ref.*, to be proud.

ATLE, *pron.* Nothing.

ATLEY, *in atley*. Without.

ATONAUIA, *v.* To have a fever, to be sick.

AUH, *conj.* And, even, also.

AXALLI, *n.* Bar-sand, water-sand.

AY, *v.* pret. *oax*. To do, to make.

AYA, *adv.* Not yet, not now.

AYACACHTLI, *n.* A musical instrument. See p. 24.

AYAHUITL, *n.* Fog, mist, vapor.

AYAUIH COZAMALOTL, *n.* The rainbow; *lit.*, "mist of water jewels."

AYOC, *adv.* Already not. *Ayoctle*, nothing more.

AYOQUAN, *adv.* Aoc-ian. Nothing like it, unequaled. XVII, 17.

AYOQUIC, *adv.* Nevermore. V, 6.

AZAN, *adv.* Not a little, not a few.

AZO, *conj.* Or, perhaps, perchance.

AZTLACAPALLI, *n.* The tail feathers of a bird. XVII, 10.

C, *pron. rel.* He, her, it, him; *postpos.*, with, by, in, from, at.

CA, *adv.* Already, yes, because, for, truly, only.

CA, *v.* To be (in a place).

CA, *postpos.* With, by, by means of.

CACALI, *v.* To discharge arrows.

CACOPA, *post.* Toward, towards.

CAHUA, *v.* To leave, to let, to desert, to stop, to lay down.

CALAQUIA, *v.* To enter, to go in.

CALLI, *n.* A house; in comp. *cal*, as *nocal*, my house.

CALMECAC, *n.* A public school, p. 10.

CAMAPANTLI, *n.* The cheeks, the face. XXVI, 5.

CAMATL, *n.* The mouth.

CAMPA, *adv.* Where, whither.

CAN, *adv.* and *postpos.* Where.

CANAUHTLI, *n.* A duck. XXI, 9.

CANEL, *adv.* Since, as, because.

CAQUI, *v.* To hear, to listen to.

CATLEHUATL, *pron.* Who? which? whoever, whatever.

CATQUI, *v. irreg.* From *ca*, to be (in a place).

CAUHTEHUA, *v.* To leave a place.

CAXTLAUITL, *n.* A kind of ochre. XVII, 10.

CE, *adj.* and *art.* One, a, an.

CECE, or Cecen, *adj.* Each, every.

CECEMELQUIXTIA, *v.* To come forth wholly, perfectly. I, 1.

CECEMELTIA, *v. ref.* To rejoice, to feel glad.

CECEMELTIC, *adj.* Complete, whole, entire.

CECEMMANA, *v.* To disperse, to scatter.

CEHUIA, *v.* To rest, to repose.

CEL, Sole only.

CELIA, *v.* 1. To receive, to obtain. 2. To blossom, to bloom.

CEMANAHUATL, *n.* The world, the universe.

CEMELLE, *adv.* With peace or joy. Usually with a negative *aic cemelle*, never peacefully. XV, 18; XVI, 1.

CEMILHUILTILIA, *v.* To detain one for a day.

CEMILHUITL, *n.* One day.

CEN, *adv.* Forever, for always; *cen yauh*, to go forever, to die.

CENCA, *adv.* Very much, exceedingly.

CENCI, *adv.* Elsewhere.

CENQUIXTIA, *v.* To select from, to pick from.

CENTZONTLATOLLI, *n.* The mocking bird, *Turdus polyglottus*; *lit.*, "the myriad-voiced."

CENTZONTLI, *adj. num.* Four hundred, used for any large number.

CEPANOA, *v.* To unite, to join together.

CHALCHIUHITL, *n.* The Mexican jade or green stone; emerald *fig.*, green; precious.

CHANE, *n.* Inhabitant or resident of a place.

CHANTLI, *n.* A dwelling, a residence; in comp., *chan*.

CHIA, *v.* To wait, to expect.

CHIALONI, *n.* That which is awaited or expected.

CHICAHUAC, *adj.* Strong, powerful.

CHICHIA, *v.* 1. To make bitter. 2. To obey. XIII, 9.

CHICHINA, *v.* To snuff up, imbibe, or suck up, especially the odors of burning incense, through a tube. VII, 4; XVII, 10.

CHICHINAQUILIZTLI, *n.* Torment, pain, suffering.

CHIHUA, *v.* To make, to do, to happen; *chihua in noyollo*, my heart is troubled, I am pained.

CHIMALLI, *n.* The native shield or buckler. VI, 4.

CHITONI, *v.* To sparkle, to glitter.

CHITONIA, *v.* To gain, to realize a profit. V, 4.

CHITTOLINI, *v.* To bow down, to sink.

CHOCA, *v.* To cry (of animals and man).

CIAHUI, *v.* To fatigue one's self, to tire.

CIHUACOATL, *n.* A magistrate of high rank; *lit.*, "woman serpent."

CIHUATL, *n.* A woman.

CITLALIN, *n.* A star.

CO, *postpos.* In, from.

COA, or COHUA, *v.* To buy, to purchase.

COCHITIA, v. To sleep.

COCOA, v. To pain, to give pain.

COCOLIA, v. To hate.

COCOYA, v. To be sick.

COHUATL, or COATL, *n.* A serpent; a guest; a twin; the navel; a spade.

COHUAYOTL, *n.* Buying, purchasing. V, 2.

COLLI, *n.* Ancestor, forefather.

COLOA, v. To twist, to turn, to bend.

COMONI, v. To crackle (of a fire); to be turbulent (of people). XXIV.

CON, *pron.* Some one; comp. of *c* and *on*.

COPA, *postpos.* By, toward.

COPALLI, *n.* Resin, gum copal.

COYOUA, v. To cry, to yell. XIII, 7.

COYOHUACAN, *n.* The place of wolves. XIII, 10.

COYOLTOTOTL, *n.* The coyol bird, *Piranga hepatica*.

COYOTL, *n.* The coyote, the Mexican wolf.

COZCATIA, v. To deck with golden chains. IV, 4.

COZCATL, *n.* Jewel, precious stone; a string of such; a chain or collar.

CUECUEXANTIA, v. To gather in the folds of the robe.

CUECUEYA, v. To move to and fro. XXI, 9.

CUEPA, v. To turn, to return, to bring back.

CUEPONI, v. To blossom, to bud, to bloom.

CUETLANI, v. To wilt, to perish. XV, 15.

CUETZPALTI, *v.* To act as a glutton, to revel in. XVII, 5.

CUEXANTLI, *n.* Gown, robe, petticoat.

CUI, *v.* To take, to gather, to collect.

CUICA, *n.* A song, a poem.

CUICANI, *n.* A singer, a poet.

CUICOYAN, *n.* A place for singing. See note to p. 10.

CUIHUA, *v.* Pass. of *cui*, *q.* *v.*

CUILIA, *v.* Rev. of *cui*, *q.* *v.*

CUILOA, *v.* To paint, to write.

CUILTONOA, *v.* To be rich; to rejoice greatly; to enrich or cause joy. XV, 6.

CUITLATL, *n.* Excrement, dung.

CUIX, *adv.* An interrogative particle.

ECACEHUAZTLI, *n.* A fan.

EHECATL, *n.* Wind, air.

EHECAYO, *adj.* Full of wind, stormy.

EHUA, *v.* To lift up, especially to raise the voice in singing.

ELCHIQUIHUITL, *n.* The breast, the stomach.

ELCHIQUIUHEUA, *v.* To fatigue, to tire. VI, 5.

ELCICIHUILIZTLI, *n.* A sigh, a groan.

ELEHUIA, *v.* To desire ardently, to covet.

ELLAQUAHUA, *v.* To animate, to inspire.

ELLELACI, *v.* To suffer great pain.

ELLELLI, *n.* Suffering, pain.

ELLELQUIXTIA, *v.* To cause joy, to make glad.

ELLELTIA, *v. Ref.*, to regret, to repent, to abstain; *act.*, to prevent, to hinder, to impede, to cause pain.

EPOALLI, *adj. num.* Sixty.

EZTLI, *n.* Blood.

HUAHUAQUI, *u.* To dry up, to wither wholly. VIII, 1.

HUAL, *adv.* Hither, toward this place.

HUALLAUH, *v. irreg.* To come hither.

HUAN, *postpos.* In company with; also, a plural termination.

HUAPALCALLI, *n.* Houses of planks. See XVIII, 1.

HUAQUI, *v.* To dry up, to wither.

HUECAPAN, *adj.* Lofty.

HUECATLAN, *adj.* Deep, profound.

HUEHUETL, *n.* A drum. See page 22.

HUEHUETZI, *v. freq.* To fall often.

HUEIYOTL, *n.* Greatness, grandeur.

HUEL, *adv.* Well, good, pleasant.

HUELIC, *adj.* Sweet, pleasant, fragrant.

HUELMANA, *v.* To make smooth, or even; to polish, to burnish.

HUETZCANI, *n.* A jester, a laughter. XXI, 1.

HUETZI, *v.* To fall.

HUETZTOC, *v.* To be stretched out, to be in bed.

HUEY, *adj.* Great, large.

HUEYATLAN, *n.* Place of increase, from *hueya*, to grow greater.

HUIC, *postpos.* Toward, against.

HUICA *v.* To accompany; to carry off; to govern, to rule, to direct.

HUIHUICA, *v.* To follow in crowds, or often.

HUIHUIITEQUI, *v.* To gather, to pluck.

HUILOHUAYAN, *n.* Bourne, goal, terminus; from *huiloa*, all go.

HUIPANA, *v.* To put in order, to arrange.

HUITOMI, *v.* To split, to fall. XVIII, 4.

HUITZ, *v.* To come.

HUITZITZICATIN, *n.* The humming bird. I, 1.

HUITZITZILIN, *n.* The humming bird, *Trochilus*.

HUITZLI, *n.* A thorn, especially of the maguey.

HUITZTLAN, *n.* The south; *huitztlampa*, from or to the south.

I, *v. Pret. oic.* To drink.

I, *pron.* His, her, its, their.

IC, *conj.* For, since, because; *prep.* With, towards, by, in; *adv.* Where? when? *zan ic*, as soon as, often, only, on purpose.

ICA, *post.* With him, her, it, etc.

ICÂ, *adv.* Sometimes, occasionally.

ICAC, *v.* To stand upright.

ICAHUACA, *v.* To sing (of birds).

ICALI, *v.* To war, to fight. VI, 5.

ICAUHTLI, *n.* Younger brother. VII, 2.

ICELIA, *v.* To incite another, to devote one's self to.

ICNELIA, *v.* To do good, to benefit.

ICNIUHTLI, *n.* A friend, a companion; *tocnihuan*, our friends.

ICNOPILLAHUELILOCATI, *v.* To be ungrateful.

ICNOTLAMACHTIA, *v.* To excite compassion.

ICPAC, *postpos.* Upon, over.

IHUAN, *conj.* And, also.

IHUI, *adv.* Of this kind, in this way.

IHUINTI, *v.* To intoxicate, to make drunk.

IHUITL, *n.* Feather, plumage.

ILACATZIUI, *v.* To twist, to twine.

ILACATZOA, *v.* To twine around, to wind about. XV, 2.

ILCAHUA, *v.* To forget.

ILHUIA, *v.* To speak, to say, to tell.

ILHUICATL, *n.* Heaven, the sky.

ILNAMIQUILIA, *v.* To remember, to call to mind.

ILPIA, *v.* To bind, to fasten.

IM, See *in*.

IMATI, *v.* To be skillful or wise; to prepare or arrange something skillfully.

IN, *art. and pron.* He, they, the, which, etc.; *in ma oc*, meanwhile; *in ic*, so that, in order that.

INAYA, *v.* To confer, to hide. X, 2.

INECUI, *v.* To smell something, to perceive an odor. IV, 6.

INIC, *adv.* For, in order that, after that.

ININ, *pron.* These, they.

INQUAC, *conj.* When.

INNE, *conj.* But.

INOC, *adv.* While, during.

INON, *pron.* Those.

INTLA, *conj.* If.

INTLACAMO, *adv.* Unless, if not.

IPALNEMOANI, *n.* A name of God. See III, 1, note.

IPAMPA, *adv.* Because.

IPOTOCTLI, *n.* Smoke, vapor, exhalation.

ITAUHCAYOTL, *n.* Fame, honor. XVII, 14.

ITHUA, *v.* To see, for *itla*. XV, 6.

ITIA, *v.* 1. To drink; to cause to drink. 2. To suit, to fit.

ITIC, *postpos.* Within, inside of.

ITLANI, *v.* To ask, to solicit, to demand.

ITOA, *v.* To say, to speak, to tell.

ITONALIZTLI, *n.* Sweat; *fig.*, hard work. VI, 5.

ITOTIA, *n.* To dance in the native fashion.

ITOTILIZTLI, *n.* Dance.

ITTA, *v.* To see, to behold.

ITTITIA, *v.* To show, to make evident.

ITZMOLINI, *v.* To be born, to sprout, to grow. XX, 4.

ITZTAPALLI, *n.* Paving stone. XV, 8.

ITZTOC, *v.* To watch, to keep awake, to wait for. XVII, 12.

IXAMAYO, *adj.* Known, recognized. XIII, 2.

IXAYOTL, *n.* A tear (from the eyes).

IXCUITIA, *v.* To take example.

IXIMACHOCA, *n.* The knowledge of a person.

IXIMATI, *v.* To know personally.

IXITIA, *v.* To awake, to arouse.

IXPAN, *postpos.* Before the face of, in presence of.

IXQUICH, *adv.* As many as.

IXTIA, *v.* To face a person, especially the enemy; to watch.

IXTLAHUATL, *n.* Open field, savanna, desert.

IXTLAN, *postpos.* Before the face of.

IXTLI, *n.* Face, visage; eye.

IZA, *v.* To awaken, to arouse.

IZCALI, *v.* To arise, to rise up.

IZHUATL, *n.* A leaf of a tree, etc.

IZHUAYO, *adj.* Leafy, with leaves.

IZQUI, *adj., pl.* izquintin. As many, so many, all; *izqui in quezqui*, as many as.

IZTAC, *adj.* White.

IZTLACAHUIA, *v.* To deceive, to cheat.

IZTLACOA, v. To search for; *ref.*, to take counsel.

MA, *adv.* Sign of optative, subjunctive and vetative; *ma oc*, yet a while.

MACA, v. To give, to present.

MA CA, *neg.* Do not.

MACAIC, *adv.* Never.

MACAZO TLEIN, *neg.* No matter, for all that. VI, 2.

MACEHUALLOT, *n.* Servitude, slavery.

MACEUALTI, v. *defect.* To merit; to be happy.

MACEHUALTIA, v. 1. *nino*, to make another a vassal, to reduce to vassalage; *nite*, to give vassals to one; *nita*, to impose a penance on one.

MACH, *adv.* An intensive particle.

MACHTIA, v. To cause to know, to teach, to learn.

MACIUI, *adv.* Although, granted that. XVII, 13.

MACQUAITL, *n.* The native sword. VI, 4.

MACUELE, *adv.* Would that—sign of the optative.

MAHACA, *adv.* Not, no.

MAHUI, v. To fear, to have fear.

MAHUIZTI, v. To be esteemed, to be honored.

MAITL, *n.* The hand, the arm. In comp. *ma*, as *noma*, my hand.

MALACACHOA, v. To twine, to fold. XVI, 4.

MALHUIA, v. To regale, to treat well, to take care of.

MALINA, v. To twine, to wreath.

MALINTIUH, v. To twine, to twist, to enwreath.

MAMALIA, *v.* To carry.

MAMALLI, *v.* To enter, to penetrate. XII, 4.

MAMANA, *v.* To arrange a feast, to set in order. XV, 15.

MAMANI, *v.* See Mani.

MANA, *v.* To offer offerings. XVII, 3.

MANCA, *v.* Imp. of *Mani*.

MANEN, *neg.* That not, that it does not happen, etc.

MANI, *v.* To be (of broad or wide things); to be stretched out.

MANOZO, *adv.* Or, if.

MAQUIZTLI, *n.* A bracelet or other ornament of the arm. III, 5.

MATI, *v.* To know. *Ref.*, to think, to reflect; *qui-mati noyollo*, I presume, I doubt; *nonno-mati*, I attach myself to a person or thing.

MATILOA, *v.* To anoint, to rub.

MAZO, *adv.* Although.

MEYA, *v.* To flow, to trickle.

MIAHUATOTOTL, *n.* A bird. IV, 2.

MICOHUANI, *adj.* Mortal, deadly.

MIEC, *adv.* Much, many.

MILLI, *n.* Cultivated field.

MIQUI, *v.* To die, to kill.

MIQUITLANI, *v.* To desire death. X, 1.

MITZ, *pron.* Thee, to thee.

MIXITL, *n.* A narcotic plant. See *tlapatl*. IX, 2.

MIXTECOMATL, *n.* A dark night, a dark place. III, 4.

MIZQUITL, *n.* The mesquite. XV, 1.

MO, *pron.* 1. Thy, thine; 2. *Pron. ref.* 3 sing., he, him, they, them.

MOCHI, *adj.* All.

MOCHIPA, *adv.* Always.

MOLINIANI, *n.* One who moves, or agitates. XVI, 3.

MOMOLOTLA, *v.* To cause to foam, to cut to pieces. XII, 3.

MOTELCHIUH, *n.* The governor of Tenochtitlan. XIII, 8.—See *telchihua*.

MOTLA, *v.* To throw, to fall. I, 1.

MOTLALI, *adj.* Seated, placed, in repose.

MOYAUUA, *v.* To conquer; to become cloudy or troubled (of water); to talk about; to boast.

MOZTLA, *adv.* To-morrow.

NAHUAC, *postpos.* Toward, by, along, near to.

NAHUI, *adj. num.* Four.

NALQUIXTIA, *v.* To cause to penetrate, causative of *nalquiza*, to penetrate.

NANANQUILIA, *v.* To answer, to reply to.

NANTLI, *n.* Mother, *tonan*, our mother, etc.

NAUHCAMPA, *adv.* In four directions, to four places.

NE, *pron.* Reflexive pronoun 3d person in verbal substantives and impersonal verbs.

NE, *pron.* for *nehuatl*. I, me.

NECALIZTLI, *n.* Battle, combat.

NECH, *pron.* Me, to me.

NECHCA, *adv.* There, down there; like the French *là-bas*; *ocye nechca*, formerly, once.

NECI, *v.* To appear, to show one's self or others.

NECO, *v.* Pass, of *nequi*, *q. v.*

NECTIA, *v.* To desire, to wish for.

NECULTONOLLI, *n.* Riches, possessions.

NEICALOLOYAN, *n.* The field of battle.

NEIXIMACHOYAN, *n.* A place where one is taught. XIII, 1.

NEL, *adv.* But.

NELHUAYOTL, *n.* A root; *fig.*, principle, foundation, essence.

NELIHUI, *adv.* It is thus, even thus; *mazo nelihui*, though it be thus.

NELLI, *adv.* Truly, verily.

NELOA, *v.* To mingle, to shake, to beat.

NELTIA, *v.* To verify, to make true.

NEMACTIA, *v.* 1. To receive, to obtain. 2. To give, to grant.

NEMAYAN, *adv.* In the course of the year. XII, 3.

NEMI, *v.* To live, to dwell, to walk.

NEMOA, *v. impers.* To live, to dwell.

NEN, *adv.* Vainly, in vain.

NENCHIUA, *v.* To do in vain.

NENECTIA, *v.* To obtain by effort. XII, 4.

NENELIUHTICA, *adj.* Mixed up, mingled together.

NENELOA, *v.* To mix, to mingle.

NENEPANOA, *v. freq.* To mix, to mingle. XVII, 1.

NENEQUI, *v.* To act tyrannically; to feign; to covet. XI, 7.

NENNEMI, *v.* To wander about.

NENONOTZALCUICATL, *n.* A song of exhortation.

NENTACI, *v.* To fail, to come to naught. XVII, 13, 14.

NENTLAMACHTIA, *v. ref.* To afflict one's self, to torment one's self.

NENTLAMATI, *v.* To be afflicted, disconsolate.

NEPA, *adv.* Here, there. *Ye nepa*, a little further, beyond. XXI, 6. *Oc nepa*, further on.

NEPANIUI, *v.* To join, to unite.

NEPANTLA, *postpos.* In the midst of.

NEPAPAN, *adj.* Various, diverse, different.

NEPOHUALOYAN, *n.* The place where one is reckoned, read, or counted. VI, 2.

NEQUI, *v.* To wish, to desire.

NETLAMACHTILIZTLI, *n.* Riches, property.

NETLAMACHTILOYAN, *n.* A prosperous place. IV, 6; VII, 4.

NETLANEHUIHUIA, *v.* To have an abundance of all things. XXVI, 1.

NETOTILIZTLI, *n.* Dance, dancing.

NETOTILOYAN, *n.* Place of dancing.

NI, *pron. pers. I.* Before a vowel, *n.*

NICAN, *adj.* Here, hither.

NIHUI, *adv.* From *no-ihui*, thus, of the same manner. XVIII, 3.

NIMAN, *adv.* Soon, promptly.

NINO, *pron. ref.* I myself.

NIPA, *adv.* Here, in this part, there.

NO, *adv.* Also, like, *no yuh*, in the same way, thus. *Pron.* My, mine.

NOCA, *pron.* For me, for my sake, by me.

NOHUAN, *pron.* With me.

NOHUIAMPA, *adv.* In all directions, on all sides.

NOHUIAN, *adv.* Everywhere, on all sides.

NONOYAN, *n.* Place of residence. V, 2.

NONOTZA, *v.* To consult, to take counsel, to reflect.

NOTZA, *v.* To call some one.

NOZAN, *adv.* Even yet, and yet, to this day.

OBISPO, *n.* Bishop. *Span.* XIX, 4.

OC, *adv.* Yet, again; *oc achi*, yet a little; *oc achi ic*, yet more, comparative; *oc pe*, first, foremost.

OCELOTL, *n.* The tiger; a warrior so called. See note to I, 5.

OCOXOCHITL, *n.* A fragrant mountain flower. III, 2.

OCTICATL, *n.* See note to VII, 1.

OCTLI, *n.* The native wine from the maguey. In comp., *oc*.

OHUAGA, *interj.* Oh! alas!

OHUI, *adj.* Difficult, dangerous.

OHUICALOYAN, *n.* A difficult or dangerous place. XXII, 7.

OHUICAN, *n.* A difficult or dangerous place.

OME, *adj.* Two.

OMITL, *n.* A bone.

OMPA, *adv.* Where.

ON, *adv.* A euphonic particle, sometimes indicating action at a distance, at other times generalizing the action of the verb.

ONCAN, *adv.* There, thither.

ONOC, *v.* To be lying down.

OPPA, *adv.* A second time, twice.

OQUICHTLI, *n.* A male, a man.

OTLI, *n.* Path, road, way.

OTOMITL, *n.* An Otomi; a military officer so called.

OTONCUICATL, *n.* An Otomi song. II, 1.

PACHIUI NOYOLLO, *v.* I am content, satisfied. IX, 2.

PACQUI, *v.* To please, to delight.

PACTLI, *n.* Pleasure, joy.

PAL, *postpos.* By, by means of.

PAMPA, *postpos.* For, because.

PAN, *postpos.* Upon; *apan*, upon the water.

PAPALOTL, *n.* The butterfly.

PAPAQUI, *v.* To cause great joy.

PATIUHTLI, *n.* Price, wages, reward.

PATLAHUAC, *adj.* Large, spacious.

PATLANI, v. To fly.

PEHUA, v. *Pret.*, *opeuh*, to begin, to commence.

PEPETLACA, v. To shine, to glitter.

PEPETLAQUILTIA, v. To cause to shine.

PETLACOATL, *n.* The scolopender, the centipede. XVII, 24.

PETLATL, *n.* A mat, a rug (of reeds or flags); *fig.*, power, authority.

PETLATOTLIN, *n.* A rush suitable to make mats. XXI, 10.

PETLAUA, v. To polish, to rub to brightness.

PEUHCAYOTL, *n.* Beginning, commencement.

PILIHUI, v. To fasten to, to mingle with. XXI, 6.

PILIHUITL, *n.* Beloved child. XII, 3.

PILLI, *n.* Son, daughter, child. A noble, a chief, a ruler, a lord. *Tepilhuan*, the children, the young people. *Nopiltzin*, my lord.

PILOA, v. To hang down, to suspend.

PILTIHUA, v. To be a boy, to be young.

PIPIXAUI, v. To snow, to rain heavily.

PIXAUI, v. To snow, to rain.

POCHOTL, *n.* The ceiba tree; *fig.*, protector, chief.

POCTLI, *n.* Smoke, vapor, fog, mist.

POLOA, v. To destroy; to perish.

POPOLOA, v. Freq. of *poloa*.

POPOYAUHTIUH, v. To leave a glorious memory. XXI, 5.

POXAHUA, v. To work the soil, to labor.

POYAUUA, *v.* To color, to dye. XVII, 21.

POYAUUI, *v.* To become clear, to clear off.

POYOMATL, *n.* A flower like the rose. IV, 6.

POZONI, *v.* To boil, to seethe; *fig.*, to be angry.

QUA, *v.* To eat.

QUAHTLA, *n.* Forest, woods.

QUAHUITL, *n.* A tree; a stick; *fig.*, chastisement.

QUAITL, *n.* Head, top, summit.

QUALANI, *v.* To anger, to irritate.

QUALLI, *adj.* Good, pleasant.

QUATLAPANA, *v.* To break one's head; to suffer much.

QUAUHTLI, *n.* The eagle; a warrior so called; bravery, distinction. I, 5.

QUEMACH, *adv.* Is it possible!

QUEMMACH AMIQUE, *rel.* Those who are happy, the happy ones. IX, 2.

QUENAMI, *adv.* As, the same as.

QUENAMI CAN, *adv.* As there, the same as there, sometimes with *on* euphonic inserted, *quenonami*.

QUENIN, *adj.* How, how much.

QUENNEL, *adv.* What is to be done? What remedy?

QUENNONAMICAN, See under *quenami*.

QUEQUENTIA, *v.* To clothe, to attire.

QUETZA, *v.* *Nino*, to rise up; to unite with; to aid; *nite*, to lift up.

QUETZALLI, *n.* A beautiful feather; *fig.*, something precious or beautiful.

QUETZALTOTOTL, *n.* A bird; *Trogon pavoninus*.

QUEXQUICH, *pron.* So many as, how much.

QUI, *pron. rel.* He, her, it, they, them.

QUIAUATL, *n.* Entrance, door. XVII, 18.

QUIAUITL, *n.* Rain, a shower.

QUIMILOA, *v.* To wrap up, to clothe, to shroud the dead. XI, 6.

QUIN, *pron. rel.* They, then.

QUIQUINACA, *v.* To groan, to buzz, etc.

QUIQUIZOA, *v.* To ring bells. IV, 3.

QUIZA, *v.* To go forth, to emerge.

QUIZQUI, *adj.* Separated, divided.

QUIZTIQUIZA, *v.* To go forth hastily. XXII.

TAPALCAYOA, *v.* To be full of potsherds and broken bits. XV, 16.

TATLI, *n. and v.* See p. 19.

TE, *pron. pers.* 1. Thou. 2. *Pron. rel. indef.* Somebody.

TEAHUIACA, *adj.* Pleasing, agreeable.

TECA, *pron.* Of some one; *te* and *ca*.

TECA, *v.* To stretch out, to sleep; to concern one's self with. *Moteca*, they unite together. TECH, *postpos.* In, upon, from. *Pron.* Us.

TECOCOLIA, *n.* A hated person, an enemy.

TECOMAPILOA, *n.* A musical instrument. See p. 23.

TECPILLI, *n.* Nobleman, lord.

TECPILLOTL, *n.* The nobility; noble bearing, courtesy.

TEHUAN, *pron.* 1. We. 2. With some one.

TEHUATL, *pron.* Thou.

TEINI, *v.* To break, to fracture.

TEL, *conj.* But, though.

TELCHIHUA, *v.* To detest, to hate, to curse.

TEMA, *v.* To place something somewhere.

TEMACHIA, *v.* To have confidence in, to expect, to hope for.

TEMI, *v.* To be filled, replete; to be stretched out. XXVI, 4.

TEMIQUI, *v.* To dream.

TEMO, *v.* To descend, to let fall.

TEMOA, *v.* To search, to seek.

TENAMITL, *n.* A town; the wall of a town.

TENAUAC, *post.* With some one, near some one.

TENMATI, *v.* To be idle, negligent, unfortunate.

TENQUIXTIA, *v.* To speak forth, to pronounce, to declare.

TENYOTL, *n.* Fame, honor.

TEOATL, *n.* Divine water. See VI, 4, note.

TEOCUITLA, *n.* Gold, of gold.

TEOHUA, *n.* A priest. XVII, 19.

TEOQUECHOL, *n.* A bird of beautiful plumage.

TEOTL, *n.* God, divinity.

TEOXIHUITL, *n.* Turquoise; *fig.*, relation, ruler, parent.

TEPACCA, *adj.* Causing joy, pleasurable.

TEPEITIC, *n.* Narrow valley, glade, glen.

TEPETL, *n.* A mountain, a hill.

TEPEUA, *v.* To spread abroad, to scatter, to conquer. XV, 3.

TEPONAZTLI, *n.* A drum. See p. 22.

TEPOPOLOANI, *v.* To slay, to slaughter.

TEQUANI, *n.* A wild beast, a savage person.

TEQUI, *v.* To cut.

TETECUICA, *v.* To make a loud noise, to thunder. XXI, 7.

TETL, *n.* A stone, a rock. In comp., *te*.

TETLAMACHTI, *n.* That which enriches, glorifies, or pleases.

TETLAQUAUAC, *adj.* Hard or strong as stone. Comp. of *tetl* and *tlaquauac*.

TETOZCATEMO, *v.* To let fall or throw forth notes of singing. I, 2.

TETZILACATL, *n.* A copper gong. XVII, 21. See p. 24.

TEUCTLI, *n.*, pl. *teteuctin*. A noble, a ruler, a lord; *in teteuctin*, the lords, the great ones.

TEUCYOTL, *n.* Nobility, lordship.

TEUH, *postpos.* Like, similar to.

TEUHYOTL, *n.* Divinity, divineness.

TEYOLQUIMA, *adj.* Pleasing, odorous, sweet.

TEYOTL, *n.* Fame, honor.

TI, *pron.* 1. thou; *timo*, ref.; *tic*, act. 2. we; *tito*, ref.; *tic*, act.

TILANI, *v.* To draw out.

TILINI, *v.* To crowd, to press. XVII, 19.

TIMALOA, *v.* To glorify, to exalt, to praise.

TIMO, *pron. ref.* Thou thyself.

TITO, *pron. ref.* We ourselves.

TIZAITL, *n.* Chalk; anything white; an example or model.

TIZAOCTLI, *n.* White wine. See VII, 2.

TLA, *adv.*, for *intla*, if; *pron. indef.*, something, anything; *postpos.* in abundance.

TLACACE, *interj.* Expressing astonishment or admiration. XVII, 3.

TLACAQUI, *v.* To hear, to understand.

TLACATEUCTLI, *n.* A sovereign, a ruler.

TLACATI, *v.* To be born.

TLACATL, *n.* Creature, person.

TLACAZO, *adv.* Truly, certainly.

TLACHIA, *v.* To see, to look upon.

TLACHIHUAL, *n.* Creature, invention.

TLACHINOLLI, *n.* Battle, war; from *chinoa*, to burn.

TLACOA, *v.* To injure, to do evil, to sin.

TLACOCOTLI, *n.* The arrow.

TLACOCOA, *v.* To buy, to purchase. X, 1.

TLACOHUA, *v.* To buy, to purchase.

TLACOHUA, *v.* To beat, to chastise.

TLACOTLI, *n.* A servant, slave.

TLACOUIA, v. To split, to splinter.

TLACUILOA, v. To inscribe, to paint in, to write down.

TLAELEHUIANI, *adj.* Desirous of, anxious for.

TLAHUELLI, *n.* Anger, ire.

TLAHUICA, *n.* Servant, page; also, a native of the province of Tlahuican. (See *Index*.)

TLAILOTLAQUI, *n.* "Workers in filth;" scum; a term applied in contempt. XIII, 8; XV, 12, 14. Also a proper name. (See *Index*.)

TLALAQUIA, v. To bury, to inter.

TLALLI, *n.* Earth, ground; *tlalticpac*, on the earth.

TLALNAMIQUI, v. To think of, to remember.

TLALPILONI, *n.* An ornament for the head. VI, 4, from *ilpia*.

TLAMACHTI, v. *ref.* To be rich, happy, prosperous.

TLAMAHUIZOLLI, *n.* Miracle, wonder.

TLAMATILLOLLI, *n.* Ointment; anything rubbed in the hands. XI, 9.

TLAMATQUI, *adj.* Skillful, adroit.

TLAMATTICA, *adj.* Calm, tranquil.

TLAMELAUHCAYOTL, *n.* A plain or direct song. II, 1.

TLAMI, v. To end, to finish, to come to an end.

TLAMOMOYAUUA, v. To scatter, to destroy. XV, 21.

TLAN, *postpos.* Near to, among, at.

TLANECI, v. To dawn, to become day. *Ye tlaneci*, the day breaks.

TLANEHUIA, v. *Nicno.* To revel, to indulge one's self in. XXI, 8.

TLANELTOCA, *v.* To believe in, to have faith in.

TLANIA, *v.* To recover one's self, to return within one's self.

TLANIICZA, *v.* To abase, to humble. IX, 3.

TLANTIA, *v.* To terminate, to end.

TLAOCOL, *adj.* Sad, melancholy, pitiful, merciful.

TLAOCOLIA, *v.* To be sad, etc.

TLAOCOLTZATZIA, *v.* To cry aloud with grief. I, 3.

TLAPALHUIA, *v., rel.* To be brilliant or happy; *act.*, to salute a person; to paint something.

TLAPALLI, *n.* and *adj.* Colored; dyed; red.

TLAPALOA, *v.* To salute, to greet.

TLAPANAHUIA, *adj.* Surpassing, superior, excellent; used to form superlatives.

TLAPANI, *v.* To dye, to color. XVII, 10.

TLAPAPALLI, *adj.* Striped, in stripes.

TLAPATL, *n.* The castor-oil plant; the phrase *mixitl tlapatl* means stupor, intoxication. IX, 2.

TLAPEPETLANI, *v.* To sparkle, to shine forth.

TLAPITZA, *v.* Fr. *pitza*, to play the flute. XVII, 26.

TLAQUALLI, *n.* Food, eatables.

TLAQUAUAC, *adj.* Strong, hard.

TLAQUAUH, *adj.* Strongly, forcibly.

TLAQUILLA, *adj.* Stopped up, filled. XX, 4.

TLAQUILQUI, *n.* One who plasters, a mason. XXI, 1.

TLATEMMATI, v. To suffer afflictions.

TLATENEHUA, v. To promise.

TLATHUI, v. To dawn, to become light.

TLATIA, v. 1. To hide, to conceal; 2. to burn, to set on fire.

TLATLAMANTITICA, *adj.* Divided, separated.

TLATLATOYA, v. To speak much or frequently. XVII, 11.

TLATLAUHTIA, v. To pray. XVI, 3.

TLATOANI, *n.* Ruler, lord.

TLATOCAYOTL, *n.* The quality of governing or ruling.

TLATOLLI, *n.* Word, speech, order.

TLATZIHUI, v. To neglect, to be negligent; to be abandoned, to lie fallow; to leave, to withdraw.

TLAUANTLI, *n.* Vase, cup. XXVI, 4.

TLAUHQUECHOL, *n.* A bird, the red heron, *Platalea ajaja*.

TLAUILLOTL, *n.* Clearness, light. X, 1.

TLAXILLOTIA, v. To arrange, sustain, support. IX, 4.

TLAXIXINIA, v. To disperse, to destroy.

TLAYAUA, v. To make an encircling figure in dancing.

TLAYAUALOLLI, *adj.* Encircled, surrounded. XXI, 6.

TLAYLOTLAQUI, *n.* See XIII, 8.

TLAYOCOLIA, v. To make, to form, to invent. XIV.

TLAYOCOYALLI, *n.* Creature, invention.

TLAZA, v. To throw away; *fig.*, to reject, to despise.

TLAZOTLA, *v.* To love, to like.

TLE, *pron. int. and rel.* What? That.

TLEAHUA, *v.* To set on fire, to fire.

TLEIN, *pron., int. and rel.* What? That.

TLEINMACH, *adv.* Why? For what reason?

TLENAMACTLI, *n.* Incense burned to the gods. III, 1.

TLEPETZTIC, *adj.* Shining like fire, *tletl, petzlic*. XV, 26.

TLETL, *n.* Fire.

TLEYMACH, *adv.* Why? Wherefore?

TLEYOTL, *n.* Fame, honor.

TLEZANNEN, *adv.* To what good? Cui bono?

TLILIUHQUI, *adj.* Black, brown.

TLILIUI, *v.* To blacken, to paint black. XII, 6.

TLOC, *postpos.* With, near to.

TLOQUE NAHUAQUE, *n.* A name of divinity. See I, 6, note.

TO, *pron. posses.* Our, ours.

TOCA, *v.* To follow.

TOCI, *n.* "Our ancestress," a divinity so called.

TOCO, *v.* Impers. of *toca*.

TOHUAN, *pron.* With us.

TOLINIA, *v.* To be poor, to be unfortunate.

TOLQUATECTITLAN, *n.* The place where the head is bowed for lustration. III, 1.

TOMA, *v.* To loosen, to untie, to open. XVII, 3.

TOMAHUAC, *adj.* Great, heavy, large.

TONACATI, *v.* To be prosperous or fertile.

TONACATLALLI, *n.* Rich or fertile land.

TONAMEYO, *adj.* Shining like the sun, glittering.

TONAMEYOTL, *n.* Ray of the sun, light, brilliancy.

TONATIUH, *n.* The sun.

TONEUA, *v.* To suffer pain; *nite*, to inflict pain.

TOQUICHPOHUAN, *n.* Our equals. I, 3.

TOTOTL, *n.* A bird, generic term.

TOZMILINI, *adj.* Sweet voiced. XXI, 3.

TOZNENETL, *n.* A parrot, *Psittacus signatus*.

TOZQUITL, *n.* The singing voice, p. 21.

TZALAN, *postpos.* Among, amid.

TZATZIA, *v.* To shout, to cry aloud.

TZAUHQUI, *v.* To spin. XVII, 22.

TZETZELIUI, *v.* To rain, to snow; *fig.*, to pour down.

TZIHUAC, *n.* A species of bush. XV, 1.

TZIMIQUILIZTLI, *n.* Slaughter, death. XVI, 5.

TZINITZCAN, *n.* A bird, *Trogon Mexicanus*.

TZITZILINI, *n.* A bell.

TZOTZONA, *v.* To strike the drum.

UALLAUH, *v.* To come. See *huallauh*.

UITZ, v. To come.

ULLI, *n.* Caoutchouc. See p. 22.

XAHUA, v. To paint one's self, to array one's self in the ancient manner. XXIV, 1.

XAMANI, v. To break, to crack.

XAXAMATZA, v. To cut in pieces, to break into bits.

XAYACATL, *n.* Face, mask.

XELIHUI, v. To divide, to distribute.

XEXELOA, v. To divide, to distribute.

XILOTL, *n.* Ear of green corn.

XILOXOCHITL, *n.* The flower of maize. XVII, 10.

XIMOAYAN, *n.* A place of departed souls. See I, 8.

XIMOHUAYAN, *n.* Place of departed spirits. VIII, 1.

XIUHTOTOTL, *n.* A bird, *Guiraca caerulea*.

XIUITL, *n.* A leaf, plant; year; anything green.

XOCHICALLI, *n.* A house for flowers, or adorned with them.

XOCHIMECATL, *n.* A rope or garland of flowers.

XOCHIMICOHUAYAN, *n.* See XVI, 3, note.

XOCHITECATL, *n.* See XXV, 7, note.

XOCHITL, *n.* A flower, a rose.

XOCHIYAOTL, *n.* Flower-war. See XVI, 4, note.

XOCOMIQUI, v. To intoxicate, to become drunk.

XOCOYA, v. To grow sour. XIII, 4.

XOPALEUAC, *n.* Something very green.

XOPAN, *n.* The springtime.

XOTLA, *v.* To blossom, to flower; to warm, to inflame; to cut, to scratch, to saw.

XOXOCTIC, *adj.* Green; blue. XVI, 6.

XOYACALTITLAN, *n.* The house or place of decay. III, 1.

Y., Abbrev. for *ihuan*, and *in*, q. v.

YA, *adv.* Already, thus; same as *ye*; *v.*, to suit, to fit. Part. euphonic or expletive. See note to XVII, 3.

YAN, *postpos.* Suffix signifying place.

YANCUIC, *adj.* New, fresh, recent.

YANCUICAN, *adv.* Newly, recently.

YAOTL, *n.* War, battle.

YAOYOTL, *n.* Warfare.

YAQUI, *adj.* Departed, gone, left for a place.

YAUH, *v.*, *irreg.* To go.

YE, *adv.* Already, thus; *ye no ceppa*, a second time; *ye ic*, already, it is already.

YE, *pron.* He, those, etc.

YE, *adj. num.* Three.

YECE, *adv.* But.

YECEN, *adv.* Finally, at last.

YECNEMI, *v.* To live righteously.

YECOIA, *v.* To do, to finish, to conclude.

YECTENEHUA, v. To bless, to speak well of.

YECTLI, *adj.* Good, worthy, noble.

YEHUATL, *pron.* He, she, it. Pl. *yehuan*, *yehuantin*.

YEHUIA, v. To beg, to ask charity.

YEPPA YUHQUI. Formerly, it was there. VII, 2.

YHUINTIA. See *ihuinti*.

YOCATL, *n.* Goods, possessions; *noyocauh*, my property. XV, 26.

YOCAUA, *n.* Master, possessor, owner.

YOCOLIA, v. To form, to make.

YOCOYA, v. To make, to invent, to create.

YOHUATLI, *n.* Night, darkness.

YOLAHUIA, v. To rejoice greatly.

YOLCIAHUIA, v. To please one's self, to make glad.

YOLCUECUECHOA, v. To make the heart tremble. IV, 6.

YOLEHUA, v. To excite, to animate.

YOLIHUAYAN, *n.* A place of living III, 5.

YOLLO, *adj.* Adroit, skillful; also for *iyollo*, his heart.

YOLLOTL, v. Heart, mind, soul.

YOLNONOTZA, v. See note to I, 1.

YOLPOXAHUA, v. To toil mentally.

YUHQUI, *adv.* As, like.

YUHQUIMATI, v. To understand, to realize.

ZACATL, *n.* Herbage, straw, hay. XXI, 5.

ZACUAN, *n.* Feather of the zacuan bird; *fig.*, yellow; prized.

ZACUAN TOTOTL, *n.* The zacuan bird, *Oriolus dominicensis*.

ZAN, *adv.* Only, but; *zan cuel*, in a short time; *zanen*, perhaps; *Zan nen*, in vain.

ZANCUEL ACHIC, *adv.* A moment, an instant; often; *zan ye*, but again, but quickly.

ZANIO, *pron.* I alone, he or it alone.

ZOA, *v.* To pierce; to spread out; to open; to sew; to string together; to put in order.

ZOLIN TOTOTL, *n.* The quail.

ZOMA, *v.* To become angry.

ZOMALE, *adj.* For *comalli*, vase, cup. XXVI, 4.

INDEX OF NAHUATL PROPER NAMES, WITH EXPLANATIONS.

ACALLAN, 105. "The place of boats," from *acalli*, boat. An ancient province at the mouth of the Usumacinta river; but the name was probably applied to other localities also.

ACATLAPAN, 41. A village southeast of Chalco. From *acatla*, a place of reeds, and *pan*, in or at.

ACHALCHIUHTLANEXTIN, 46. The first chief of the Toltecs; another form of *chalchihuhtonac*. Both names mean "the gleam of the precious jade." Compare Torquemada, *Monarquia Indiana*. Lib. III., cap. 7; Orozco y Berra, *Hist. Antigua de Mexico*, Tom. III., p. 42. The date of the beginning of his reign is put at A.D. 667 or 700.

ACOLHUACAN, 40, 91, 119. A compound of *atl*, water, and *colhuacan*, (q. v.) = "Colhuacan by the water," the name of the state of which Tetzcuco was the capital, in the valley of Mexico.

ACOLMIZTLAN, 89, from

ACOLMIZTLI, 35. A name of Nezahualcoyotl (see p. 35), also of other warriors.

ANAHUAC, 125. From *atl*, water, *nahuac*, by, = the land by the water. The term was applied first to the land by the lakes in the Valley of Mexico, and later to that along both the Gulf of Mexico and the Pacific Ocean.

ATECPAN, 77. "The royal residence by the water" (*atl*, *tecpan*). I do not find this locality mentioned elsewhere.

ATLIXCO, 125. "Where the water shows its face" (*atl*, *ixtli*, *co*). A locality southeast of Tezcucuo, near the lake, so called from a large spring. See Motolinia, *Historia de los Indios*, Trat. III, cap. 18.

ATLOYANTEPETL, 85, 89, 91. Perhaps for *atlauantepetl*, "the mountain that rules the waters." But see note to XIII, v. 6.

ATZALAN, 114. "Amid the waters" (*atl*, *tzalan*). Perhaps not a proper name; but two villages in the present State of Puebla are called Atzala (see Orozco y Berra, *Geografia de las Lenguas de Mexico*, pp. 212, 213).

AXAXACATZIN, 43. Probably for *axayacatzin*, reverential of *axayacatl*, the name of a species of marsh fly. It was also the name of the sixth ruler of Mexico (flor. about 1500), and doubtless of other distinguished persons. See Ixtlilxochitl, *Historia Chichimeca*, cap. 51.

AZCAPOTZALCO, 50, 51. An ancient town in the valley of Mexico, once the capital city of the Tepanecas (q. v.). The word means "place of the ant-hills," from *azcaputzalli*.

AZTECS, 25. A Nahuatl tribe who derived their name from their mythical ancient home, Aztlan. The derivation is obscure, but probably is from the same radical as *iztac*, white, and, therefore, Father Duran was right in translating Aztlan, "place of whiteness," the reference being to the East, whence the Aztecs claim to have come. See Duran, *Historia de las Indias*, cap. II.

CACAMATL, 94, 95. The reference appears to be to Cacamatzin (the *Noble Sad One*, from *cacamaua*, fig. to be sad), last ruler of Tezcucó, son and successor, in 1516, of Nezahualpilli. He was put to death by Cortes.

CATOCIH, 89. A doubtful word, which may not be a proper name.

CHALCO, 16, 69, 95. A town and lake in the valley of Mexico. The people were Nahuas and subject to Mexico. The word is probably derived from *Challi*, with the postpos. *co*, meaning "at the mouth" (of a river). See Buschmann, *Ueber die Aztekischen Ortsnamen*, s. 689, and comp. *Codex Ramirez*, p. 18.

CHIAPA, CHIAPANECA, 70, 71. The province and inhabitants of Chiapas, in Southern Mexico. There were colonies of Nahuas in Chiapas, though most of the natives spoke other tongues. The derivation is probably from *chia*, a mucilaginous seed highly esteemed in Mexico.

CHICHIMECATL or CHICHIMECS, 88, 89, 91, 101. A rude hunting tribe, speaking Nahuatl, who settled, in early times, in the valley of Mexico. The name was said to be derived from *chichi*, a dog, on account of their devotion to hunting (*Cod. Ramirez*). Others say it was that of their first chieftain.

CHICOMOZTOC, 88, 89. "At the seven caves," the name of the mythical locality from which the seven Nahuatl tribes derived their origin. The *Codex Ramirez* explains the seven caves to mean the seven houses or lineages (totems) of which the nation consisted.

CHILILITLI, 36. Name of a tower of sacred import. It is apparently a compound of *chia* or *chielia*, to watch, and *tlilli*, blackness, obscurity, hence "a night watch-tower." It was probably used for the study of the sky at night.

CHIMALPOPOCA, 43. "The smoking shield," from *chimalli*, shield, and *popoca*. The name of several distinguished warriors and rulers in ancient Mexico.

CHOLULA or CHOLOLLAN, 105. Name of a celebrated ancient state and city. From *choloa*, with the probable meaning, "place of refuge," "place of the fugitives."

CIHUAPAN, 41. Name of a warrior, otherwise unknown. From *cihuatl*, woman, *pan*, among, with.

COATZITEUCTLI, 89. A name compound of *coatzin*, reverential form of *coatl*, serpent, and *teuctli*, lord.

COLHUA, A people of Nahuatl affinity, who dwelt in ancient times in the valley of Mexico. See *Colhuacan*.

COLHUACAN, 88, 89, 91. A town in the valley of Mexico. In spite of the arguments to the contrary, I believe the Colhua were of Nahuatl lineage, and that the name is derived from *colli*, ancestor; *colhuacan*, the residence of the ancestors; with this signification, it was applied to many localities. It must be distinguished from *Acolhuacan*. Its ikonomatic symbol was a hill bent over at the top, from *coloa*, to bend.

COLZAZTLI, 39. Probably for Coltzatztl, one who cries out or calls to the ancestors (*colli*, *tzatzia*). A chief whom I have not found elsewhere mentioned.

CONAHUATZIN, 41. A warrior not elsewhere mentioned. By derivation it means "noble son of the lord of the water" (*conetl*, *ahua*, *tzin*).

CUETZPALTZIN, 89. A proper name, from *cuetzpalli*, the 4th day of the month.

CUEXTLA, 33. A province of ancient Mexico. See Torquemada, *Monarquia Indiana*. Lib. II, caps. 53, 56.

CULTEPEC, 42. A village five leagues from Tezcucó, at the foot of the mountains. Deriv., *colli*, ancestor, *tepetl*, mountain or town, with post-pos. *c*; "at the town of the ancestors."

HUETLALPAN or HUETLAPALLAN, 89. The original seat of the mythical Toltecs. The name is a compound of *hue*, old, and *Tlapallan*, q. v.

HUEXOTZINCO, 50, 83, 91, 99, 113. An independent State of ancient Anahuac, south of Tlascala and west of Cholula. The name means "at the little willow woods," being a diminutive from *huexatla*, place of willows.

HUITLALOTZIN, 89. From *huitlallotl*, a species of bird, with the reverential termination. Name of a warrior.

HUITZILAPOCHTLI, 16. Tribal god of the Mexicans of Tenochtitlan. The name is usually derived from *huitzitzilin*, humming bird, and *opochtli*, left (*Cod. Ramirez*, p. 22), but more correctly from *huitztli*, the south, *iloa*, to turn, *opochtli*, the left hand, "the left hand turned toward the south," as this god directed the wanderings of the Mexicans southward. The humming bird was used as the "ikonomatic" symbol of the name.

HUITZILIHUITL, 89. "Humming-bird feather." Name of an ancient ruler of Mexico, and of other warriors.

HUITZNAHUACATL, 91. A ruler of Huexotlan (Clavigero); a member of the Huitznahua, residents of the quarters so called in Tezcucó and Tenochtitlan (Ixtilxochitl, *Hist. Chichimeca*, cap. 38).

IXTLILXOCHITL, 35, 46, 89. A ruler of Acolhuacan, father of Nezahualcoyotl. Comp. *ixtli*, face, *tlilxochitl*, the vanilla (literally, the black flower).

IZTACCOYOTL, 89, 93. "The white wolf." Name of a warrior otherwise unknown.

MEXICANS, 67, 83, 85, 87, 123, 125. See

MEXICO, 83, 123. Name of the town and state otherwise called Tenochtitlan. *Mexitl* was one of the names of the national god Huitzilopochtli, and Mexico means "the place of Mexitl," indicating that the city was originally called from a name of the god.

MICTLAN, 95, 117, 119. The Mexican Hades, literally, "the place of the dead."

MONTEZUMA, 14, 41, 113. The name of the ruler of Mexico on the arrival of Cortes. The proper form is *Moteuhzomatzin* or *Motecuhzomatzin*, and the meaning, "he who is angry in a noble manner." ("señor sañudo," *Cod. Ramirez*, p. 72; "qui se fache en seigneur," Siméon, *Dict. de la Langue Nahuatl*, s. v.).

MOQUIHUIX, 33. The fourth ruler of Tlatilolco. He assumed the power in 1441, according to some writers (Bustamente, *Tezcoco, en los Ultimas Tiempos de sus Antiguos Reyes*, p. 269). The name probably means "He who comes forth a freeman." See Ixtlilxochitl, *Historia Chichimeca*, caps. 36, 51.

NACXITL TOPILTZIN, 105, 107. Nacxitl, "the four footed" (*nahui*, *ixitl*), was the name of one of the gods of the merchants (Sahagun, *Hist. de Nueva España*, Lib. I, c. 19). In the song it is applied to Quetzalcoatl, who was also regarded as a guardian of merchants.

NAHUATL, (9, etc.). A term applied to the language otherwise known as Aztec or Mexican. As an adjective it means "well-sounding," or, pleasant to the ear. From this, the term *Nahua* is used collectively for all tribes who spoke the Nahuatl tongue. *Nahuatl* also means clever, skillful, and the derivation is probably from the root *na*, to know.

NECAXECMITL, 46. Name of uncertain meaning of a person otherwise unknown.

NEZAHUALCOYOTL, 35, 67, 119. Chief of the Acolhuas, and ruler in Tezcucó from 1427 to 1472, or thereabouts. He was a distinguished patron of the arts and a celebrated poet. See p. 35, et seq.

NEZAHUALPILLI, or NEZAHUALPIZINTLI, 14, 125. Ruler of Acolhuacan, son of Nezahualcoyotl. His accession is dated in 1470 or 1472.

NONOHUALCO, 105, 125. Name of one of the quarters of the ancient city of Mexico; also of a mountain west of the valley of Mexico. The derivation is probably from *onoc*, to lie down; *onohua*, to sleep; *onohuayan*, a settled spot, an inhabited place. The *co* is a postposition.

NOPAL or NOPALTZIN, 46. Ruler of Acolhuacan, A. D. 1260-1263, according to some chronologies. The name is from *nopalli*, the cactus or opuntia.

NOPILTZIN, 67, 91. "My son," or "my lord," a term of deference applied to superiors, from *pilli*, which means son and also lord, like the old English *child*. Cf. *Topiltzin*.

OTOMIS, 16, 49, 58, 64, 71, 95. A nation which inhabited a portion of the valley of Mexico and region adjacent, entirely dissimilar in language and appearance from the Nahuas. The etymologies suggested are unsatisfactory.

POPOCATEPETL, 46. "The smoking mountain," the name of a famous volcano rising from the valley of Mexico.

POYAUHTECATL, 105. A volcano near Orizaba (Sahagún. *Hist. de Nueva España*, Lib. I, cap. 21). Derived from *poyaua*, to color, to brighten.

QUANTZINTECOMATZIN, 41. A warrior not otherwise known. The name is a double reverential, from *quani*, eater, and *tecomatl*, vase, "The noble eater from the royal dish."

QUAUHQUECHOLLAN, 95. A village and plain near the southern base of Popocatepetl. It means "the place of the quechol woods," or the trees among which quechol birds are found. See Motolinia, *Historia de los Indios*, Trat. III, cap. 18.

QUAUHXILOTL, 89. Name of a large tree, and applied to a warrior, ruler of Iztapallocan, whom Ixtlilxochitl, King of Tezcucó, placed at the head of his troops in his war with Tezozomoc. See Clavigero, *Storia Antica di Messico*, Tom. I, p. 185.

QUETZALCOATL, 32, 143, 144. See note on p. 143.

QUETZALMAMATZIN, 91. Name of a warrior, "the noble one of the beautiful hands" (*quetzalli*, *mama*, pl. of *maitl*, and rev. term, *tzin*). Perhaps the same as Quetzalmemalitzin, ruler of Teotihuacan, mentioned by Ixtlilxochitl, *Historia Chichimeca*, cap. 35.

QUIAUHTZIN, 93. Name of a warrior, "The noble rain" (*quiauitl*, *tziri*).

TENOCHTITLAN, 85. The current name for the City of Mexico; literally, "at the stone-nopal," from *tetl*, stone, *nochtli*, nopal, and postpos., *tlan*. The term refers to an ancient tradition.

TEPANECAS or TECPANECAS, 35. A powerful nation of Nahuatl lineage, who dwelt in the valley of Mexico. They were destroyed in 1425 by the Acolhuas and Mexicans, and later the state of Tlacopan was formed from their remnants. Comp. probably from *tecpan*, a royal residence, with the gentile termination.

TEPEYACAC, TEPEYACAN, 93. From *tepetl*, mountain, *yacatl*, nose, point, and postpos., *c.* 1. A small mountain on which the celebrated church of the Virgin of Guadalupe now stands. 2. A large town and state subject to ancient Mexico, now Tepeaca in the province of Puebla.

TETLAPAN QUETZANITZIN, 68, 69. A ruler of Tlatilolco, contemporary of the conquest. See Note to Song VI.

TETZCOCO, now TEZCUCO, 14, 35, 36, 77. Capital city of Acolhuacan, and residence of Nezahualcoyotl. It has been called "the Athens of Anahuac." The derivation of the name is from a plant called *tetzculli* (*Cod. Ramirez*).

TEZOZOMOC, TEZOZOMOCTLI, 35, 39, 67, 88, 89. A ruler of the Tepanecas, celebrated for his warlike skill and severity. His death is placed

in the year 1427. The name, like Montezuma, is derived from *zoma*, to be angry, in this case from the reduplicated frequentative form, *zozoma*.

TIZATLAN, 103. "The place of white varnish" (*tizatli*), the name of one of the four quarters of the city of Tlascala.

TLACOMIHUATZIN, 93. "The noble cousin of the lynx" (*tlacomiztli*, lynx, huan, postpos., denoting affinity, *tzin*, reverential). The name of a warrior.

TLACOPAN, now TACUBA, 135. A small state west of Mexico and subject to it, built up on the ruins of the ancient Tepanecas. Comp. from *tlacotli*, a slave.

TLAHUICAN, 118. A Nahuatl province south of the valley of Mexico, so called from the cinnabar, *tlahuatl*, there obtained (Buschmann; but the *Cod. Ramirez* gives the meaning "toward the earth," from *tlalli* and *huic*). [*Transcriber's note: TLAHUICAN not found in text. See Tlahuica in Vocabulary.]

TLAILOTLACAN, 140. One of the seven divisions of the city of Tezcucó (*Ixtlilxochitl*, *Hist. Chichimeca*, cap. 38). [*Transcriber's note: TLAILOTLACAN not found in text.]

TLAILOTLAQUI, 84. Literally, "workers in refuse," or "scavengers." Said by M. Aubin to have been a tribe who settled in Tezcucó in the reign of Quinantzin. The term is apparently one of contempt. [*Transcriber's note: TLAILOTLAQUI not found on page 84 in text. See Tlailotlaqui in Vocabulary.]

TLALMANALCO, 42. A village near the foot of the volcano Popocatepetl. Derived from *tlalmanalli*, level ground, with postpos. *co*.

TLALNAHUACATL, 89. "Dweller on the land;" name of a warrior.

TLALOC, 45. God of rain and the waters; a famous divinity among the ancient Mexicans. The word means "stretched on the earth," and the idol of the god represented a man extended on his back holding a vase.

TLAPALLAN, 105. A mythical land from which the Toltecs were fabled to have come and to which Quetzalcoatl returned. The derivation is from *tlapalli*, color, especially red.

TLATETOLCO, TLATILULCO, 33, 83, 85. A suburb of the ancient city of Mexico, founded in 1338; from *tlatelli*, a mound, *ololoa*, to make round, the sense being "an island." See Motolinia, *Historia de los Indios*, Trat. III, cap. 7.

TLAXCALLAN, now TLASCALA, 89, 93, 103. "The place of bread," from *tlaxcalli*, bread. Site of a warlike tribe of Nahuatl descent, east of the valley of Mexico.

TLATZIN, 46. Chief of a town of the Chichimecs, situated on Lake Chalco. He flourished toward the close of the 14th century. From *tlatli*, a falcon.

TOCHIN, 89. From *tochtli*, rabbit; name of the brother of the Tezcucan ruler Quinantzin, and of many other personages.

TOLLAN, or TULAN, 46, 105, 107. The ancient mythical capital of the Toltecs. The common derivation from *tolin*, a rush, is erroneous. The name is a syncopated form of *tonatlan*, "the place of the sun."

TOLTEC, properly TOLTECATL, 46, 111. An inhabitant of Tollan. The Toltecs were a mythical people, whose civilization was supposed to have preceded that of the Aztecs.

TOPILTZIN, 46, 105. "Our son" or "Our lord" (see Nopiltzin). The term was especially applied to Quetzalcoatl, q. v. See Orozco y Berra, *Hist. Antig. de Mexico*, Tom. III, p. 54.

TOTOQUILHUATLI, 41. From *totoquilia*, to act as agent or lieutenant. Ruler of Tlacopan. The verse of the song in which this name occurs is given in the original Nahuatl by Ixtlilxochitl, who says it was very popular throughout New Spain. See his *Historia Chichimeca*, cap. 32.

XICALANCO, 107. A locality on the borders of the province Tabasco. The people spoke Nahuatl. Deriv. *xicalli*, gourd or jar, and postpos. *co*.

XICOMATZINTLAMATA, 43. Name of a warrior not otherwise known. The compound seems to mean "skillful with angry hand" (*xicoa*, *maitl*, *tlamati*).

XICONTECATL, 103. Name of several distinguished Tlascalan warriors, lords of Tizatlan. See Clavigero, *Hist. Antica di Messico*, Tom. III, pp. 38

and 40, One was a favorite of Nezahualcoyotl. See Ixtlilxochitl, *Historia Chichimeca*, cap. 40.

XIUHTEUCTLI, 15. The god of fire, literally, "the lord of the year," or "of the foliage."

XIUHTZAL, 46. A queen of ancient Tollan, said by Clavigero to have ruled from A. D. 979 to 984. Other writers give the name more correctly Xiuhtlaltzin, "Lady of the Green Fields," and place her death in 987. (Orozco y Berra, *Hist. Antig. de Mexico*, Tom. III, p. 45.)

XOLOTL, 46. An early if not the first king of the Chichimecs. His death occurred in 1232.

YOHUALLATONOC, 89. "Shining at night." Name of a warrior.

YOPICO, 22. A division of the ancient city of Mexico, containing a temple of this name. The word means "the place of the tearing out of hearts" (*yolltol, pi, co*), from the form of sacrifice there carried out.

YOYONTZIN, 35, 40, 66, 67. A name of Nezahualcoyotl. See p. 35.

FOOTNOTES.

[1] Diego Duran, *Historia de las Indias de Nueva España*, Tom. I, p. 233; and compare Geronimo de Mendieta, *Historia Ecclesiastica Indiana*, Lib. II, cap. 31.

[2] Sahagun, *Historia de Nueva España*, Lib. VIII, cap. 26.

[3] Sahagun, *Historia de Nueva España*, Lib. III, cap. 8.

[4] *Cuicoyan*, from *cuica*, song, and the place-ending *yan*, which is added to the impersonal form of the verb, in this instance, *cuicoa*. Mr. Bancroft entirely misapprehends Tezozomoc's words about these establishments, and gives an erroneous rendering of the term. See his *Native Races of the Pacific Coast*, Vol. II, p. 290, and Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 18.

[5] Juan de Torquemada, *Monarquia Indiana*, Lib. VI, cap. 43.

[6] Torquemada, *Monarquia Indiana*, Lib. XVII, cap. 3. Didacus Valades, who was in Mexico about 1550, writes of the natives: "Habent instrumenta musica permulta in quibus semulatione quadam se exercent." *Rhetorica Christiana*, Pars. IV, cap. 24.

[7] Descriptions are given by Edward Mühlentfordt, *Die Republik Mexico*, Bd. I, pp. 250-52 (Hannover, 1844).

[8] Molina translates *piqui*, "crear ô plasmar Dios alguna cosa de nuevo." *Vocabulario de la Lengua Mexicana*, s.v.

[9] Sahagun, *Historia de Nueva España*, Lib. X, cap. 8.

[10] Boturini, *Idea de una Nueva Historia General*, p. 97.

[11] Clavigero, *Storia antica di Messico*, Lib. VII, p. 175.

[12] Torquemada, *Monarquia Indiana*, Lib. X, cap. 34.

[13] Duran, *Hist. de la Indias de Nueva España*, Tom. I, p. 233.

[14] Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 64.

[15] Ixtlilxochitl, *Historia Chichimeca*, cap. 47.

[16] Boturini, *Idea de una Nueva Historia General*, p. 90.

[17] Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 53.

[18] See Sahagun, *Historia de Neuva España*, Lib. IV, chap. 17, and Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 64.

[19] *Cuitlaxoteyotl*, from *cuitatl*, mierda; *tecuilhuicuicatl*, from *tecuilhuaztli*, sello, *tecuilonti*, el que lo haze a otro, pecando contra natura. Molina, *Vocabulario*.

[20] William A. Hammond, *The Disease of the Scythians (morbus feminarum) and Certain Analogous Conditions*, in the *American Journal of Neurology and Psychiatry*, 1882.

[21] *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 2.

[22] On this subject the reader may consult Parades, *Compendio del Arte de la Lengua Mexicana*, pp. 5, 6, and Sandoval, *Arte de la Lengua Mexicana*, pp. 60, 61. Tapia Zenteno whose *Arte Novissima de la Lengua Mexicana* was published in 1753, rejects altogether the saltillo, and says its invention is of no use except to make students work harder! (pp. 3, 4.) The vowels with saltillo, he maintains, are simply to be pronounced with a slight aspiration. Nevertheless, the late writers continue to employ and describe the saltillo, as Chimalpopoca, *Epitome á Modo Facil de aprender el Idioma Nahuatl*, p. 6. (Mexico, 1869.)

[23] *Arte Novissima de la Lengua Mexicana*, pp. 3, 4.

[24] Duran, *Historia de Nueva España*, Tom. I, p. 230.

[25] The singer who began the song was called *cuicaito*, "the speaker of the song."

[26] The most satisfactory description of these concerts is that given by Geronimo de Mendieta, *Historia Ecclesiastica Indiana*, Lib. II, cap. 31. I

have taken some particulars from Boturini and Sahagun.

[27] Literally, "the broken drum," from *tlapana*, to break, as they say *tlapanhuimetzli*, half moon. It is described by Tezozomoc as "un atambor bajo." *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 53.

[28] From *yollotl*, heart, and *pi*, to tear out. The instrument is mentioned by Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 48. On the Yopico, and its ceremonies, see Sahagun, *Historia de Nueva España*, Lib. II, cap. 1, and Appendix.

[29] Simeon, however, thinks the name arose from the growing and swelling of the sound of the instrument (notes to Jourdanet's translation of Sahagun, p. 28). Mr. H.H. Bancroft gives the astonishing translation of *teponaztli*, "wing of stone vapor!" (*Native Races of the Pacific States*, Vol. II, p. 293.) Brasseur traced the word to a Maya-Quiche root, *tep*. In both Nahuatl and Maya this syllable is the radicle of various words meaning to increase, enlarge, to grow strong or great, etc.

[30] Sahagun, *Hist. de Nueva España*, Lib. II, cap. 27.

[31] See *The Güegüence, a Comedy ballet in the Nahuatl Spanish dialect of Nicaragua*, Introd., p. 29. (Philadelphia, 1883.)

[32] Theodor Baker, *Ueber die Musik der Nord-Amerikanischen Wilden.*, pp. 51-53. (Leipzig, 1882.)

[33] *Omitl*, bone, *chicahuac*, strong. A specimen made of the bone of a fossil elephant is possessed by Señor A. Chavero, of Mexico. See Tezozomoc, *Cronica Mexicana*, cap. 55, and the note of Orozco y Berra to that passage in the Mexican edition. Also Sahagun, *Hist. de Nueva España*, Lib. VIII, cap. 20, who likewise describes most of the instruments referred to in this section.

[34] H.T. Cresson, *On Aztec Music*, in the *Proceedings of the Academy of Natural Sciences*, Philadelphia, 1883.

[35] Sahagun, *Historia de Nueva España*, Lib. II, Appendice.

[36] Duran, *Historia de las Indias de Nueva España*, Tom. I, p. 233.

[37] Boturini, *Idea de una Nueva Historia General*, Appendice, p. 95.

[38] Echevarria, *Historia del Origen de las Gentes de Nueva España*, Discurso Preliminar.

[39] Clavigero, *Storia Antica di Messico*, Lib. VII, p. 175.

[40] "Ihre Sprachen sind überreich an doppelsinnigen Ausdrücken die sie absichtlich anwenden um ihre Gedanken zu verbergen. Geistliche haben mir versichert, dass sie obgleich der Aztekischen Sprache vollständig mächtig, oft den wahren Sinn einer Beichte nicht zu verstehen vermochten, weil die Beichtende sich in räthselhafter und metaphorreicher Weise auszudrücken pflegten." Carlos von Gager, *Charakteristik der Indianischen Bevölkerung Mexico's*, p. 17 (in the *Mit. der Geog. Gesell.*, Wien. 1837).

[41] Carochi's translations are not quite literal. The following notes will explain the compounds:—

1. *Tlauitl*, red ochre, *quecholli*, a bird so called, *aztatl*, a heron, *ehualtia*, reverential of *ehua*, to rise up; hence, "It (or he) shone like a noble red-winged heron rising in flight."

2. *Ayauitl*, mist; *coçamalotl*, rainbow; *tonameyotl*, shining, brightness; *ti*, connective; *mani*, substantive verb. "The brightness of the rain bow is there." There is no conjunction "and"; Father Carochi seems to have carelessly taken *ayauh*, which is the form of *ayauitl* in composition, for the conjunction *auh*, and. Each of the lines given is a detached fragment, without connection with the others.

3. *xiuitl*, something blue or green; *coyolli*, bells; *tzitzilicaliztli*, tinkling. "The golden drum's turquoise-bell-tinkling."

4. *xiuhtic*, blue or green; *tlapalli*, red; *cuiloa*, to paint or write; *amoxitli*, book; *manca*, imperf. of *mani*. "There was a book painted in red and green."

5. *chalchiuhuitl*, the jade; *cozcatl*, a jewel; *mecatl*, a string; *totoma*, frequentative of *toma*, to unfold, unwind. "I unwind my song like a string of precious jewels."

[42] See above, page 10

[43] *On the Ikonomatic Method of Phonetic Writing, with special reference to American Archeology*. By D. G. Brinton, in Proceedings of the American

Philosophical Society, for October, 1886.

[44] This fact is mentioned by Lord Kingsborough in his great work on Mexico, Vol. VI, p. 533.

[45] It is described in the *Anales del Museo Nacional*, Tom. III, p. 262.

[46] Echevarria's words are "los pongo en su idioma." *Hist. del Origen de las Gentes que poblaron la Nueva España, Discurso Preliminar*, in Kingsborough's *Mexico*, Vol. VIII.

[47] See his *Tezcuco en los Ultimas Tiempos de sus Antiguos Reyes*. Parte IV (Mexico, 1826).

[48] See the description of this fragment of Boturini by Señor Alfredo Chavero in the *Anales del Museo Nacional*, Tom. III, p. 242.

[49] M. Aubin, *Notice sur une Collection d'Antiquités Mexicaines*, pp. 8, 9. (Paris, 1851.)

[50] Printed very incorrectly in Lord Kingsborough's edition of Ixtlilxochitl's *Relaciones Historicas* (Rel. X, Kingsborough, *Antiquities of Mexico*, Vol. IX, p. 454).

[51] See Sahagun, *Historia de Nueva España*, Lib. II, Appendix.

[52] Bustamente puts the number of the songs of Nezahualcoyotl at eighty, of which he could find only one extant, and this, as I understand his words, in Spanish only. See his *Tezcuco en los Tiempos de sus Antiguos Reyes*, p. 253 (Mexico, 1826). When Alexander von Humboldt visited Mexico he sought in vain for any fragment of the songs of the royal bard. *Vues lies Cordillères*, etc., Tom. II, p. 391.

[53] *Tardes Americanas*, pp. 90-94. (Mexico, 1778.)

[54] Torquemada, *Monarquia Indiana*, Lib. II, cap. 45. The word *huehuetitlan*, seems to be a misprint for *ahuehuetitlan*, from *ahuehuetl*, with the ligature *ti*, and the postposition *tlan*, literally "among the cypresses."

[55] *Op. cit.* Tom. I, p. 795.

[56] *Grammatica del Idioma Mexicano*, p. 180. (Mexico, 1880.)

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